The Laws of Cricket

The Laws of Cricket, like the English Common Law, are essentially English in that they have developed according to the needs of each particular age. Perhaps one of the reasons why this book is as fascinating as it is informative is because it tells of the circumstances which forced each change in the Laws of Cricket into being, often revealing a story both unexpected and entertaining.

Colonel Rait Kerr, who is Secretary to the M.C.C., has made considerable research into the subject and has succeeded in segregating for the first time the authentic development of the Laws of Cricket since the seventeenth century from other material of doubtful reliability. In the first part of the book he traces their development from cricket's earliest days as a game for children to the preparation of the 1947 Code, in which the author played an important part. The second half of the book is devoted to a complete chronology of the statutory changes. There are several illustrations of considerable historical interest.

A rewarding subject, wide research and an entertaining style make this outstanding amongst books on cricket. As Sir Norman Birkett writes in his Foreword, 'No man can read it without being conscious of the years of unselfish labour that have gone into the making of this book, and no man can put it down without feeling that his knowledge of the game and his love for it have been immensely deepened and intensified.'



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The Laws of Cricket

THEIR HISTORY AND GROWTH

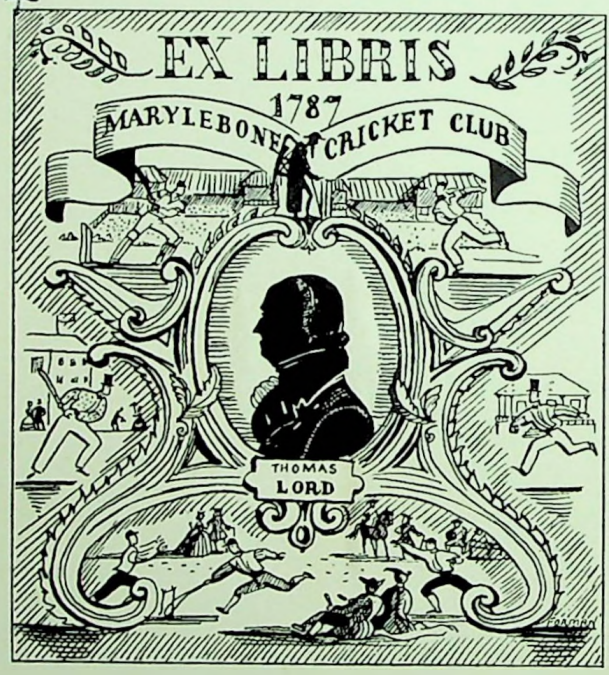
R. S. RAIT KERR

with a foreword by

SIR NORMAN BIRKETT



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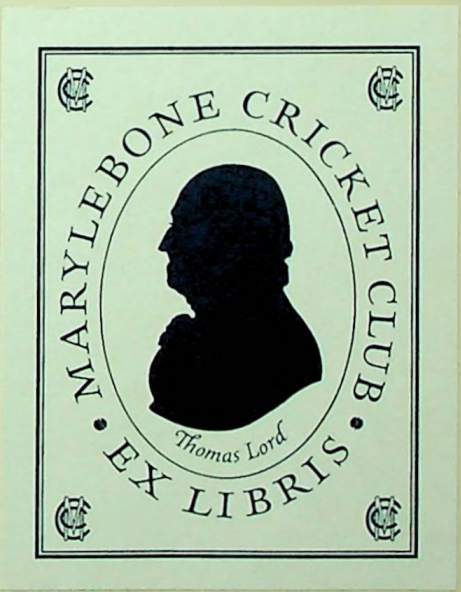


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Presented to the M.C.C. April 1950

J. S. Raitt-Kerr.

Copy containing a few m.s. alterations noted for any second edition



THE LAWS OF CRICKET

Their History and Growth

For

boo



"HONEST WILL" CALDECOURT, UMPIRE
from a drawing and lithograph by J. C. Anderson, 1852

THE LAWS OF CRICKET

THEIR HISTORY AND GROWTH

by

R. S. RAIT KERR

C.B.E., D.S.O., M.C.

With a Foreword by the Rt. Hon.
SIR NORMAN BIRKETT



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FOREWORD

by Sir Norman Birkett

Col. Rait Kerr has invited me to write a short Foreword to his book on the Laws of Cricket, and I am deeply sensible of the honour he confers on me by so doing. It is customary for a Foreword to be written by an acknowledged authority on the subject matter of the book, who commends the author and his work to the reading public. Authorities on the Laws of Cricket are not too easy to find, and if there be such, I am quite sure that I have no place in their company; but having read this book with unusual pleasure, I can and do commend the author and his work with the greatest sincerity. Col. Rait Kerr is the present Secretary of the M.C.C., and that very great authority, Sir Pelham Warner, has described him as the ablest Secretary the M.C.C. has ever possessed, and when paying that high tribute, added the significant words "and you cannot stump him on the laws of cricket." This book makes the truth of that saying abundantly plain by the remarkable knowledge displayed on every page. Col. Rait Kerr has written a most scholarly and authoritative treatise on the Laws of Cricket, the result of wide reading and careful study over many years, and it may fairly claim to be a piece of thoughtful and original research in fields where few dare venture.

Cricket, more than any other game perhaps, has attracted a great host of writers in every age, and the literature of cricket is as rich and varied as any to be found in other departments of our national life. I am familiar with some of it, but Col. Rait Kerr is familiar with it all. Exercising the most praiseworthy restraint, he has confined himself to what is strictly relevant to his immediate theme. For until this book appeared, there was no book in all the literature of cricket that was devoted solely to the development of the Laws of Cricket, and certainly no book that related the growth of the Laws and their formulation to the background of circumstance out of which the Laws emerged. Not that literature is absent from these pages, and

the informed and stored mind of the author is apparent in every line. He discusses at some length the Code of Laws of 1744 and casts doubt on the assertion of an earlier historian that the Code was the result of a match played in that year on the Artillery Ground between Kent and an All England Eleven. But that match has at least one other claim to remembrance, for one James Love described it in "Cricket: an Heroic poem" and set a standard in rhapsody that the mere writer of a Foreword finds it hard to sustain.

> Hail Cricket! glorious, manly, British game!
> First of all Sports! be first alike in Fame!
> To my fir'd soul thy busy transports bring
> That I may feel thy Raptures while I sing. . . .

But Col. Rait Kerr, avoiding such rhapsodies, reprints the Latin verses of William Goldwin of 1706 because of the light they shed on the evolution of the game, and the conditions prevailing before the Code of 1744. It appears from Goldwin that the method of resolving disputes in those days was not by appealing to an Umpire clothed with absolute power to interpret fixed laws, but by the following method: "Now some grey veteran intercedes, and wins their love, the while he pleads . . . yet rich is he in cricket lore, and proves that they need strive no more." It is an engaging and attractive picture, but it is perhaps as well that in these modern days Umpires are officially appointed who need not trouble overmuch about winning the love of anybody; for love in such circumstances is notoriously hard to win. But rivalling Goldwin's verses in sheer interest are the Articles of Agreement made between His Grace the Duke of Richmond and Mr. Broderick on the July 11th, 1727, referred to by Col. Rait Kerr. Two cricket matches were to be played, one in Sussex and one in Surrey, and the laws governing the two matches are set out in sixteen Articles in fairly minute detail. It is not too much to say that this document is of quite fascinating interest when considering the period before 1774. Here there is explicit provision for two Umpires to be appointed with the somewhat severe addition "that if any of the Gamesters shall speak or give their opinion on any point of the game they are to be turned out and voided in the match." For myself, I await with interest the comments of the learned on these Articles, particularly the third Article—"A ball caught, cloathed or not cloathed, the Striker is out." For the ball in Goldwin's verses

of 1706 was described as leather-covered, and it was almost certainly dyed red and stuffed with hemp or hair. Was this Article then the origin of the phrase "knocking the cover off the ball," or did it merely refer to the fieldsman making the catch when hugging the ball to his clothing?

It is indeed fortunate that these Articles have been preserved for more than two hundred years, emphasising as they do the antiquity of the game.

It is frequently emphasised, too, that Cricket is peculiarly and specially English, and Col. Rait Kerr has set out the famous passage from John Derrick, Gent, who "aged fifty-nine, one of the Queen's Coroners for the County" asserted that when a "scholler in the free school at Guldeford [in the reign of Henry VIII] he did play at creckett and other plaies." Cricket is plainly ancient and plainly English, and I am content to have it so. I find myself quite unmoved by the profound researches into the origins of the game which seek to give a foreign flavour to its early beginnings. Andrew Lang has said the last word on this topic, and I concur in his wise saying—"Cricket ought to be to English boys what Habeas Corpus is to Englishmen, as Mr. Hughes says in *Tom Brown*."

And the game of Cricket is essentially English in this: that its Laws developed, as did the English Common Law, in accordance with the needs and requirements of the particular age.

Col. Rait Kerr takes the reader through more than two hundred years of cricket history, and the most fascinating and enthralling history it is. No man can read it without being conscious of the years of unselfish labour that have gone to the making of this book, and no man can put it down without feeling that his knowledge of the game and his love for it have been immensely deepened and intensified. Let nobody suppose for a moment that a history of the Laws of Cricket must necessarily be dull reading. The Common Law of England is the heritage of the English-speaking world, and its history is one of the most absorbing interest. The same holds true of the history of the Laws of Cricket. The ordinary watcher of cricket at Lord's is not concerned with the Laws of Cricket, save when some Captain makes a manifest error as to the declaration of the innings or the like. The three stumps with the two bails upon them, for example, seem the most ordinary and natural things in the world. But the virtue of this book is that

no man who reads it can ever again be an ordinary watcher at Lord's. The question of the stumps and the width of the bat become matters of surpassing interest. When was the third stump introduced and why? When was the law laid down governing the width of the bat, and in what circumstances? Questions of this kind are discussed by Col. Rait Kerr with a wealth of learning and reference. It appears that one day an ingenious gentleman named White of Ryegate brought a bat to the match between Hambledon and Chertsey, which being of the width of the stumps completely protected the wicket from the bowler. This was in 1771, and as the match was for £50 a side, the Hambledon men took the matter in hand and a law was passed limiting the width of the bat to four and a quarter inches. Nyren describes the unusual occurrence, which he perfectly recollected. It was Nyren, too, who described the match on the Artillery Ground in 1775 which resulted in the introduction of the third stump. Small was the last man in and Lumpy was the bowler. On several occasions the deliveries of Lumpy went right through Small's stumps, and it was felt to be a hard thing that the best and straightest balls should be thus sacrificed, so the third stump was brought in to redress the balance. It was the method of the Common Law in action. All the matters affecting the Laws of Cricket are dealt with by Col. Rait Kerr in the most entertaining and erudite fashion. The great controversies of the past are reviewed—the height of the bowler's arm, the L.B.W. rules, the definitions of "Wides" and "No Balls," and a score of others—and the growth of the Laws is related to the changing needs of different ages. Col. Rait Kerr has learnt the first essential of all attempts at description that it should be orderly, and nothing could exceed the skill of this most orderly presentation. Each period of the Law's development is clearly defined, and all the facts relevant to the particular period are marshalled with accuracy and ease. The result is a book which is easy to read despite the long history to be unfolded, and a book which will surely be regarded as one of the most valuable contributions to cricket literature that has appeared for many years; and in its own sphere it is unique.

Lovers of cricket all the world over will be grateful to Col. Rait Kerr, for this book sets the seal upon his occupancy of the high position he holds in the world of cricket. The M.C.C. exists to foster the true spirit of the game wherever it is played; it is

always ready to advise, to guide, and to help; and it must be the deepest satisfaction to all those who desire the continuance of the high traditions of Cricket and the M.C.C. that so wise, so understanding and so learned a Secretary is in charge. I hope and believe that this book will have a wide circulation and fulfil the purpose of the author in writing it. It will certainly give the highest form of pleasure and much instruction to those who read it.

NORMAN BIRKETT

To all those many Umpires who throughout the history of the Noble and Manly Game have interpreted its Laws to the incalculable benefit of Cricket, and to the great satisfaction of the Players

CONTENTS

Chapter		*Page*
1	The Early Days of Cricket	1
2	The Pre-Victorian Era The Hambledon Period, 1744 to 1787 The Early Marylebone Period, 1787 to 1835	17
3	The Middle Marylebone Period, 1835 to 1884	31
4	The Modern Period, 1884 to 1947	42
5	The Preparation of the 1947 Code	58
6	The Growth of the Laws of Cricket	65

APPENDICES

I	The Laws of 1755	91
II	The Laws of 1947	99
III	A Classified List of Editions of the Laws of Cricket Published between 1744 and 1835	114

ILLUSTRATIONS

The Umpire	*frontispiece*
Articles of Agreement, 1727	*facing page* 10
Handkerchief with Laws, *c.* 1744	11
Broadsheet of the Laws, 1820	*page* 25
Cricket in the Artillery Ground	*facing page* 32
Minute of the Hambledon Players, 1771	33
Handkerchief with Laws, *c.* 1785	33
Broadsheet of the Laws, 1809	48
The Scorer	49
The Laws of 1755	Appendix I

The Articles of Agreement, 1727, are reproduced from a photograph kindly lent by Dr. H. F. Squire, and used by permission of the Duke of Richmond and Gordon. The 1744 Handkerchief and the Hambledon Minute are included by the courtesy of Mr. J. W. Goldman, and the remaining illustrations by permission of the Marylebone Cricket Club.

INTRODUCTION

MANY writers have devoted their life's work to the study of the traditions and history of Cricket, with the result that no English game is more generously endowed with a literature of its own. The readers of the cricket world play an important part in maintaining interest in the great traditions of a great game, and it is a tragedy that so often they find it difficult to acquire either the classics or the essential historical works of men like William Denison, Rev. James Pycroft, Arthur Haygarth, F. S. Ashley-Cooper, P. F. Thomas and G. B. Buckley—to mention but a few.

The excuse for this publication is twofold—firstly that, to the best of my knowledge, no book dealing solely with the building up of the Laws of Cricket has been previously attempted, and secondly that, by shamelessly drawing on the works of the writers referred to, I am able to provide the setting in which the legislation of the game developed, and perhaps to induce in my readers a desire for wider and deeper reading.

In his last published pamphlet P. F. Thomas[1] concluded his erudite historical analysis with the words, "Good luck to anybody who can add more material, score out the unsuspected inaccuracies, and mould the whole together more consistently," and, to some degree, it is in answer to his challenge that my contribution is offered.

Amongst other duties which fall to him, a Secretary of the Marylebone Cricket Club acts as advisor on points arising from the Laws of Cricket, not only to the various committees with which he is associated, but also to the countless cricketers, cricket lovers and cricket organisations who from time to time seek enlightment on such matters. On my appointment to the post, my own knowledge of the Laws was that of the normal club

[1] Percy Francis Thomas, writing under the pseudonym of "H.P.-T.," published between 1923 and 1928 a remarkable series of pamphlets dealing with the history of cricket in greater detail than any writer had previously attempted. Though, on occasion, one may disagree with his conclusions, there is no doubt of the abiding value of his work.

Cricket's Cradle, 1923 — *Old-Time Cricket*, 1924 — *More Old Cricket*, 1926
Early Cricket, 1923 — *Cricket's Prime*, 1925 — *Cricket in the Weald*, 1928.

cricketer, and far too superficial to enable me to deal satisfactorily with the constant stream of enquiries reaching Lord's.

Education was clearly indicated, and for this the material at my disposal was indeed ample, ranging as it did from writings, either contemporary or based on first-hand information received from old players, to the more recent historical researches of the writers already mentioned. In addition of course I was fortunate in having easy access to the archives of the M.C.C. which date from 1826.

Although R. H. Mallett had published, in the 1930's, some valuable papers about the Laws of Cricket, for the most part information about them was widely scattered, and when found it was often difficult to distinguish between what was truly authentic and what was not. With the distinguished exception of the remarkable and painstaking work of Thomas, historical records sadly lacked annotations, making the task of checking dates and facts a difficult one. Since Thomas, perforce, depended mainly on the statements of earlier writers, his own thoroughness did not carry the matter much further.

It was not long before I had reason to suspect that established conclusions on certain changes in the Laws had been based on versions which were themselves of doubtful reliability; at the time our historians had no other sources of evidence available, and they must not be criticised for using the best that had been traced. The effect of this is most noticeable between 1774 and 1835, a period which saw the issue of a great number of editions of the Laws, many of which are quite unreliable either because they are undated, or because they were edited in an extremely crude manner—Lambert's *Guides* published between 1816 and 1828 provide a good example of this type of publication which has unfortunately resulted in wrong or differing dates being ascribed to important changes in the Laws, at a time when such changes were of special interest.

An example of the danger of this pitfall is provided by Thomas, whose conclusions on the changes in the size of the Wicket, based on codes now known to be unreliable, and given in *Cricket in the Weald*, are not confirmed. Again, a reference to that classic *The Young Cricketer's Tutor* by Nyren (1833) would suggest that the Laws quoted as "according with the Revision of them by the Mary-le-Bone Club in 1830" would be reliable; a cursory inspection of them, however, discloses that they are undeniably bastard

in many respects, and quite unreliable for the purpose of historical research.

My task therefore was to seek out as many editions of the Laws as possible, and to examine them all for reliability; this investigation, which had never previously been undertaken, has proved profitable, since it led directly to the discovery of hitherto unknown official issues of the Laws in 1811, 1816, 1820, 1823, and 1830—a discovery which has served to span a most difficult gap previously only covered by the unreliable Lambert, and which has enabled new dates to be ascribed to many changes in the Laws. The result of this research is given in Chapter 6 and Appendix III —the former provides a full chronology of the changes in the Laws made between 1744 and 1947, and the latter a bibliography of over fifty editions of the Laws published between 1750 and 1835, classified for reliability. Other editions almost certainly exist, and there should now be little difficulty in establishing their status. Should they prove to be reliable, they may well help to provide actual dates for changes still only known within narrow limits.

Chapters 1 to 5 provide the setting for the study of the development of the game and its Laws throughout its long history; this development follows naturally not only from advances in the technique of the players, and from the conditions under which cricket has grown to man's estate, but also from the very remarkable spread of the game across the face of the world.

In tune with the development of the game itself, we find that its constitutional government, starting from that small body of players who made use of the Artillery Ground, in the early eighteenth century, grew up under the influence of Hambledon until that Club surrendered its prestige to the M.C.C. From then on we can trace its further evolution against the background of controversial issues which in the nineteenth century were the cause of so much discussion and schism, and which at times endangered the very position of the M.C.C.

I have already acknowledged the debt that Cricket owes to its historians, and I must add my own particular thanks to Mr. G. B. Buckley, whose presentation of the results of his immense research has rendered his books quite indispensable.[1] To Dr. H. F.

[1] G. B. Buckley in *Fresh Light on 18th Century Cricket*, 1935, and *Fresh Light on Pre-Victorian Cricket*, 1937, published the results of his life's work of seeking out contemporary Press notices which had appeared during the period 1697 to 1837. The arrangement and content of these books make them particularly valuable.

Squire is due credit for having brought to light the Richmond Articles (*vide* Chapter 1) during his recent research into early Sussex cricket as an outstanding document in the history of the game. Mr. E. R. Wilson and Mr. H. S. Altham have both given up more time than they could reasonably afford to help me over difficulties, and I am deeply indebted to the M.C.C. for permitting reference to the archives of the Club, and for allowing material in the M.C.C. Collections to be used for some of the illustrations.

My warmest thanks are due also to Sir Norman Birkett for giving so much thought and time to his delightful Foreword, and to Mr. J. W. Goldman for placing some of his valuable books at my disposal, and for permission to reproduce his copy of Ware's handkerchief and the Hambledon Minute of 1771 —both of which are gems in any collection of cricket relics.

I had hoped at one time to attempt a more ambitious work, but at present this is not possible. This sketch of the evolution of the game during the past 200 years only summarises a task which has been spread over twelve years—it is necessarily incomplete, and almost certainly contains errors for which I hasten to apologise. It is offered in the hope that readers may be able to bring to light fresh evidence to complete the essential framework for future study of the history of Cricket.

Chapter One

THE EARLY DAYS OF CRICKET

In any study of the Laws of Cricket there are two sharply defined periods—from the earliest days when the game was probably one for boys, up to about 1750 when the formation of the Hambledon Club led to a great advance in the science of the game, and then from that date up to the present day. The former period may be termed the dark ages of Cricket history during which the rules under which the game was played are largely a matter of surmise, for, as we shall see, the earliest Laws that have come down to us are those of about 1744; before that year historians are dependent on press notices of a somewhat factual type, on a very little descriptive writing, and on a considerable amount of intelligent and well-reasoned guess-work.

It has always been accepted that the game grew up as a simple village pastime in the Weald of Kent, Surrey and Sussex; Thomas more than any other writer has shed light on its development since the days of 1550 when John Derrick with "diuerse of his fellowes did runne and play at Creckett" on a "parcell of land" near the "Free Schoole of Guldeford." (Extract from the Book of Court of Guildford for the year 1598.)

Thomas dissected the 1744 Laws, and by discarding words which would hardly have been in current use amongst the villagers of the Weald during the seventeenth century evolved a code which may well have governed the conduct of the village game of the period. Though no doubt each district had its own variations on points of detail, the main structure of the game must owe its establishment to this era.

Various causes delayed the advent of big cricket. In the early part of the seventeenth century the aristocracy had many alternative pursuits to serve as an outlet for the gambling spirit of the time. During their enforced retreat to their country seats in the Commonwealth days, however, village cricket began to serve as a medium for playing for stakes, and there is little doubt that this

money interest rapidly became a factor in the development of the game from what it was before—just a pastime for the countrymen in the villages of the Weald. In village and the lesser country matches the stakes were often insignificant—sometimes half a crown for each player, and frequently the stakes were not money ones at all, but bearskin gloves, gold- or silver-laced caps, dimity breeches or striped coloured waistcoats. It would be wrong to suggest that in every class of cricket the love of the game as such was by any means lessened by the money interest attached to it, though this certainly gave impetus to its spread from its place of birth.

After the Restoration the Nobility and Gentry of the day brought cricket back with them to London, where it was established at the Artillery Ground in Finsbury Fields, which even at that time was enclosed by a high brick wall. In October 1689 the Honourable Artillery Company banned the playing of games on their property, of which Howe wrote, "This field, and two others adjoining, had been infectious and very grievous to the city and to passengers, who by all means endeavoured to shun those fields as loathsome both to sight and smell." This however does not seem to have prevented its use for cricket, and long before 1744 the ground superintendent, George Smith, was charging sums varying between twopence and sixpence for admission.

This ground in particular became the scene of the Grand Matches, which were played for considerable stakes, and which quite naturally required the drawing up of "Articles of Agreement" to eliminate the risk of much disputing. Buckley has told us much about these Articles, which he has traced back as far as 1722, and it is clear that they were mainly concerned with the financial arrangements of a match, but rarely referring to playing conditions except on such points as might require co-ordination owing to some difference between local custom. Dr. H. F. Squire, during recent research into early cricket in Sussex, has found in the archives of the Duke of Richmond and Gordon the original Articles of Agreement dated July 11th, 1727, for two matches to be played between teams collected by the then Duke of Richmond and a Mr. Broderick. By the courtesy of the Duke of Richmond these Articles are reproduced in the plate facing page 8, and it will be seen that while many of them refer to points connected with the conduct of the game, they are not by any

means a complete Code. It is difficult to resist the conclusion that such Articles were used merely to supplement Laws generally accepted for common use.

If the Richmond Articles are examined from this angle, it will be seen that the special conditions appear to divide themselves into those which provide for some departure from the Laws of the day, and those which are merely supplementary in character. Articles 2, 5, 9 and 15 come into the first category. It is interesting to find that at this period under the usual Laws the striker could not be out from a catch taken behind the wicket; the reference to a twenty-three-yard pitch is surprising, and it may have been an experimental departure from the usual length, which was of course the agricultural chain; the provisions regarding substitutes, and throwing down the wicket appear to be modifications introduced for the occasion.

Articles 3, 4, 11 and 14 appear merely to cover supplementary points which otherwise might have given rise to dispute. The first of these may have been necessary owing to the liability of the early leather ball to become separated from its cover, or alternatively it may have been the forerunner of the present-day provision that the striker is out "caught" if the ball "be hugged to the body of the catcher, or be accidentally lodged in his dress." Article 4 anticipates a principle which was not included in the Laws until 1788; the rigid instruction to establish the sole authority of the umpires may well be a reflection on the prevalent customs of the day; from Article 14 we may infer that the Popping crease at this date could not have been taken into general use—the provisions of this Article are discussed more fully later.

Light is thrown on the general form of the game by some Latin verses written by William Goldwin, and published in *Musae Juveniles* in March 1706. The author had been a Colleger at Eton, and a scholar of King's College, Cambridge, and must have written the poem about the close of his undergraduate days. These verses, with an English translation by H. A. Perry, appeared over 200 years later in *Etoniana*; they were republished by Altham in his *History*, and by Thomas, with his own translation, in *Early Cricket*. Since this piece of descriptive writing sheds very considerable light on the evolution of the game and its laws, it is reprinted here in full with Perry's translation—this latter by the kind permission of the Editor of *Etoniana*.

IN CERTAMEN PILÆ
Anglice, A Cricket-Match
by William Goldwin, 1706
with a translation by
H. A. Perry, 14 November, 1922

Vere novo, cum temperies liquidissima cœli
Arridet, suadetque virentis gratia terræ
Veloces agitare pedes super æquora Campi;
Lecta cohors juvenum, baculis armata repandis
Quos habiles ludo Manus ingeniosa polivit,
In Campum descendit ovans; sua gloria cuique.
Hic Magis aptus humum celeri transmittere planta,
Et vigilante oculo variis discursibus omnes
Ire redire vias; longe torquere per auras
Doctior ille pilam, atque adversos rumpere ventos;
Tertius arte valet quo non præstantior alter
Per fola plana *Orbem* dextræ libramine justo.
Fundere, qui rapido cursu præverteret ictum.

'Tis early Spring, the lucid air
and smiling Skies make all things fair:
green Nature bids our feet, with speed,
disport them on the level mead.
I see a chosen company
with curving bats armed gallantly,
(smoothed by deft hands for use)—and lo!
with shouts into the field they go.
each boasts his own peculiar grace,
this skims the ground, supreme in pace,
hawk-eyed the moment's need to spy,
and to and fro unerring fly.
that best can hurl the ball afar
and burst the wind's opposing bar;
that other fears no rival's skill,
when, o'er the even turf, his will
sends forth a poisèd sphere, too fleet
to reck the batsman's answering beat.

Adventum excipiunt *Manus Adversaria* lætis
Alloquiis nectuntque moras; mox jurgia miscent
Civilesque iras, quod vult imponere ludo
Quisque suas leges. *Nestor*, cui cana senectus

the friendly foe's loud-voiced array
greets their approach, then comes delay,
then quarrels rife, while all exclaim
and all would lord it o'er the game.
now some grey veteran intercedes,
and wins their love, the while he pleads:

Conciliat cultum turbæ veniamque loquendi,
Se densæ immiscens plebi vice fungitur æqui
Judicis, et quanquam positis campestribus armis
Jamdudum indulsit senio, non immemor artis
Proponit justas leges, et temperat iras.

a Daniel come to judgement, he to all around speaks equity.
though now his arms be laid aside,
and marred by years his early pride,
yet rich is he in cricket lore,
and proves that they need strive no more.

Deinde locum signant, qua se diffundit in æquor
Plana superficies, Hinc illinc partibus æque
Oppositis bifido Surgentes vertice furcæ
Erectas modicum quas distinet intervallum
Infiguntur humo; Tum virgula ponitur alba
Virgula, quæ dubii certaminis alea pendet,
Et bene defendi poscit: *Coriaceus Orbis*
Vi ruit infesta, quem si fortuna Maligna
Dirigit in rectum, subversaque Machina fulcris
Abripitur, cedas positis inglorius armis.

the Lists are set where, (happy chance!)
the meadow yields a smooth expanse;
opposed, on either hand, appear
twin rods that forkèd heads uprear,
with ends set firmly in the green,
(nor wide the middle space between),
and next a milk-white Bail is laid
from fork to fork, whereby is swayed
the dubious issue of the fight,
and all must guard it with their might.
the Leathern Orb speeds forth like fate,
and should its destined line be straight
and raze the bail's support, defeat
ensues and sorrowful retreat.

Stant *Moderatores* bini stationibus aptis
Fustibus innixi, quos certo attingere pulsu
Lex jubet, aut operam cursus perdemus inanem.

each at his wicket, near at hand,
propped on his staff, the Umpires stand,
the runner's bat must touch their pale,
or else the run will nought avail.

Parte alia, visus qua libera copia detur,
Parvo in colle sedent duo pectora fida, parata
Cultellis numerum crescentem incidere ligno.

on a low mound, whence clear the view,
repose a trusty pair and true:
their simple task, with ready blade,
notches to cut, as runs are made.

Tum Certatores digitis capita æqua recensent
Ordine dispositi: Medias it nummus in auras

the players now ranged out at length,
two sides are picked, of equal strength.
a Coin goes up, now, Fortune, say,

Arbiter, et primas partes decernit agendas
Aut his, aut illis. Nondum discrimine cœpto
Stant in procinctu juvenes; dum cautior ille,
Mittere cui data cura pilam, rursusque remissam
Effugio prohibere, Manu alterutraque tenaci
Excipere attactam, præscripta ad Munia jussit.
En! Quali studio sese disponit! Ut acres
Excubias agitat circum diffusa juventus
Expectans ludi Monitum, trepidantiaque haurit
Corda pavor pulsans, famæque arrecta cupido.

who first shall bat, or we, or they!
ere yet the brave encounter start,
each youth stands ready for his part.
yet graver cares must him befall,
whose office is to bowl the ball,
then stop its sharp return, and hold
it fast, by either hand controlled.
while others to their work he sends,
how busy he to gain his ends!
around him spreads the brisk array,
and waits the word that heralds "Play."

Et jam dulce paratur opus: Par nobile primum
Heroum certamen init, duo fulmina ludi;
Inde, dato signo, pila lubrica viribus acta
Carcere prona fugit, volitansque per æquora summa
Radit iter rapidum: Sese *Hostis* poplite flexo
Inclinat, cita currentis vestigia lustrans;
Si modo subsultet, tum certum assurgit in ictum
Brachia vi torquens celeri, longeque propellit
Clangentem sphæram. Superas volat illa per auras
Continuo stridore ruens, atque æthera findit.

the Issue's joined, two chiefs of name
go forth, both heroes of the game.
the word is given, and, urged with might,
speeds the greased ball in level flight,
and o'er the grassy surface sweeps;
with bended knee the batsman keeps
a forward stance, to watch its way
and mark it rise, then *sans* delay,
his arms descend with lightning fall,
to smite again the ringing ball;
and, ringing on, sublime it flies
and disappears into the Skies.

At cœla observans Catus *Explorator* in alto
Insidias parat, erectis palmisque cadentem
Excipit exultans, dextraque retorquet ovanti.

meanwhile some wary Scout afield
brings craft to make the victor yield,
views the descent with upward eyes,
till his stretched hands secure the prize;
then gaily throws it up once more,

Hinc lætus sequitur clamor, dolor obruit illos
Mœrentes tacite casum infelicis Amici;
Grande malum! Ast uno avulso non deficit alter.
Æmulus hic laudum furiisque ultricibus actus
Ingreditur scenam, et damnum reparare minatur:
Successum Dea dira negat: Vix terque quaterque
Cursum *Orbis* peragit, vix dum tria sensit ab hoste
Verbera, præcipiti cum protenus impete missa
Virgam sede levem rapit, eluditque Minantem.
Ille indignanti vultu sua tela reponit
Atque Deos atque astra vocans crudelia, donec
Succurrens partes implerit proximus hæres,
Qui jam languentem causæ socialis honorem
Instaurare velit: sed et his quoque numine lævo
Orditur lusum; nam dum cursusque recursusque
Alternos iterat, Vestigia lubrica ponens
Labitur infelix, pronus metamque sub ipsam
Procumbit; tremefacta gemit sub pondere tellus
Ingenti, risuque exultat rustica turba.
Quemque manent sua fata, trahit suus exitus omnes
Ah! Nimium properans: Seu fors, sive artis egestas
Nisibus invidit; retro sublapsa refertur
Spes omnis juvenum vultusque et corda relanguent.

cheered by his friends' exultant roar.
but silent bows the foeman's head,
in anguish for a comrade sped.
woe worth the day! yet, eager still,
another comes the breach to fill.
fired with high hopes, his noble heat
essays to overwhelm defeat.
yet Fortune frowns, the bowler's force
four times accomplishes the course,
and thrice the batsman plays his part.
then, headlong flung with desperate art,
the ball prevents the bat, and shears
the light bail rudely from its piers.
the Victim, reddening with dismay,
shoulders his bat and walks away,
mourning his luck and low estate,
until the coming of his mate.
he, to a sinking banner true,
renews a fray he soon shall rue.
anon, between the wickets pent,
on runs this way and that intent,
he slips, he falls, unhappy soul!
upon the threshold of his goal,
flat on the earth, with sounding thwack,
while jeers aloud the rustic pack.
to each his innings, and its end
that comes too soon our case to mend;
for, be it *Fate*, or lack of Skill,
our efforts are but failures still;
back flows the current of success,
as downcast looks and moods confess.

Adversum auspiciis melioribus agmen arenam

'neath happier stars, the aspiring foe

Intrant, perpetuisque fatigant ictibus Orbem;
Fervet opus; manat toto de corpore sudor;
Mox ubi ludendi processerit ordo tenore
Felici, litemque unus discriminat ictus,
Impete pulsa pila in cœli sublimia templa
Provehitur rapiente Noto, lusumque coronat;
Concertata diu Victoria concrepat alis,
Et complet clamore polum fremituque secundo.

hot is the pace, each brow bedewed,
with linkèd triumphs oft renewed
waxes the strife, but one notch more,
and mastery will crown the score.
'tis done! the stricken sphere ascends
heavenwards, on airs the South Wind lends:
and, ended now the long debate,
Dame Victory claps her wings, elate,
and makes the Sky with cheers articulate.

If Goldwin's description is analysed it will be seen that he has written of a game which might well have been played under the 1755 Laws—Umpires, notchers, two-stump wicket with bail, leather ball are all there. The conduct of the game included tossing for innings, the call of "Play," the four-ball over, dismissals by catching and running out, and perhaps most significant of all, in two places Goldwin refers to "Laws." It really appears that there was very little change in the shape of the game between 1706 and the time when there is a written code of the Laws to which we can refer, and it is quite likely that Goldwin has in effect described for us the Wealden game of the seventeenth century.

Both Lord Harris in his Foreword to Altham's *History of Cricket*, and Thomas have questioned the accuracy of Goldwin's observation on one point. In lines 34 and 35 of his verses the words "quos certo attingere pulsu lex jubet," have been translated by Perry as "the runner's bat must touch their pale, or else the run will nought avail." His critics have maintained that the existence of the Popping Crease would render this action superfluous, but now the 14th clause in the Richmond Articles entirely substantiates Goldwin's description. It provides at last an explanation for the custom of the Umpires standing very close to the wicket in the position of leg slip, which continued long after the general introduction of the Popping Crease (*vide* plate facing

page 8). The custom of the umpires carrying bats, so common even to-day in schoolboy cricket, may possibly be indirectly connected with this old rule.

These Articles of Agreement indeed rank second only to Goldwin's verses in the historical records of Cricket, and Dr. Squire is to be congratulated in bringing to light a document which helps to span the gap between 1706 and 1744.[1]

THE 1744 AND OTHER EARLY CODES

The earliest version of the Laws which has come down to us is commonly referred to as the Code of 1744 though no small degree of unnecessary mystery has been allowed to cloud this issue. It is such an important milestone that I feel fully justified in putting on record the somewhat tiresome research which has satisfied me that the claim is not unfounded.

It is generally assumed by historians that the Laws of Cricket, if not adopted for the first time, were at least redrafted in 1744; the further I looked into the matter, the more my doubts grew, and before giving my verdict it is necessary to collate and comment on the many statements on the subject which some very eminent men have made from time to time.

A. Haygarth in 1862

As Editor of *Scores and Biographies*, and the first thorough historian of the game, it is significant that he ascribes no date to the two versions of the earliest Laws given in Volume I, and nowhere does he mention a 1744 code.

Comment: It is certain that Haygarth would have given a date if he had been in a position to do so. Nearly every later writer has focused attention on the first version of the old Laws he quoted, as having been transcribed from an undated manuscript. Haygarth's second version has passed unnoticed, although in fact, as will be made clear later, it has every evidence of being the more authentic, and therefore the more important of the two.

A. J. Gaston in 1892

In a Bibliography, contributed to *Wisden* of 1892, he makes the following entry under the year "1743"—"Possibly the first

[1] These Articles were first reprinted in *The Field* of January 6th, 1912, and it is remarkable that historians had overlooked their importance until Dr. Squire published *Henfield Cricket and its Sussex Cradle* in 1949.

pamphlet on cricket was issued in 1743, containing 'The Laws of the Game' and a folding plate depicting the players, a copy of which is in the possession of Mr. H. Perkins, of the M.C.C. Club, while a few years ago, in collating some early numbers of the *New Universal Review* for the year 1752, the writer came across the very same plate, and the Laws as settled by the Cricket Club in 1744, at the Artillery Ground, London, the representation of the game being engraved from the paintings in Vauxhall Gardens."

Comment: Gaston clearly never appreciated the value of his discovery of the 1744 Laws in *The New Universal Magazine*—the *Review* he refers to never existed—and it was left to Ashley-Cooper to rediscover them eight years later. No other collector has ever suggested the existence of a 1743 pamphlet—Perkins was Secretary of the M.C.C. at the time, and there is no trace of his leaving any such book behind him at Lord's. The 1743 print is the well-known engraving by Benoist of Hayman's picture,[1] and to the best of my knowledge has no association with the Laws of Cricket. There is however another engraving of the same picture drawn by B. Cole in 1752 for the number of *The New Universal Magazine* which contained the 1744 Laws. It seems probable that during a visit to Lord's Gaston was shown the Benoist engraving of 1743, and a booklet of the Laws of a later date, and confused the two. To him however is clearly due the credit of finding the first type-set version of the Laws.

(Vide plate facing page 32)

A. D. Taylor in 1900

In a chronology in *Sussex Cricket in the Olden Time*, he makes the following entry under "1744"—"The Laws of Cricket were revised on February 25th."

Comment: No other writer supports this very definite statement. Taylor himself does not later make any reference to February 25th, 1774, on which date it is known that the Laws were revised at the Star and Garter. This entry is very suspicious.

F. S. Ashley-Cooper in 1900

In a Chronology which appeared in *Cricket*, 1900, Ashley-Cooper states that the year 1744 was important since it was then that "the Laws of the game were drawn up by the noblemen and

[1] Francis Hayman's oil painting of "Cricket in the Artillery Ground" was commissioned for the Vauxhall Gardens *c.* 1740. It shows a game of cricket in progress—the wicket-keeper is believed to be Hogarth.

Articles of Agreement Indented made & Concluded between His Grace the Duke of Richmond & Mr Broderick (for two Cricket Matches) concluded the Eleventh of July 1727.

Imprimis: It is by the aforesaid Parties agreed that the first Match shall be played some day of this Instant July in the County of Surry; the Place to be named by Mr Broderick; the second Match to be played in August next in the County of Sussex, the Place to be named by the Duke of Richmond.

2d: That the Wickets shall be pitched in a Fair & even Place, at twenty two Yards distance from each other.

3d: A Ball caught & cleathed or not cleathed the Striker is out.

4th When a Ball is caught out the Striker counts nothing.

5th Catching out behind the Wicket allowed.

6th That it be Lawfull for the Duke of Richmond to choose any Gamesters who have played in either of the two last Matches with Mr William Gage; & that it be Lawfull for Mr Broderick to choose any Gamesters within three Miles of Peppyrharo, provided they actually played there last Cricket Day.

7th: that twelve Gamesters shall play on each side.

8th: that the Duke of Richmond & Mr Broderick shall determine the Ball or Balls to be played with.

9th: if any of the Gamesters shall be taken Lame or sick after the Match is begun; their Places may be supplied by any one there conformably to the 7th Article, or in case that can not be done, the other side shall be obliged to leave out one of their Gamesters whomsoever they please.

10th: that each Match shall be for twelve Guineas of each side, between the Duke & Mr Broderick.

11th: that there shall be one Umpire of each side; & that if any of the Gamesters shall speak or give their Opinion on any Point of the Game, they are to be turned out & voided in the Match; this not to extend to the Duke of Richmond & Mr Broderick.

12th If any Doubt or Dispute arises on any of the aforesaid Articles or whatever else is not settled therein, it shall be determined by the Duke of Richmond & Mr Broderick on their Honours; by whom the Umpires are likewise to be determined on any Difference between them.

13th The Duke of Richmonds Umpire shall pitch the Wicket when they play in Surrey; & Mr Brodericks when they play in Surry; & each of them shall be obliged to conform themself strictly to the Agreements contained in the second Article.

14th The Batt Men for every One they count are to touch the Umpires Stick.

15th that it ~~shall not be Lawfull~~ to fling down the Wicket & that no Player shall be deemed out by any Wicket put down unless with the Ball in Hand.

16th that both the Matches shall be played upon, and determined By, these Articles.

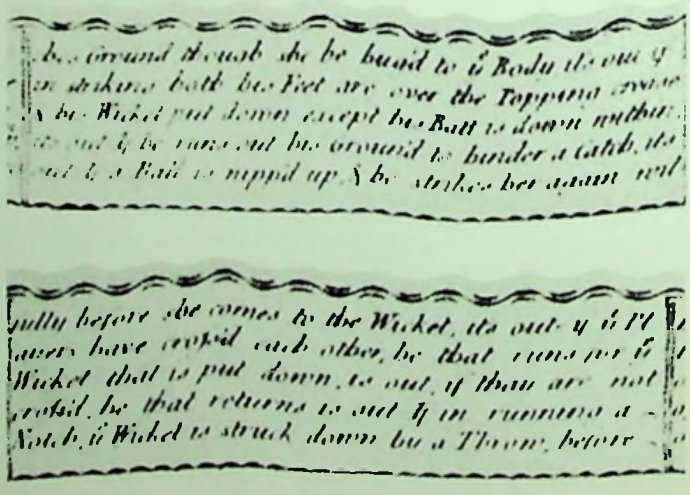
Richmond.

A. Broderick.

Articles of Agreement for two cricket matches between the 2nd Duke of Richmond and Mr. Broderick, 1727 Je



Linen handkerchief c. 1744, giving the earliest printed version of the Laws
The scene is an adaptation of a painting by Francis Hayman in the M.C.C. collection



Enlarged panels of the 1744 handkerchief, with wording typical of the period

gentlemen who frequented the Artillery Ground." He then quotes *in extenso* "the Laws drawn up this year."

Comment: Ashley-Cooper's failure to give the source of the Laws he quoted has proved most unfortunate, and has unnecessarily added to the doubts about the 1744 Laws. Taken at their face value his words suggest rather more than a mere revision, and Thomas's even more definite later statements can largely be attributed to this reading of the article in question.

H. T. Waghorn in 1906

In the bibliography appended to *The Dawn of Cricket*, Waghorn, a most painstaking research worker, makes no reference to any Laws being published before 1755.

Comment: This is particularly surprising since at the time he wrote Waghorn must have known of Ashley-Cooper's article of 1900. It may be that he preferred to exclude a reference to a code for which no authority had been given.

P. F. Thomas in 1923–5

For his *Old-Time Cricket* Thomas lifts Haygarth's version of the old Laws derived from an undated manuscript, and labels them "The London Laws of 1744." In the same pamphlet he states, "the oldest edition, with a known date, that we possess is that drawn up for the London Club in 1744, issued in pamphlet form in 1755, and printed in *Cricket* in 1900." In a footnote he further states that "Mr. F. S. Ashley-Cooper republished this pamphlet 'The Game at Cricket as play'd in the Artillery Ground, London.' It was originally issued by Robert Sayer at the Golden Buck, Fleet Street."

Later, in *Cricket's Prime* we find an even more definite statement in which Thomas traces one result of the match between Kent and All England played on the Artillery Ground in 1744 as being that "the London Club had its Laws put into print as an authoritative guide to the correct play methods. Very likely other copies in the same words are older still, but it was the first time that a date was appended to them, and it leaves no doubt about the rules of the first-class game in pre-Hambledon days. These Laws, with the sanction of the London Club . . . are a link in the unbroken chain that connects the Wealden version of the seventeenth century with the Marylebone game of the twentieth. Their printing was the finest thing that ever hap-

pened to prevent the sport from degenerating into a variety of forms."

Comment: The first extract suggests that the 1755 edition of the Laws merely reproduced the original form of a 1744 code—this is only true if all intervening modernisation of the wording is disregarded. The footnote suggests that Ashley-Cooper republished a booklet issued in 1744—he actually republished the version of the 1744 Laws printed in 1752 (*vide infra*). The reference to an edition published by Robert Sayer is not supported, and it is probably intended for the 1755 booklet published by M. Read. Robert Sayer is known to have published an engraving[1] of Hayman's painting of "The Game at Cricket as play'd in the Artillery Ground, London," about this time, but he does not appear ever to have been connected with any edition of the Laws of Cricket.

The second extract is if anything even more misleading; there is no evidence that the revision of 1744 had any connection with the Kent and All England match, nor that the Laws were put into print for the first time at this period as Thomas appears to suggest.

Finally, most of what he wrote was around the version of the Laws quoted in *Old-Time Cricket*, which Thomas himself admits are taken from Haygarth. As the latter claimed no particular date for them, Thomas certainly is not justified in ascribing them definitely to 1744 as he does.

H. S. Altham in 1926

In *A History of Cricket* he states that "the earliest code of the Laws which has come down to us will be found printed as Appendix A. They can be dated as 1744."

Comment: Altham depended to a considerable extent on Thomas, and in fact the Laws he gives are identical with those in *Old-Time Cricket*. He is careful to avoid being too definite on a point about which he may not have been entirely satisfied.

G. B. Buckley in 1935

In a Chronology under the year "1755" Buckley states, "The Code of 1744. They are advertised in *The Public Advertiser* of May 15th under the title of 'The Game of Cricket.'"

Comment: A check of the entry in *The Public Advertiser* has

[1] This print is No. 9 of a set of engravings, published by Sayer, of the pictures by Francis Hayman painted for the Vauxhall Gardens.

shown that the date "1744" is not mentioned at all, and the notice is nothing more than an advertisement of the 1755 booklet of the Laws published by M. Read.

Readers who have borne with me through these tiresome extractions will appreciate that my doubts about the 1744 Laws had at least some substance, and will agree that a serious effort to clear up the uncertainty was justified. Of the eight authorities from whom I have quoted, and to my knowledge there are no others, only Ashley-Cooper and Gaston are of any assistance, and therefore the problem would only be solved if the source of the former's version could be established—the clue might well lie in Gaston's rather garbled description of his investigations.

Thanks to the kindness of Mr. J. W. Goldman, I have been able to compare the Laws in *The New Universal Magazine* of November 1752 with those quoted by Ashley-Cooper in 1900. Apart from two very minor discrepancies which are probably nothing more than errors in transcription, they agree word for word, and one may surmise that Ashley-Cooper followed up the earlier hint provided by Gaston.

The New Universal Magazine version is described as "The Game at Cricket, as settled by the CRICKET-CLUB, in 1744, and play'd at the ARTILLERY-GROUND, LONDON." This appears entirely conclusive as regards the date, and while the term "settled" does not necessarily imply that the Laws were printed then, it must surely mean that some revision at least was carried out in that year. This result by itself justifies the time spent on my enquiry, but, in addition, it may also throw light on the dates of other early versions which have come down to us. In considering this, however, we must always keep in mind that by 1752 the Laws may have included changes introduced into the game since 1744, and they may have been subject to some degree of modernisation.

There are at least four versions of such early codes. The first is that taken by Haygarth from the undated manuscript, and already mentioned. The others are all provided by printed handkerchiefs. X Haygarth quotes the Laws from one which was in the possession of a Mr. W. J. Humphry in 1862; the other two handkerchiefs—and they are not identical—were printed by Joseph Ware of Crayford, Kent. All three handkerchiefs give the same version of the Laws but all differ in the modernisation of the wording. From

L in 1862 L, to whom it had been bequeathed by his old coach Daniel King.

X See note by D. H. F. Squire at end.

the description of the Humphry handkerchief given in *Scores and Biographies*, Volume I, it would seem that all correspond in their general design. The Laws are printed in script lettering along the borders of the four sides of the square, and in the centre there is a representation of a game of cricket in progress, and the title. In the case of the Ware prints the picture is clearly based on Hayman's oil painting entitled "Cricket in the Mary-le-bone Fields," which was executed *c.* 1740.

Specimens of the scarce original version of these Ware handkerchiefs are in the collections of Mr. E. R. Wilson and Mr. J. W. Goldman† (*vide* plate facing page 9). The M.C.C. own the only known copy of the second edition which differs in many respects from the first.

† Now MCC

A comparison of the wording on the handkerchiefs suggests that the Humphry version may be the earliest—the Ware versions are both titled "The Laws of the Game of Cricket"; in the Humphry print this is "Ye Laws of Ye Game of Cricket," and in the wording of the Laws there are over twenty minor discrepancies from the first Ware printing—a few of these might be accounted for as errors in transcription, but it is difficult to believe that so meticulous a worker as Haygarth could have been at fault throughout. If this is accepted, it is quite possible that the Humphry handkerchief was printed in London, and copied shortly afterwards by Ware in Kent.

While there is no difference at all between the Laws given in any of these handkerchiefs and those in the first booklet of 1755 in the matter of their sequence, phrasing and intent, there is distinct evidence of a gradual modernisation, such as "Ye" becoming "The," and the ball ceasing to be referred to as "She" or "Her." On this evidence, admittedly weak, a possible order of the publication of the versions which almost certainly appeared before 1755 might be as follows:

First, and possibly even prior to the 1744 revision, the Humphry and early Ware prints in that order.

Second, the later Ware edition. (The M.C.C. copy carries "S.B. 1771" embroidered in silk, which must be the initials of a later owner, and not the date of publication of the print).

Third, the 1744 code published in *The New Universal Magazine* November 1752.

Conclusions

It is now necessary to formulate tentative conclusions on the evidence at our disposal, and they are:

First, before matches were played for high stakes as a regular custom, it is possible that no printed Laws were current despite the fact that a simple code was commonly accepted with no doubt some local variations on points of detail.

Second, after cricket had come to London at the beginning of the eighteenth century, a master code may well have been maintained at the Artillery Ground, from which copies were prepared by hand to govern the play in the Grand Matches played elsewhere.

Third, there is no reason to think that any important changes occurred during the period 1700 to 1755, and therefore the code adopted in 1744 was no more than a revision of the earlier Laws.

Fourth, the Humphry and Ware handkerchiefs may well have been the very first printing of the Laws in any shape, just as the 1752 edition is probably the first to have been type-set.

Having thus discussed at some length all that can relevantly be learnt of the dark ages, the stage is set to examine the evolution of the Laws from 1750 to the present time. A detailed chronology of the actual changes made in the Laws will be found in Chapter 6, but this list of events by its nature will probably have its chief virtue in its reference value, which in turn will not be fully realised unless the changing character of the game throughout the different periods is appreciated.

In order to provide this general background, the history of the game can best be divided into periods which fit in with the constitutional aspect of the Laws which governed it. The dividing lines I have selected are felt to be logical and convenient, since each period commences with a definite revision of the Laws of the game. They are:

1744 to 1787	The Hambledon Period
1787 to 1835	The Early Marylebone Period
1835 to 1884	The Middle Marylebone Period
Since 1884	The Modern Period

I have sketched the main characteristics of these periods in the Chapters which follow, and in doing so have drawn attention to

the important questions of the hour, with which the ensuing changes in the Laws are so closely connected.

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Chapter Two

THE PRE-VICTORIAN ERA

THE SETTING

We have already seen that the stakes and gambling associated with the more important matches was an essential factor in the development of cricket, and the hundred years which followed the revision of the Laws in 1744 provide continuing evidence of this feature.

It is not out of place, in a book dealing with the Laws of the game, to mention that Cricket itself was an unlawful pursuit until after the accession of Queen Victoria, since all games were banned by an Act of Parliament of the time of Henry VIII (33, c. 9), as a consequence of "crafty persons having invented new and crafty games by reason whereof archery is sore decayed." In 1845, an amending Act relieved games of skill of their shackles, and only then did the M.C.C. and Cricket become honest members of society.

Fortunately neither gambling nor illegitimacy was regarded as anything but normal in the eighteenth century, and the pioneers quite rightly judged that Cricket should be above the laws of the land; the application of the Act of Henry VIII was left to the magistrates, when they were constrained to deal with riotous gatherings, and to those who, having fairly lost their money on a match, elected to be sued for their debts rather than to pay as honourable men. The Act, too, may well account for the lack of historical records of cricket in the fifteenth and sixteenth centuries, since all games must at least have had a clandestine character.

Whether the Law was generally enforced or not in the early days may be regarded as doubtful, but in the period with which we are concerned the very fact that both Royalty and Nobility became the match-makers provided cricket with the immunity it deserved. At no other period has Royalty played so active a part in the game. Frederick, Prince of Wales, was a staunch supporter

and a keen player, attending at the Grand Matches from 1733. In 1750 he was struck by a ball while playing, and his death in the following year is said to have resulted from this unfortunate accident.

His son, George III, inherited his enthusiasm, and in 1770 presented a cup for a match "to be played for at Cricket for the amusement of the young Princes." Of the latter the Prince of Wales, later the Prince Regent and George IV, was a cricketer, and at the early age of ten showed a proper spirit towards the rules of the game when a dispute arose in a match in which he was playing, by drawing "the disputants into a small apartment in the Palace, where as a punishment, he locked them in by themselves for the space of an hour, declaring that they were fit company only for one another."

Long before 1750 large stakes on matches were usual, and for the more important ones were as high as 500 and even 1,000 guineas. Such stakes required match-makers, and for the Grand Matches these were drawn from the ranks of the Bucks of the day, many of whom were themselves first-class players. Apart from Frederick, Prince of Wales, the names of the Dukes of Dorset and Richmond, the Earls of Sandwich, March and Tankerville, and of many leading Commoners like Sir Horace Mann became household words.

With such large interests at stake, it was natural that the game should be attacked on moral grounds—the following extract from *The Chelmsford Chronicle* of 1774, traced by Buckley, is particularly interesting as it synchronises with the addition to the Laws of Cricket of rules to regulate the settlement of bets made in connection with matches. It is typical also of the milder type of diatribe of the period: "The game of Cricket which requires the utmost exertion of strength and agility, was followed until of late years, for manly exercise, animated by a noble spirit of emulation. This sport has too long been perverted from diversion and innocent pastime to excessive gaming and public dissipation: Cricket matches are now degenerated into business of importance. The increasing evil our magistracy ought to suppress in the Artillery Ground. It is confidently said that a set of idle fellows, or more properly a gang of dextrous gamblers, are hired and maintained by a most noble lord, at so little expense as £1,000 a year."

There seems to have been a steady tendency for the stakes to increase up to 1790, and in exceptional cases they rose to 2,000 and even 4,000 guineas. There is no doubt that betting starting from small private wagers steadily increased, and gradually became more and more professionalised. The coming of the professional bookmaker in turn produced the scandals of the early part of the nineteenth century connected with the selling of matches by the players, who in some cases were in the hands of the "legs."

Nyren stoutly defended the honesty of his father and the older generation of Hambledon player, but in doing so tacitly admitted the advent of crooked practices amongst the younger players, and this was later confirmed by William Beldham.

The 1774 Laws for betting were introduced to meet the changing requirements of the gamblers, and were as follows:

"If the Notches of one Player are laid against another, the Bet depends on both Innings, unless otherwise specified.

"If one Party beats the other in one Innings, the Notches in the First Innings shall determine the Bet.

"But if the other Party goes in a Second Time, then the Bet must be determined by the Numbers on the Score."

From about 1790 the number of games played for high stakes fell off; probably the number of matches exceeded the supply of backers; the latter were by then amply cared for by the bookmakers, who openly attended the more important matches. Beldham described the scene at Lord's where "if gentlemen wanted to bet just under the pavilion sat men ready, with money down, to give and take current odds: these were by far the best men to bet with, because if they lost, it was all in the way of business: they paid their money and did not grumble. Still they had all sorts of tricks to make their betting safe. 'One artifice,' said Mr. Ward, 'was to keep a player out of the way by a false report that his wife was dead.' Then these men would come down to the Green Man and Still, and drink with us, and always said that those who backed us, or 'the nobs,' as they called them, sold the matches. You will find some to persuade you this is true. But don't believe it. That any gentleman in my day ever put himself into the power of these blacklegs by selling matches, I can't credit. Still, one day, I thought I would try how far these tales were true. So, going down into Kent with one of high degree, he said to me, 'Will, if this match is won, I lose a hundred pounds.'

'Well,' said I, 'my lord you and I *could* order that.' He smiled as if nothing were meant, and talked of something else, and, as luck would have it, he and I were in together, and brought up the score between us, though every run seemed to me like a guinea out of his Lordship's pocket."

By 1820 the selling of matches was rife and shortly afterwards the M.C.C. removed the bookmakers from Lord's. While betting continued for many years in a small way, we hear no more of the scandals which had besmirched the good name of cricket for so long. Mary Russell Mitford described a cricket scene in 1823: "There they stood, railed in by themselves, silent, solemn, slow, playing for money; making a business of the thing; grave as judges, taciturn as chess players—a sort of dancers without music. . . . Everything is spoilt when money puts its ugly nose in."

By the close of the period, Miss Mitford would have been able to include once more the great matches at Lord's in her well-known comment, "I doubt if there be any scene in the world more animating or delightful than a cricket match. I do not mean a set match at Lord's Ground for money, hard money, between a certain number of gentlemen and players, as they are called—people who make a trade of that noble sport, and degrade it into an affair of bettings, and hedgings and cheatings, it may be, like boxing or horse-racing."

THE HAMBLEDON PERIOD, 1744 TO 1787

It is true to say that it was during this period that Cricket grew to man's estate, and the credit for this is due very largely to the astonishing prowess of the Hambledon players in what was at that time a very inaccessible part of Hampshire, particularly for players living in London and Kent, which had hitherto been the most important centres of the first-class game.

The Hambledon Club was formed about 1750 by, it is believed, the Reverend Charles Powlett (Paulet or Pawlet), a son of the 3rd Duke of Bolton by Lavinia Fenton who played the original part of Polly Peachum in Gay's *Beggar's Opera*. The formation of the new club was destined to have a greater impact on the game than any succeeding event, and within forty years the Hambledon players lifted cricket from its early immaturity to the level of a truly scientific game.

The success of the club was due in part to the enthusiasm of its

founders which created a wonderful *esprit de corps*, and in part to its composition, for in this we see the counterpart of modern cricket in which amateurs and professionals play alongside each other in the happiest association to the great benefit of the game. Its members were drawn mainly from Hampshire, but it also attracted many of the leading players from London, Kent, Surrey and Sussex, to form a team whose calibre was undoubted, and who were also thinking cricketers and great students of the game.

It was not long before Hambledon could play All England, and, although they are said to have suffered a temporary set-back about 1770, between 1772 and 1796 the club won thirty-six out of seventy-one matches played against England, Kent, Surrey and Sussex.

The effect of the advance during the period is naturally reflected in the changes which were made in the Laws—this effect is seen in two ways, the type of constitutional authority set up to deal with the Laws, and the actual changes thereby effected.

It would take time for Hambledon to establish its prestige, and it is not surprising to find that the 1755 code, published by the Star and Garter Committee, remained essentially identical with those settled at the Artillery Ground in 1744. In the next twenty years, however, the rapid advance of Hambledon both in prestige and in science demanded changes in the Laws, which, as might be expected, were mainly directed towards the closer definition necessary for the more serious game in course of development.

It would seem that the Star and Garter Committee of 1755 was in no sense a standing one—we learn of their Laws being reissued in 1767 (*Reading Mercury*, June 8th), but there is no evidence that these were more than reprints of the original version: even as late as 1786 an edition of the 1774 Laws was published containing in addition the 1755 code in its first form, which strongly suggests that no new Laws were enacted in the intervening years. This lack of a legislative authority must have proved irksome to those bent on progress, and in the absence of such a body we have definite evidence of Hambledon taking the matter into their own hands, for in 1771 a committee of their players gave an *ad hoc* decision to limit the width of the bat.

The story of this change is told by Nyren—his facts being taken from an account of the early days lent to him by William Ward.

"Several years since (I do not recollect the precise date) a player, named White, of Ryegate, brought a bat to a match, which being the width of the stumps, effectually defended his wicket from the bowler: and in consequence, a law was passed limiting the future width of the bat to four and a quarter inches." To this Nyren adds his own personal footnote, "I have a perfect recollection of this occurrence; also, that subsequently an iron frame, of statute width, was constructed for and kept by the Hambledon Club; through which any bat of suspected dimensions was passed, and allowed or rejected accordingly."

The match in question is known to have been an exciting affair between Hambledon and Chertsey played at Laleham Burway on September 23rd, 1771, for £50 a side, in which Hambledon scraped home by one notch. The Hambledon Club deciding that no more risks should be run acted at once on their own authority, as is clear from the Minute illustrated by the courtesy of Mr. J. W. Goldman in the plate facing page 21.

If the Hambledon Committee of players were prepared to act in one case, there is no reason to suppose that they may not have dictated many of the other changes which came to be incorporated in the next revision of the Laws in 1774. This revision was carried out by a committee representing both London and the neighbouring counties, amongst which Hampshire figures. It can be taken that Hampshire signified Hambledon, as of the team of eleven appointed for the task, the Earl of Tankerville, the Rev. Charles Pawlet, and probably Charles Coles had a definite association with the Club, and were no doubt briefed to voice the views of the players.

Apart from five omissions from the previous code which may well have resulted from careless drafting, the committee approved or confirmed only seven major alterations and it is significant of the period that the majority of these were directed towards the closer definition of the game demanded by the Hambledon conception.

The next alteration—the introduction of the three-stump wicket—also owed its origin directly to a Hambledon match; this time a single-wicket, five-a-side one played between the Club and Kent on the Artillery Ground on May 22nd and 23rd, 1775, which Nyren, quoting from the MS. of an old player, has described for us: "When Small went in the last man for fourteen

runs, and fetched them, Lumpy was the bowler upon the occasion; and it having been remarked that his balls had three several times passed between Small's stumps, it was considered to be a hard thing upon the bowler that his straightest balls should be thus sacrificed; the number of the stumps was in consequence increased from two to three. Many amateurs were of opinion at the time that the alteration would tend to shorten the game; and subsequently the Hampshire gentlemen did me the honour of taking my opinion upon this point. I agreed with them that it was but doing justice to the bowler; but I differed upon the question that it would shorten the game; because the striker, knowing the danger of missing one straight ball with three instead of two stumps behind him, would materially redouble his care; while every loose hard hitter would learn to stop, and play as safe a game as possible." It is interesting to record that on this occasion, Small took no less than two and three-quarter hours to make his fourteen runs, and also that Lumpy Stevens was playing against Hambledon, which is evidence of the unbiased nature of the Club's attitude when studying the best interest of the game.

Thus we pass through this all-important period of cricket history, till at its close we see the transfer of power back from Hampshire to London on the formation of the M.C.C., and since the first revision of the Laws carried out by the M.C.C. in 1788 must still reflect the developments pursued by Hambledon, I can appropriately refer to them here.

The new code contained only four new provisions—of these, three were closer definitions of the Laws dealing with "L.B.W.," the obstruction of a catch, and for the disallowance of runs in the case of a catch or a run out—all in strict keeping with Hambledon's established conception of the game as one deserving more detailed legislation than had hitherto been provided. The remaining change provided, for the first time, rules for the rolling, mowing, etc., of the pitch by mutual agreement during a match—surely the earliest sign of the now accepted principle that bad conditions make for bad cricket; doubtless it reflected the tremendous advance made in bowling technique, and thereby in batting, by such players as David Harris, of whom Nyren wrote, 'To Harris' fine bowling I attribute the great improvement that was made in hitting, and above all in stopping; for it was utterly impossible

to remain at the crease, when the ball was tossed to a fine length; you were obliged to get in, or it would be about your hands, or the handle of your bat; and every player knows where its next place would be."

I have explained that there is no evidence to show that the Star and Garter committee of 1755 remained in being to amend the Laws as necessity arose, and this is equally true of the period between the revision of 1774 and the formation of the M.C.C., though it might appear from an examination of the editions of the Laws published just prior to 1787 that some revision may have been carried out; if this was so, we have no record of the authority which was responsible for the work. (*Vide* Appendix III.)

We see, therefore, that 1787 is an important constitutional milestone since that year marks the passage from an epoch in which the revisions were carried out at irregular intervals by committees appointed for the occasion, to one during which a single central authority has been in continuous session.

THE EARLY MARYLEBONE PERIOD, 1787 TO 1835

When Tom Lord opened his ground on the site of Dorset Square in 1787, no one anticipated that the resulting formation of the Marylebone Cricket Club would lead to the rapid eclipse of Hambledon. The chief founders of the M.C.C. were the Earl of Winchilsea and the Hon. Charles Lennox, who were Presidents of Hambledon in 1787–9 and 1791 respectively; other notable supporters of cricket such as the Earls of Tankerville and Darnley, the latter's brother General the Hon. E. Bligh and Thomas Assheton Smith, were also members of both the clubs. Nyren never hinted that any ill-feeling arose at any time between the two interests, and the fact that the names of so many influential figures of the cricket world were on the rolls of both clubs probably provides the reason.

None the less, within a very few years Hambledon had lost its great prestige, and its power was transferred to Dorset Square. The identity of many of the new legislators with the old probably explains the fact that for several years only a few minor changes of a tidying-up nature were made; major alterations were confined to giving assistance to the bowler by increasing the size of the wicket, and by allowing a new ball at the start of each innings; in

THE LAWS OF CRICKET,

As Revised by the CRICKET CLUB, at St. MARY-LE-BONE, 1820.

THE BALL must weigh not less than Five Ounces and a Half, nor more than Five Ounces and Three Quarters. At the beginning of each Innings either Party may call for a new Ball.

THE BAT

must not exceed Four Inches and One Quarter, in the widest part.

THE STUMPS

must be Twenty-six Inches out of the ground, the Bails Seven Inches in length.

THE BOWLING CREASE

must be in a line with the Stumps, Three Feet in length, with a RETURN CREASE.

THE POPPING CREASE

must be Four Feet from the Wicket, and parallel to it.

THE WICKETS

must be opposite to each other, at the distance of Twenty-two Yards; which shall be pitched within Thirty Yards of a centre fixed by the Adversaries.

It shall not be lawful for either Party during a match, without the consent of the other, to alter the Ground, by rolling, watering, covering, mowing, or beating: This rule is not meant to prevent the Striker from beating the Ground with his Bat near where he stands during the Innings, or to prevent the Bowler from filling up holes, watering his ground, or using sawdust, &c. when the ground is wet.

THE BOWLER

shall deliver the Ball with one foot behind the Bowling Crease, and within the Return Crease, and shall bowl Four Balls before he changes wickets, which he shall do but once in the same Innings.

The Ball must be bowled (not thrown or jerked), and delivered underhand, with the Hand below the Elbow. But if the Ball be jerked, or the arm extended from the body horizontally, and any part of the back of the hand be uppermost, or the hand horizontally extended when the Ball is delivered, the Umpire shall call "*No Ball*."

He may order the Striker, at his wicket, to stand on which side of it he pleases.

If the Bowler tosses the Ball over the Striker's head, or bowls it so wide that the Striker cannot play at it, the party that is in shall be allowed One Notch, to be put down to the Byes, and those Balls not to be reckoned as any of the Four Balls.

If the Bowler bowls a *No Ball*, the Striker may play at it, and be allowed all the Runs he can get, and shall not be put out, except by running out.

In the event of a change of Bowling, no more than Two Balls to be allowed in practice.

The Bowler who takes the Two Balls, to be obliged to bowl Four Balls.

THE STRIKER IS OUT

if the Ball is bowled off, or the Stump bowled out of the ground.

Or, if the Ball, from a stroke over or under the Bat, or upon his hand (but not wrists), is held before it touches the ground, although it be hugged to the body of the Catcher.

Or, if in striking or at any other time while the Ball is in play, both his feet are over the Popping Crease and his Wicket put down, except his Bat is grounded within it.

Or, if in striking at the Ball he hits down his Wicket.

Or, if under pretence of running a Notch, or otherwise, either of the strikers prevent a Ball from being caught, the Striker of the Ball is out.

Or, if the Ball is struck up, and he wilfully strikes it again.

Or, if in running a Notch, the Wicket is struck down by a throw, or with the Ball in Hand, before his Foot, Hand, or Bat is grounded over the Popping Crease. But if the Bail is off, the Stump must be struck out of the ground.

Or, if any part of the Striker's dress knocks down the Wicket.

Or, if the Striker touches or takes up the Ball while in play, unless at the request of the other Party.

If with his foot or leg he stops the Ball, which the Bowler in the opinion of the Umpire at the Bowler's Wicket shall have pitched in a straight line to the Wicket, and would have hit it.

If the Players have crossed each other, he that runs for the Wicket which is put down, is out; if they are not crossed, he that has left the Wicket which is put down, is out.

When a Ball is caught, no Notch to be reckoned.

When a Striker is run out, the Notch they were running for is not to be reckoned.

If a lost Ball is called, the Striker shall be allowed Four, but if more than Four are run before lost Ball is called, then the Striker to have all they have run.

When the Ball has been in the Bowler's or Wicket-keeper's hands, it is considered as no longer in play; and the Strikers need not keep within their ground till the Umpire has called "*Play*;" but if the player goes out of his ground with an intent to run before the Ball is delivered, the Bowler may put him out.

If the Striker is hurt, he may retire from his Wicket, and have his Innings at any time in that Innings.

If a Striker is hurt, some other Person may be allowed to stand out for him, but not go in.

If any Person stops the Ball with his Hat, the Ball is to be considered as dead, and the opposite Party to add Five Notches to their Score; if any are run, they are to have Five in all.

If the Ball is struck up, the Striker may guard his Wicket either with his Bat or his Body.

In SINGLE-WICKET MATCHES, if the Striker moves out of his ground to strike at the Ball, he shall be allowed no Notch for such Stroke.

THE WICKET KEEPER

shall stand at a reasonable distance behind the Wicket, and shall not move till the Ball is out of the Bowler's hand, and shall not by any noise incommode the Striker; and if his hands, knees, feet, or head, be over or before the Wicket, though the Ball hit it, it shall not be out.

THE UMPIRES

are sole judges of fair and unfair play, and all Disputes shall be determined by them, each as his own Wicket: but in case of a Catch, which the Umpire at the Wicket cannot see sufficiently to decide upon, he may apply to the other Umpire, whose opinion is conclusive.

The Umpires, in all Matches, to pitch fair Wickets, and the Parties to toss for the choice of Innings.

They shall allow Two Minutes for each man to come in, and Fifteen Minutes between each Innings; when the Umpire shall call "*Play*," the Party refusing to play shall lose the Match.

They are not to order a Player out, unless appealed to by the Adversaries.

But, if the Bowler's Foot is not behind the Bowling Crease, and within the Return Crease, when he delivers the Ball, they must, unasked, call "*No Ball*."

If the Striker runs a Short Notch, the Umpire must call "*No Notch*."

That the Umpire at the Bowler's Wicket shall be first applied to, to decide on all Catches.

The Umpires are not to be changed during the Match, but by the consent of both Parties.

BETS.

If the Notches of one Player are laid against another, the Bets depend on the First Innings, unless otherwise specified.

If the Bets are made upon both Innings, and one Party beats the other in One Innings, the Notches in the First Innings shall determine the Bet.

But if the other Party goes in a second time, then the Bet must be determined by the number on the Score.

Example of the Laws in broadsheet form: printed in 1820 by T. Craft, official printer to the M.C.C. (about one-third scale)

the light of subsequent history both of these changes are very significant.

The period from 1810 to 1835 was concerned almost entirely with a bitter controversy about the height of the bowler's arm at the moment of delivery—in other words whether bowling should continue to be under-arm or not. The resulting schism must be described in some detail for two reasons which are relevant to our main theme: firstly, because it affected the prestige and authority of the M.C.C. for many years to come, and secondly because the experience of the period provided many lessons on which the legislative procedure of later years was founded.

Long previously, Tom Walker of Hambledon had exploited for a time round-arm, or "throwing" as it was then called, but it was not until Mr. John Willes of Kent revived this technique about 1802 that the matter became serious enough for the M.C.C. to take notice. In effect, for the first time this raised in an acute form the question, which to-day is perennial, of how to maintain an even balance between the bowler and the striker. David Harris by his genius had forced on batsmen a new style of play and a new shape of bat, which had led to their supremacy on the field; to it Willes and his imitators thought that illegal, round-arm bowling was the answer.

This player is said to have owed his methods to practice against the bowling of his sister, who, it has been suggested, garbed herself for the occasion in such a voluminous crinoline that she could not avoid bowling "No balls." Willes was imitated by others, so that, in spite of warnings from authority, the practice of "throwing" was becoming general by 1816; William Ward, a staunch conservative, then pressed his views on the M.C.C. to such effect that they adopted a new version of the "No ball" Law, which deserves quoting, if only as an example of how not to frame a law. It read, "The ball must be bowled (not thrown or jerked), and be delivered underhand, with the hand below the elbow. But if the ball be jerked, or the arm extended from the body horizontally, and any part of the back of the hand be uppermost, or the hand horizontally extended when the ball is delivered, the Umpire shall call 'No ball.'"

This enactment was a tactical blunder which was soon to cause trouble; the difficulty over the earlier Law was not due to its wording, but to the weakness of the captains in allowing, and of

the umpires in not stopping, illegal practices, which to-day would be dealt with by a M.C.C. instruction to the players and umpires. The complicated nature of the new Law produced much misunderstanding, and thereby assisted the agitators who favoured round-arm methods.

Six years later an umpire was bold enough to "No ball" Willes in a match at Lord's between the M.C.C. and Kent, and as a result this progressive player retired in umbrage from the match and from cricket. He died in 1852, and his tombstone in Sutton Vallence churchyard bears the epitaph, "He was a patron of all manly sports and the first to introduce round-arm bowling in cricket."

Thus ended the first phase of the controversy, but it was not long before a campaign in favour of the "New style" was opened on a carefully prepared plan by Mr. George Knight, himself a member of the M.C.C. A full account of his experimental matches and of the arguments on both sides is to be found in the contemporary numbers of *The Sporting Magazine* of 1827 and 1828, from which it is clear that the case in favour of granting greater latitude to the bowler was based on the following grounds:

(i) Some help to the bowler was necessary as the result of the great development in batting.

(ii) The change would not lead to faster bowling or to injuries to the players, but it would increase the stock of good bowlers to the advantage of the game, and in particular it would enable bowlers to impart more spin and lift to the ball after pitching.

(iii) The present Law stood condemned—it defied interpretation, and did not define a "throw." The Law proposed in its place had stood up to trials, and above all was capable of comprehension by the umpires.

(iv) The M.C.C. were trying to legislate against a minority of bowlers who in fact raised their hand above the shoulder—an extravagance not even suggested by the supporters of the "New style."

The protagonists of the old style, led as before by William Ward, remained true to their conservative counter-arguments that the change would eliminate stroke play and encourage de-

fensive batsmanship, and on bad wickets would quite ruin the game; that it would lead to fast bowling of the wildest type; and that if its purpose was to reduce the number of drawn matches, the first step should be to cut out waste of time, and then to see what other means could be found to help the bowler, such as further increasing the size of the wicket and reducing the width of the bat.

The only point on which both parties were agreed was on the necessity for experiments before any definite alteration was made in the Laws, which is of course the established practice to-day. This gave Knight his cue, and he organised three experimental matches in 1827 between Sussex, including both Lillywhite and Broadbridge, who were the great exponents of the new style, and All England. Sussex won the first easily, the second by a narrow margin, and lost the third. After the second match nine of the England team signed a declaration, to be later withdrawn, that they would not play in the third "unless the Sussex bowlers bowl fair—that is abstain from throwing."

The results of these matches were held by Knight to justify his proposing to a Special General Meeting of the M.C.C. in May 1828 that the extra latitude he sought for the bowler should be granted, but William Ward once more carried the day by moving an amendment to simplify the previous difficult Law, but to continue to bar any bowling in which the hand or the arm was above the elbow at the time of delivery.

The change naturally could not satisfy the increasing number of supporters of the "march of intellect" system. Even at Lord's in the following year Lillywhite and Broadbridge were required to keep within the Law in the first innings of an England *v.* Sussex match, but in the second they were permitted to bowl round-arm! Everywhere umpires increasingly were turning a blind eye to the lifting of the arm, and matters finally came to a head in 1834, after which season the diehards capitulated with reluctance. Nyren expressed their feeling in 1833 when he wrote, "I am decidedly of opinion, that if it be not stopped altogether, the character of the game will become changed. I should hope that such powerful and efficient members of the Mary-le-bone Club as Mr. Ward, etc., will determine, not only to discountenance, but wholly and finally to suppress it; and instead, to foster and give every encouragement to genuine, bona fide bowlers—men

with a fine delivery." For better or for worse, however, the change was accepted on May 14th, 1835.

It would be wrong to infer from this schism that the M.C.C. had adopted a *laisser-faire* attitude towards the matter—on the contrary they were very active in attempting to restore the balance between the bowler and the batsman, basing their policy on maintaining the "No ball" definition, and helping the bowler in other ways. Of the major changes made between 1810 and 1835, five dealt with general points, such as rules for fielding substitutes, tossing for innings, and pitching wickets; three were designed to help the bowler by twice increasing the size of the wicket—it had already been increased once in 1798—and by extending the "L.B.W." Law; on the other hand restraint on the "New style" was insisted on by four changes in the "No ball" Law, and by the introduction of penalties for both "No balls" and "Wides."

The first Law to deal with "Wides" probably resulted from a well-known incident which occurred at Lord's in 1810 during a Single-wicket match between that forceful character Lord Frederick Beauclerk and T. C. Howard on the one side, and Squire Osbaldeston and William Lambert on the other. The Squire was taken ill, but Lord Frederick insisted on play or pay, on which Lambert, realizing he could bowl wide of the wicket without any penalty, consistently did so to his noble opponent, who lost his temper, his wicket and the match.

The period was notable not only for the problems which arose in connection with the conduct of the game, but it also saw much constitutional progress. Knight's proposal to alter the "No ball" Law in 1828 was the first occasion on which we hear of an alteration in the Laws being referred to a General Meeting of the M.C.C.—secondary changes however for some years continued to be dealt with by the Club committee, for example, when the penalty for a "No ball" was introduced in 1829. Later when it was decided to carry out a general revision of the Laws, the proposed changes were published in *The Sporting Magazine* seven months in advance of the Anniversary meeting of 1835 at which they were presented. The same journal later provides an account of this meeting, when so much time was taken up with other business that the only alteration dealt with was the crucial one which introduced round-arm bowling. The remainder of the

code was re-examined by a sub-committee on which were such famous names as Lord Charles Russell, Hon. George Ponsonby, Colonel Hon. H. C. Lowther, H. Jenner, Lord Frederick Beauclerk, William Ward, R. Kynaston, Benjamin Aislabie and others; a hastily summoned Special General Meeting was convened on May 20th, 1835, when the new Code was adopted.

We take leave of this period therefore with the older cricketers full of doubts as to the effect of round-arm bowling on the future of the game, and we shall see that it was not long before their fears were justified. We see too a very definite advance towards a stricter constitutionalism which was to provide a sheet anchor for the game in later years.

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Chapter Three

THE MIDDLE MARYLEBONE PERIOD, 1835 TO 1884

THIS period falls into two sharply defined phases divided by the recognition of over-arm bowling in 1864: one theme was common to both—a constant striving on the part of the bowler to regain his superiority over the striker, a struggle which naturally had a direct impact on the legislation of the time.

The latter part of the era saw the start of modern inter-County cricket, and of the interchange of visits with overseas countries, both of which were destined later to alter the shape of the Laws—it also saw the gradual development of the modern perfect pitch, though this had not reached the stage which required the attention of authority before the end of the period under review.

Including those made in 1835, there were not more than sixteen important alterations to the Laws made during the fifty years, and many of these were of an entirely general nature such as limitations for the dimensions of the bat and the ball, and the provision of a "Follow on" rule designed to reduce the number of undecided matches. The perennial struggle between bowler and batsman was the chief preoccupation of those responsible for the governance of the game, and until over-arm bowling was recognised, the story has a close resemblance to that of the controversy of the 1820's in respect of round-arm bowling. Long before 1835 it was clear that the "New style" bowlers were bowling over-arm whenever they were allowed to do so by the umpires; thirty years later Pycroft recalled that the introduction of round-arm was such an unnatural and illogical solution of the problem that it could only lead to the crudest sort of bowling, unless the bowlers did indeed go beyond their rights. He quoted Caldecourt, the distinguished umpire, as saying of Lillywhite, "It is only when you let Lilly bowl as high as he likes that he beats all that ever did bowl."

History repeated itself not only in the tactics adopted by the bowlers, but also in the policy followed by the M.C.C., who once

again strove to keep the bowlers from going outside the letter of the Law—a policy which had failed once when there had been logic in it, and was now destined to fail even more ignominiously.

Within ten years of the recognition of round-arm bowling in 1835, three changes in the Laws were adopted, all directed towards limiting its effect; these were a revised "L.B.W." Law under which the ball must have pitched between wicket and wicket instead of having been delivered in a straight line from the bowler's hand, and two other alterations designed to tighten up the Law for "Wides," which deserve special mention.

From 1840 onwards we have access to contemporary comments on the questions of the hour, and the first writer of these was a journalist, William Denison, who came of a family well versed in the lore of Hambledon, and who was himself a keenly observant player. The opening rounds of the contest between authority and the bowlers were directed against "the liberal contribution of 'wide balls.'" Denison, and Pycroft later confirmed his views, held that this resulted from the very large number of bowlers who, in trying to emulate the speed of Alfred Mynn, bowled far beyond their physical powers, and thereby were not only damaging the growth of scientific batsmanship, but also very often hazarded the result of matches by the number of runs which were thrown away.

Umpires, too, were left in much doubt as to the definition of a "Wide" they were intended to follow—Lambert's dictum of the 1820's that a ball must pitch outside the Return crease to be a "Wide" apparently still applied in nearly all games except when M.C.C. umpires were standing, and for the latter matches the M.C.C. had confused the issue by an instruction to the effect that a straight ball might become a "Wide" if it broke sufficiently after pitching.

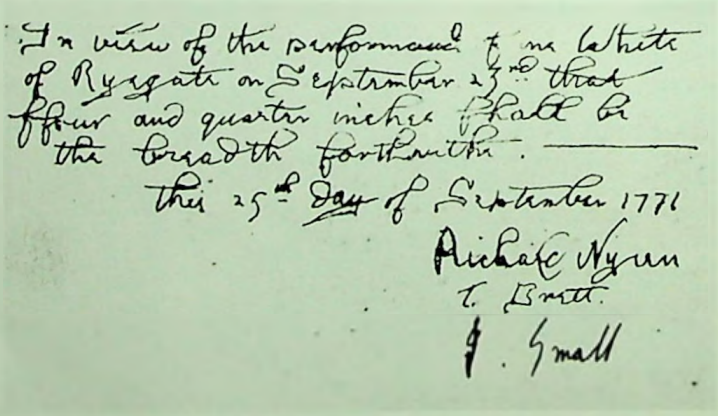
Largely as the result of Denison's protests, the M.C.C. appointed a committee to look into the matter; evidence was taken from both Denison and Dark, the proprietor of Lord's Ground. The former pressed hard for a rigid definition, suggesting that the Popping creases should be made eight feet long, and that any ball passing outside them should automatically be called "Wide." This definition was not accepted but Denison gained two points —instead of a penalty of one run only being allowed for a "wide" on the call of which the ball was "dead," the Law was altered to



Engraving by B. Cole after the picture painted by Francis Hayman for Vauxhall Gardens, used to illustrate the Laws as published in the *New Universal Magazine*, November, 1752



Linen Handkerchief c. 1785 with the 1774 Laws corrected to include a reference to the three-stump wicket. The scene depicts the new wicket in use on the famous White Conduit Ground The medallion portraits in the corners are those of the Prince of Wales, the Duke of Dorset, Sir Horace Mann and Colonel Tarleton.


In view of the performance to be at White of Ryegate on September 25th that four and quarter inches shall be the breadth forthwith. —

this 25th Day of September 1771

Richard Nyren
T. Brett
J. Small

Minute of the Hambledon players, which determined the width of the bat in 1771.

allow the batsmen all the runs they could make, such runs reckoning of course as "wides." In addition he persuaded the M.C.C. to issue an instruction to the scorers that "the names of the bowlers who bowl 'Wide balls' or 'No balls' in future to be placed on the score, to show the parties by whom either score is made." In fact this instruction appeared quite improperly as part of the Law until the revision of 1884.

Although Denison had not gained his entire end in 1844, his influence was still at work, and at the Anniversary Dinner in the following year the M.C.C. Committee were asked to enquire whether "any regulation can be laid down by them by which the limit of bowling may be more easily defined and acted on." As a result the Law was again altered two months later to change the definition of a "Wide" from a ball "out of distance to be played at" to one which was so wide "that in the opinion of the umpire it shall not be fairly within the reach of the batsman." While this change could not have satisfied Denison and his supporters who sought precision, the general publicity given to the matter apparently satisfied both the umpires and the players by removing the uncertainty which had previously existed.

That "wides" continued to be an inherent feature of round-arm bowling can be judged by a glance at the score sheets of second-class matches before over-arm bowling became general—thereafter the increased accuracy of the bowling quelled the demand for a finer definition, though the advent of "off theory" as practised by Tom Emmett in the 1870's must have given cause for alarm. His method, which was to bowl very wide off-breaks with an occasional straight ball, was copied by others with the result that the game became tiresomely slow for the spectators, whose opinion forced the abandonment of the theory. The averages of the period are ample evidence of Emmett's method as he bowled many more "wides" than any other first-class bowler of his day.

But to return to our main theme, the start of the struggle to restrain the bowler can be traced to a pin prick when the right of a fresh bowler to trial balls was taken away in 1838, but the deployment of authority's main forces was concealed for some time behind the screen created by the discussions on "wides." It was not until 1845 that the M.C.C. launched their full assault on the increasing number of bowlers who, following the example

set them by Lillywhite, were bowling over-arm; the first exchange was the issue of a fresh and much more definite version of the "No ball" Law which concluded with the words, "and whenever the bowler shall so closely infringe on this rule in any of the above particulars as to make it difficult for the umpire at the bowler's wicket to judge whether the ball has been delivered within the true intent and meaning of this rule or not, the umpire shall call 'No ball'."

To make it clear that they were in earnest, within a month of the adoption of this Law, the M.C.C. Committee considered it necessary to prohibit their professionals and umpires from taking part in any match in which there was not strict compliance with the official Laws. This must surely indicate that the authority of the M.C.C. was being questioned, and indeed as early as 1836 the rules of a club as far from Lord's as St. Austell in Cornwall contained the significant phrase "that the game be played according to the rules of the Mary-le-bone club; but if the majority of the members present wish to play the rough game, they may do so." There can be little doubt that the "rough game" was unlicensed "throwing" as over-arm bowling was commonly called.

The M.C.C.'s attack failed however, and by 1851 further action was necessary; this time it took the form of the first general pronouncement by the M.C.C. on the conduct of the game that has been traced—it was in fact what to-day would be called an "Instruction to Umpires," and is therefore of particular historical significance. It was addressed to James Dark, who was responsible for the professionals engaged at Lord's, but was clearly intended for the wider cricket world. It ran, "It is the wish of the Committee that any M.C.C. player who shall stand umpire in any match shall pay particular attention to the bowling in reference to Rule No. 10 of the Laws of Cricket and if any bowler shall in his opinion transgress that Law by throwing or jerking the ball, or if the hand of a bowler shall be above the shoulder in delivery; that is when the ball leaves the hand, he shall call 'No ball.' As it is impossible to define a throw or a jerk, he must form his own opinion. If in the slightest doubt it is his duty to call 'No ball.' If, in any match, he shall call any bowler unfair, and he shall be allowed to bowl by the other umpire, he shall explain his reasons to the other and endeavour, if possible, to agree with him as to the course to be taken during the remainder of the match. But if

the difference of opinion shall be so great that no agreement can be come to, he shall act according to his own opinion and shall as soon as possible after the match report to the Committee of the M.C.C. the circumstances of the case. Although the Committee of the M.C.C. address these observations to their own players in particular, they recommend the consideration of them to Umpires throughout the country."

The bowlers however were not to be curbed, nor the umpires to be persuaded to act, and in 1858 the Law was again reinforced by limiting the lifting of the hand or arm, not only in the act of delivery, but also "in the action immediately preceding the delivery." That this too fell upon deaf ears is clear from the issue of further special instructions to the umpires before the 1859 season.

History was indeed repeating itself—in 1816 the complexity of the Law had proved its undoing, and now again the M.C.C. had found it necessary to clarify their real intention by including in their pronouncement the following phrase which could scarcely have carried conviction to the umpires and players: the Committee felt "that a fair and liberal construction should be given to the Laws of Cricket (the wording of which cannot always be framed with legal accuracy)." The instruction continued by explaining that "In Law 10 the words 'in the action immediately preceding delivery' are not intended to prevent a bowler raising his hand in any manner he may think fit provided it is not above the shoulders as it passes the body in the last swing of the arm before the ball is delivered."

The trouble persisted and finally came to a head in the England *v.* Surrey match at the Oval in 1862, when John Lillywhite, having watched Willsher bowl two overs, "no balled" him six times in succession. The entire England team except the amateurs walked off the field, and the game was suspended until the following day when play was resumed, but only after Lillywhite had been supplanted by another umpire. The sequel is of particular interest, as for the first time the M.C.C. decided that it was necessary to obtain the opinions of Cricket Clubs generally on a point connected with the Laws, and in February 1863 the following statement appeared in the sporting Press:

"The Committee of the M.C.C. having taken into consideration during the last autumn the many difficulties which have existed in carrying out Law 10, so far as it relates to the height of

the hand in bowling, determined at a Meeting held on the 31st October to issue a Circular addressed to numerous Clubs with a view to elicit the opinion of Cricketers in the principal Districts whether Law 10 should be enforced or not.

"Replies have been received to the Circular from many Quarters and the prevailing feeling seems to be, that the restriction on the height of the hand should be abolished, but that throwing and jerking should be disallowed as at present. Suggestions were made by some that additional or altered words might secure greater strictness in enforcing the Law against throwing and jerking.

"The subject was fully considered at a Meeting of the Committee held on the 25th [February, 1863], Earl Sefton in the Chair. The following resolutions were adopted:

"'That a General Meeting of the Members of the M.C.C. be held in the Pavilion in Lord's Ground on Wednesday the 15th of April at 3 o'clock precisely, for the purpose of taking into consideration any proposal which may be made by Members of the Club with reference to Law 10.'

"The Committee do not propose to publish any of the Letters they have received; but they will be placed in the hands of Mr. Dark at Lord's Ground, where they will be open to the inspection of any Members of the M.C.C. or other Cricketers interested in the question of bowling.

"Any proposals for altering Law 10 must be sent to the Hon. Sec. Mr. Kynaston, 43 Devonshire Street, W., before the 10th March, as one month's notice must be given of a General Meeting agreeable to Rule 17 of the Club and all Notices of Motion must appear in the public advertisement."

The response to this invitation appears to have been disappointing as it fell to the Hon. Secretary to produce the main proposal, which was clearly an illogical compromise, allowing the bowler to raise his hand level with the head but no higher; this could never have endured, and the proposal may well have proved fatal to the amendment standing in the name of the Hon. Fred Ponsonby by which the bowler was granted full latitude. Both the main resolution and the amendment failed to gain support.

The same meeting dealt with a drastic proposal to alter the "L.B.W." Law to read, "Or if with any part of his person he stop

the ball, which in the opinion of the umpire at the bowler's end would have hit the striker's wicket." If this formula had been accepted, it is interesting to speculate how the later development of defensive batsmanship would have been affected—it will be understood that the proposal disregarded completely the pitch of the ball, or the position of the striker. Perhaps fortunately, the Hon. Secretary at once proposed an amendment, which while inserting the requirement that the part of the striker's person must be between wicket and wicket, curiously omitted the words "would have hit the striker's wicket." The amendment was carried, but owing to formal notice not having been given was later declared by the M.C.C. Committee to be invalid.

As a result of the decision not to alter the "No ball" Law, the Committee found themselves constrained to inform teams playing at Lord's that the Law as it stood would be enforced; at the same time they reminded their own umpires of their duty, adding that while believing "that interference with the independence of umpires would be injurious to cricket," they would deal appropriately "with proved cases of incapacity or unfairness of M.C.C. umpires." It must therefore have been a shock to them to find that within a week of this instruction, the umpires in a Colts' match at Lord's had completely disregarded it!

In fact, the matter had got completely out of control, and public opinion so forced the issue that, on June 10th, 1864, a General Meeting of the M.C.C. finally surrendered by granting complete emancipation to the bowlers. Thus the vexed question was at long last settled, though even at that time conservative thinkers like Pycroft felt that a better alternative would have been to revert to under-arm bowling.

It may be possible to justify the M.C.C.'s policy in regard to round-arm bowling in the period 1810 to 1835, but it is very difficult to believe that the situation which developed later could not have been better handled—as a result the years from 1840 to 1864 probably represent the very worst period of M.C.C. control of the game, and might well have proved disastrous to cricket. The proceedings of the abortive General Meeting in April 1863 led directly to a movement fostered by *The Sporting Life* to set up a form of Cricket Parliament consisting of practical and business men elected in their respective constituencies to frame the Laws and to regulate the national game. The sponsors

of the proposal pointed out that so long as cricket had been mainly confined to the South of England, the M.C.C. could control the game, but they were no longer in a position to do so now that it had spread so far afield.

Criticism of the "No ball" decision was by no means confined to the more distant Clubs, as within three days of the General Meeting of the M.C.C., we hear of W. South Norton, who had been the first Secretary of the Kent C.C.C., writing to the Hon. E. V. Bligh as follows: "I understand the M.C.C. have left Law 10 exactly as it was which means I am afraid 'vengeance on Willsher'—I begin to be jealous of the M.C.C. as lawgivers and am inclined to favour the suggestion of a congress of representatives from the cricketing counties with a view of superseding their authority."

Just a week before over-arm bowling was recognised a meeting was called in London to launch such a scheme, but nothing emerged from it. Writing at the time, Pycroft roundly condemned the whole project in the following words: "But men who meet, big with their own importance, and proud of their suit of 'little brief authority,' if they find nothing to settle, will find something to unsettle; so jaw, jar and discord will be the order of the day. As to harmonising fixtures and programmes of matches, 'in the name of the Prophet, FIGS!', a Committee of the whole House will not settle such things by Doomsday. And if, as we hear, bills of pains and penalties against offending professionals are to be proposed, we have only to say that the understanding between the players and the gentlemen has been generally so delightful, that we should be very sorry to read in our statute-books the possibility of an exception."

While undoubtedly serious tactical mistakes were made, there were off-setting developments in the constitutional government of the game. In the 1840's a proposal to alter a Law could be raised at the Anniversary Meeting of the M.C.C. without previous notice being given, and the resolution could be passed by a bare majority; this was corrected in 1850 when it was laid down that such proposals must first be approved by the Committee, who would give one month's notice of them both in the Club and in the Press before they were submitted at a General Meeting. This rule was tested in 1863 when, as we have already seen, a resolution to alter the "L.B.W." Law was carried, but declared to be

null and void owing to formal notice not having been given. When the Rules of the M.C.C. were revised in 1865, the above provision was reinforced by requiring that the notice of any meeting "shall state in distinct terms the change in the Laws to be proposed, and no change shall be declared carried unless twenty members at least shall vote in favour of it." It is probable that this alteration was dictated by the unsatisfactory proceedings of 1863.

These last twenty years, while constitutionally unhappy ones, covered a period of very rapid development and spread of cricket in England and Scotland for which the great touring teams, such as William Clarke's All-England Eleven, can claim credit, and no doubt the movement for setting up a Parliament independent of the M.C.C. sprang largely from the consequent widening interest in the game.

So ended the first phase of the period, and during the next twenty years there were but few changes in the Laws; the most important was clearly designed to help the bowlers by altering the 1744 provision that a bowler could only change ends once in any innings—instead he was now allowed to do so twice subject to his not bowling more than two overs in succession. Another change —a minor matter in connection with the rolling of the pitch during play—was interesting as it resulted from a recommendation of the first-class County Secretaries—a clear indication of the growing importance of County cricket.

It would be wrong to infer from the slowing down of legislation that the introduction of over-arm bowling had restored the balance between bowling and batting. The Hon. R. H. Lyttelton has told us that the new Law did indeed for a time give the bowlers a much-needed assistance, but the improvement of the pitches soon made their plight as serious as ever, and encouraged them to resort to more criminal practices than ever before. At first a few, and then many more, bowlers adopted "throwing" in its modern sense, and from 1882 onwards contemporary writers continually urged the umpires to stamp out the evil. In that year the captain of the visiting Australian team—his own bowlers were completely exonerated from any charge of unfairness—protested against the abuse, which had reached the stage in which the bowlers were openly boasting that they could "throw" once an over without fear of detection.

The M.C.C., having learnt by bitter experience that initiative on their part might not be well received, waited for outside pressure to make itself felt, and this was not long in coming. At a meeting of the County representatives in 1883, Lord Harris, later to become at once the most able and the strongest cricket administrator of the day, urged the Counties to agree not to employ any bowler with a doubtful action—six Counties agreed but three held aloof, though all joined in asking the M.C.C. to instruct the umpires to apply the "No ball" Law in its strictest sense. To this the M.C.C. Committee replied that the Law itself was as explicitly worded as it could be, that the M.C.C. umpires already had instructions to apply it strictly, and it was to be hoped that other Clubs would co-operate in putting an end to a scandal which, in Lord Harris's words, bid fair to cause a deterioration both in bowling and in the game generally. The M.C.C. were indeed in real difficulty, as the players were at variance as to both the symptoms and the cure of the disease—some thought that any fast bowler threw if his elbow was bent on delivery—others held that there were perfectly fair bowlers who bowled in this manner, but that others threw in spite of a straight-arm delivery; these, like Denison in an earlier period, held that it was not possible to define a "throw." Robert Lyttelton suggested that if the Lancashire captain refused to play Nash and Crossland, all unfair bowling would cease, to which Hornby naïvely replied that so long as Crossland was invited to play in representative matches at Lord's, when the M.C.C. umpires allowed his bowling as fair, he could hardly be expected to consider it otherwise. The publicity given to the matter at this time certainly had some temporary effect, due mainly to the strong feelings that the majority of the Counties had expressed.

Thus the matter stood at the time when the 1884 code of the Laws was in course of preparation; when it was presented at a Special General Meeting of the M.C.C., Lord Harris pointed out that he had protested against "throwing" in every way open to him, and it appeared to him that no solution except the replacement of professional umpires by amateurs would avail; as this alternative was hardly practicable, he secured a last-minute addition to the Laws of a clause directing the umpire at the bowler's end to call "No ball" if not satisfied with the absolute fairness of the delivery, which was really nothing more than a return to the

1845 formula; this had not been effective under different circumstances, and was not to be so under the present ones.

However disappointing these years may have been to the M.C.C., there was one point at least on which they could look back with satisfaction, for it was during the early part of the period that betting was finally stamped out to the great benefit of future generations of cricketers. Since 1774 the Laws of Cricket had contained special rules dealing with the settlement of bets made in connection with cricket matches, and it is pleasant to be able to record that the first step taken in the revision of the code in 1884 was to delete these *in toto*.

The period had been a testing one for the M.C.C.—it had seen great developments in the game itself; many lessons had been learnt; the constitution for governing the game had been established on a regular footing, in readiness for the impact that County cricket was to have upon its future, of which we have already seen a beginning. Indeed, in every direction both at home and overseas the growth of the game was to accelerate in the years that followed, and the machinery for dealing with the resulting problems remained in the hands of the M.C.C., who having ridden out the storms of the early and middle parts of the century, had once again established its prestige in the eyes of the world.

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Chapter Four

THE MODERN PERIOD, 1884 TO 1947

THE 1884 CODE

THE year 1884 has been chosen as the start of a new period because it saw the introduction of a completely revised code of the Laws. The steps leading up to this are worth recording, since they contained features which were later to prove of much value at the time the 1947 code was under preparation.

As a result of a discussion on one or two of the Laws at a meeting of the M.C.C. Committee in February 1883, it was decided to instruct a sub-committee comprising the Hon. S. Ponsonby Fane, V. E. Walker, Lord Winterton, Captain W. E. Denison, C. B. Marsham, the Hon. Alfred Lyttelton, Lord Harris and the Secretary of the M.C.C., H. Perkins, to revise the Laws "by defining terms, supplying omissions, and better wording, but without altering the spirit of the game." During the following summer the draft of the proposed code was circulated for comment to the County Clubs, the University Clubs, and to the Cricket Associations of Victoria, New South Wales, Philadelphia and New York—a circulation showing that the M.C.C. even at this early time fully appreciated its changing constitutional position arising from the rapid spread of the game.

After the replies had been considered, the final draft was adopted at a Special General Meeting of the M.C.C. in April 1884 with only one material amendment—proposed by Lord Harris and directed towards tightening up the "No ball" Law. This code—the third revision undertaken by the M.C.C., and destined to serve for over sixty years—was by far the most adequate ever produced. As might be expected from the terms of reference given to the drafting sub-committee no important changes were made in the intent of the Laws, but their sequence was materially altered, and much new matter was included to fill gaps previously left to the imagination; in fact a great deal of tidying up was

carried out for which no doubt Henry Perkins, a Secretary with a legal training, was largely responsible.

For the first time reference is found to the size of a team, to the number of innings, to the method by which runs are scored and the results of matches assessed, to the appointment of umpires and scorers, and many other minor omissions were made good.

To appreciate fully the development of the game since 1884, it is necessary in the first place to glance at the background against which it has expanded.

STRUCTURAL BACKGROUND

In no period has there been a more rapid development in the structure and organisation of cricket, as a result of the increased facilities for playing, improved means of transport, and the consequent growth of public interest in the game encouraged as it has been by the Press, Broadcasting, News Reels and Television.

There has been a steady increase in the number of countries anxious to enter the international arena, accompanied by a perhaps exaggerated importance being attached to the result of Test Matches, which to-day test the mental and physical stamina of the players to an extent unthought of sixty years ago. First-class inter-County matches are at least three times as many as in 1884. The Minor Counties' Championship starting from nothing has grown into an important competition in which nearly 150 matches are played in each season. League cricket has gone from strength to strength, and is now steadily spreading from its place of birth in the North of England, and clubs without number have sprung into being all over the world.

Overseas, the period has seen the institution of Inter-State competitions—in Australia the Sheffield Shield, in South Africa the Currie Cup, in New Zealand the Plunket Shield, in India the Ranji Trophy, and in the West Indies the Inter-Colonial Tournament.

This world-wide development has naturally brought in its train the administrative machinery necessary for its control, and a brief account of this building-up process will not be out of place. In the international field Boards of Control have come into being in England (1898), Australia (1905), South Africa (1890), New Zealand, West Indies and India. In 1909, the M.C.C. joined with Australia and South Africa in establishing the Imperial Cricket

Conference, to which New Zealand, West Indies and India were later admitted. This body controls the programme for the interchange of official visits, the status of "Test" matches, and the rules for the qualification of players to represent their respective countries.

At home, meetings of the County Secretaries have been a regular feature since 1882, and for many years the Secretaries exercised authority on a wide range of matters, acting for their County Committees, but to-day, following on the introduction of other machinery, these meetings do not deal with formal business outside the arrangement of fixtures.

The need for stronger representation was felt by the Counties, and as a result a body called "The County Cricket Council" was set up in 1887; this body endowed itself with full executive powers, but these were not used in opposition to the growing prestige of the M.C.C. Unfortunately owing to internal troubles within three years the Council adjourned *sine die*, without even troubling to dispose of its funds, and once again the meetings of the County Secretaries became the administrative link with the M.C.C.

Meetings of the County Captains became regular from 1895, and they took over some of the functions until then carried out by the Secretaries. In 1901, as we shall see, the Captains took action to put an end to the "throwing" scandal; this action was criticised as being *ultra vires* by one or two of the County Committees, and led to the M.C.C. being asked to establish the Advisory County Cricket Committee in 1904, as the result of which the business for the meetings of the Captains and Secretaries has been curtailed respectively to the appointment of umpires and the arrangement of matches.

In every other field, Associations, Federations and Conferences have sprung into being for the co-ordination and control of club championships and league competitions; amongst these bodies must be mentioned the Minor Counties' and the Services' Cricket Associations, the great League Federations of the North, the Club, and other, Cricket Conferences, many district umpires' Associations, and two very recent arrivals, the National Club and the English Schools' Cricket Associations—all admirably designed on a strict functional basis, and all loyally looking to the M.C.C. for guidance on matters related to the conduct of the game.

The great increase in the number of first-class matches played each season in England has undoubtedly told on the players—the Findlay Commission in 1938 drew serious attention to this point —but it is fair to say that the general spread of competitive cricket has had little impact on the shape of the game. When the Laws were revised in 1947 it was only found necessary to introduce here and there some added elasticity to provide for the widely varying conditions under which the game is played in different parts of the world, and in different grades of cricket wherever it be played.

ECONOMIC BACKGROUND

While, similarly, changes in the economic structure of the country have not materially affected the conduct of the game, they have in no small measure altered its social shape. Two Great Wars have profoundly modified every aspect of our national life, and cricket could not expect to escape the economic consequences—high taxation, inroads on capital and the break-up of country estates and other social changes materially added to the difficulties facing the game which for all practical purposes had been halted for eleven years between 1914 and 1946.

It has now become very difficult for any but full-time professionals to play regularly in matches lasting for more than one day. This gradual elimination of the amateur as the result of economic pressure has removed much of the gay adventure~~some~~/ous spirit so prominent in the first-class game at the opening of the twentieth century, and by no means the last to regret this has been that body of professional opinion which, during the long history of cricket, has recognised the great mutual benefit to be derived from the closest association of "Gentleman" and "Player."

Apart from the falling off in the number of first-class amateurs, there is little doubt that their standard of performance has suffered as the result of an economic situation which demands an ever higher degree of attention to education. Oxford and Cambridge Universities have been the main source of our great amateur tradition in the past, but they can no longer offer pleasant summers of recreation to young men; the Universities are increasingly recruited from State-aided scholars, and there is no longer room for the "athletic Commoner," who came up to play games, widen his education and take a Pass Degree. The relatively

few young cricketers who can give up time to University cricket are with rare exceptions lost in these days to the first-class game on coming down.

The position in regard to the recruitment of professionals has also deteriorated as opportunity for lucrative and secure employment has increased. It is idle to argue that the life of a cricketer, and particularly that of a bowler, is not a risk—not only is the shadow of injuries ever present, but at the best his active life will end at a time when men in other professions are in their prime. The introduction of national service in peace-time too has greatly increased the difficulty of the recruitment and training of young players.

While so far these economic factors have had little impact on the Laws of Cricket, it is possible that in future a greater emphasis may lie on the study of the requirements of the one-day game than has been the case in the past.

TECHNICAL BACKGROUND

If, as we have seen, structural and economic factors have hardly affected the Laws, the technical background of the period most certainly did so, and one reason was almost entirely responsible—the marked improvement of the cricket pitches between 1870 and the end of the century. As late as 1860 it is known that only the pitches at the Oval, Canterbury, Cambridge and Brighton approached modern standards, and elsewhere the introduction of over-arm bowling on the rough scythe-cut grounds made the game a severe trial of nerve. The advent of the mowing-machine, the heavy roller and Nottingham marl provided the opportunity for the groundmen; they were not slow to develop their art, and by 1900 match centres had been transformed.

Every student of the game is agreed that it was the production of the modern pitch which has changed the technique of the game in no uncertain manner. It was responsible for the "throwing" scandal of the last part of the nineteenth century—it enabled batsmen to follow the example of Arthur Shrewsbury in the development of back play—it led to the bowlers trying to get wickets by flight and swerve rather than by movement off the pitch—it led too to the development of the "googly," which resulted in even more attention being paid to playing off the back foot, and later to the adoption of the exaggerated two-eyed

stance and shortened back lift, so that all but a few of the leading batsman ceased to drive or cut—and finally it led to a very serious reduction in the number of genuine fast bowlers.

The score sheets clearly show that whereas prior to 1900 few County sides possessed more than three or four batsmen who could be relied upon to make runs when the conditions were difficult, later a sound defensive technique was acquired by the middle and most of the tail-piece of first-class teams. Mr. Altham, with his long experience, considers that in public-school cricket during the last forty years sides have become much harder to bowl out, and this view is strongly supported by the number of such two-day matches in which no decision is reached.

By the 1930's, except for the left-arm and "googly" bowlers, many of the others had given up any attempt to attack the wicket, but instead adopted negative tactics, which consisted of bowling just short of a length in the hope that the batsmen would ultimately get themselves out.

As a direct result of the excellence of the pitches in conjunction with the advance in defensive batsmanship, we had the unsavoury "Bodyline" interlude in Australia in 1932–3 and later in England; this affair will be discussed more fully later in relation to the Laws.

There were of course distinguished exceptions to the trend of negative bowling, and it is also right to say that by 1939 there were signs of a return to sanity by many of the offenders.

The natural result of this state of affairs was that legislation throughout the period was consistently directed towards giving more assistance to the bowler, and in fact the only remedy left untried was a reduction in the width of the bat, which has remained at four and a quarter inches ever since 1771.

It may fairly be asked why the groundmen have not been instructed to desist from activities which appear to have been so much opposed to the best interest of the game. The short answer to this is that they have often been so instructed.

Most careful enquiries both in 1901 and 1929 established the difficulty in laying down any hard and fast rules for the preparation of pitches under widely different conditions of soil and weather, but it was not until 1938, as the result of a recommendation by the Findlay Commission, that the Counties unanimously accepted a proposal put forward by the M.C.C. that all ground-

men should be instructed "that the ideal pitch is one which makes the conditions equal as between batsman and bowler without being dangerous, and that under no circumstances should pitches be prepared so as to favour the batsman unduly." At the same time the Counties relieved the groundmen of any criticism that might ensue and agreed in principle on a broad policy restricting the period allowed for the preparation of a pitch. The outbreak of war in 1939 interrupted the progress of what then appeared to be a promising cure for the evil—the same instructions remain in force to-day at a time when all executives are far more pitch-conscious than ever before.

One conclusion reached during the 1929 enquiries, that the modern pitch is no more true than its counterpart of forty years ago, requires qualification as most judges are agreed that it is less lively, and after rain seldom remains difficult for any length of time. This may well be due in part to the advent of the motor mowing-machine and roller, with their highly concentrated weight, and in part to the winter top-dressing of soil required on most grounds to make good the wear and tear resulting from the ever-increasing demand for more and more pitches during the season.

It would be wrong to place the entire blame for the effect of the improvement of pitches on the shoulders of the groundman, who has a psychological problem to overcome both for himself and his friends, the players; it must be remembered that there is a very narrow margin of error between a reasonable pitch and one which may become really dangerous in the later stages of a three-day match.

THROWING

The background of the perfect pitch therefore has coloured nearly every change in the Laws made between 1884 and 1947, during which the maintenance of a balance of power between bowler and batsman was never more carefully studied. Before discussing the many changes made with the object of improving the lot of the unfortunate bowler, it is necessary to complete the story of the "throwing" villainy from the point reached in the last chapter, when for a short time the action of the County captains had certainly done something to curb the evil.

A serious difference of opinion between Kent and Lancashire



The LAWS of the NOBLE GAME of CRICKET

as revised by the Club at St. Mary-le bone

THE BALL muſt weigh not leſs than Five Ounces and a Half, nor more than Five Ounces and Three Quarters. At the beginning of each Innings either party may call for a New Ball.

THE BAT

Muſt not exceed Four Inches and One Quarter, in the wideſt part.

THE STUMPS

Muſt be Twenty-four inches out of the ground, the BAILS Seven Inches in length.

THE BOWLING CREASE

Muſt be in a line with the Stumps, three Feet in length, with a RETURN CREASE.

THE POPPING CREASE

Muſt be Three Feet Ten Inches from the Wicket, and parallel to it.

THE WICKETS

Muſt be oppoſite to each other, at the diſtance of Twenty-two yards.

THE PARTY WHICH GOES FROM HOME

Shall have the choice of the Innings, and the pitching of the Wickets, which ſhall be pitched within Thirty Yards of a center fixed by the Adverſaries.

When the Parties meet at a Third Place, the Bowlers ſhall toſs up for the pitching of the Wickets, and the choice for going in.

It ſhall not be lawful for either party during a Match, without the conſent of the other, to alter the Ground, by rolling, watering, covering, mowing, or beating. This rule is not meant to prevent the Striker from beating the ground with his Bat near where he ſtands during the Innings, or to prevent the Bowler from filling up holes, watering his ground, or uſing ſawdeſt, &c. when the ground is wet.

THE BOWLER

Shall deliver the Ball with one foot behind the Bowling Creaſe, and within the Return Creaſe, and ſhall bowl four Balls before he changes Wickets, which he ſhall do but once in the ſame Innings.

He may order the Striker at his Wicket, to ſtand on which ſide of it he pleaſes.

THE STRIKER IS OUT

If the Ball is bowled off, or the Stump bowled out of the ground.

Or, if the Ball, from a ſtroke over or under the Bat, or upon his hand, (but not wriſt) is held before it touches the ground, although it be hugged to the body of the Catcher.

Or, if in ſtriking, or at any other time while the Ball is in play, both his feet are over the Popping Creaſe and his Wicket put down, except his Bat is grounded within it.

Or, if in ſtriking at the ball he hits down his Wicket.

Or, if under pretence of running a Notch, or otherwiſe, either of the Strikers prevent a Ball from being caught, the Striker of the Ball is out.

Or, if the Ball is ſtruck up, and he wilfully ſtrikes it again.

Or, if in running a Notch the Wicket is ſtruck down by a throw, or with the Ball in Hand, before his Foot Hand or Bat is grounded over the Popping Creaſe. But if the Ball is off, the Stump muſt be ſtruck out of the ground.

Or, if the Striker touches or takes up the Ball while in play, unleſs at the requeſt of the other Party.

If with his foot or leg he ſtops the Ball, which the Bowler in the opinion of the Umpire at the Bowler's Wicket ſhall have pitched in a ſtraight line to the Wicket, and would have hit it.

If the Players have croſſed each other, he that runs for the Wicket which is put down, is out; if they are not croſſed, he that has left the Wicket which is put down, is out.

When a Ball is caught, no Notch to be reckoned.

When a Striker is run out, the Notch they were running for is not to be reckoned.

If loſt Ball is call'd, the Striker ſhall be allowed four, but if more than four are run before loſt Ball is call'd, then the Striker to have all they have run.

When the Ball has been in the Bowler's or Wicket-keeper's hands, it is conſidered as no longer in play; and the Strikers need not keep within their ground, till the Umpire has called PLAY, but if the player goes out of his ground with an intent to run before the ball is delivered, the Bowler may put him out.

If the Striker is hurt, he may retire from his Wicket, and have his Innings at any time in that Innings.

If a Striker is hurt, ſome other Perſon may be allowed to ſtand out for him, but not go in.

If any Perſon ſtops the Ball with his Hat, the Ball is to be conſidered as dead, and the oppoſite Party to add Five Notches to their Score. If any are run, they are to have five in all.

If the Ball is ſtruck up, the Striker may guard his Wicket either with his Bat or his Body.

In ſingle Wicket Matches, if the Striker moves out of his ground to ſtrike at the Ball, he ſhall be allowed no Notch for ſuch ſtroke.

THE WICKET KEEPERS

Shall ſtand at a reaſonable diſtance behind the Wicket, and ſhall not move till the Ball is out of the Bowler's hand, and ſhall not by any noiſe incommode the Striker; and if his hands, knees, feet, or head, be over, or before the Wicket, though the Ball hit it, it ſhall not be out.

THE UMPIRES

Are the ſole judges of fair and unfair play, and all diſputes ſhall be determined by them; each at his own Wicket: but in caſe of a Catch, which the Umpire at the Wicket cannot ſee ſufficiently to decide upon, he may apply to the other Umpire, whoſe opinion is concluſive.

They ſhall allow Two Minutes for each man to come in, and Fifteen Minutes between each Innings; when the Umpire ſhall call *Play*, the party refuſing to Play ſhall loſe the Match.

They are not to order a player out, unleſs appealed to by the Adverſaries.

But if the Bowler's foot is not behind the Bowling Creaſe, and within the return Creaſe, when he delivers the Ball, they muſt, unaſked, call *No Ball*.

If the Striker runs a ſhort Notch, the Umpire muſt call *No Notch*.

The Umpire of the Bowler's Wicket, ſhall be firſt applied to decide on all Catches.

The Umpires are not to be changed during the Match, but by the conſent of both Parties.

BETS.

If the Notches of one Player are laid againſt another, the Bets depend on the Firſt Inning, unleſs otherwiſe ſpecified.

If the Bets are made upon both Innings, and one Party beats the other in one Inning, the Notches in the Firſt Inning ſhall determine the Bet.

But if the other Party goes in a ſecond time, then the Bet muſt be determined by the number on the Score.

Publiſhed by John Wallis, 13, Warwick-Square, London.

J. Wallis' broadsheet of the Laws of May 25th 1809 showing an adaptation of Hayman's picture



The Scorer, William Davies of Brighton
Drawn and lithographed by Thomas Henwood, 1842

in 1885 helped in the same direction, but the scandal soon again grew rife, and by 1896 had spread from England to Australia. At this period it seemed clear that professional umpires would not take action, and that the cure must lie in the joint action of the County committees and their captains.

The M.C.C. decided to deal with the matter by empowering *either* umpire to call "No ball," and by calling the umpires into consultation. The umpires were quite frank in stating that their position in the matter was most trying, and they insisted that it was the clear duty of the captains to see that their players did not adopt dubious methods, and still less excite the sympathy of the crowd by a display of theatrical disapproval whenever a bowler was called to book. The whole question was then put to the County captains, who previous to the 1901 season agreed not to bowl fourteen named bowlers; this course was repeated in 1902, and proved completely successful in putting an end to an extremely unsavoury period in the history of bowling.

THE "L.B.W." LAW

We will now examine the legislative action taken during the period with the object of giving assistance to the bowler, and in the first place a survey of the prolonged discussions about the "L.B.W." Law is necessary. As we have seen the improvement in the pitches enabled Arthur Shrewsbury to develop a new gospel of defensive batsmanship which soon made many converts. From about 1885 this technique involved an increasing use of the pads, which in a year or two was causing the deepest concern in the cricket world, and as a result the reform of the "L.B.W." Law became the question of the hour, and with one interlude has remained so to this day.

In the 1880's heated arguments arose over possible variants to the Law, which at that time restricted a "L.B.W." decision to the case of a ball which, pitching between wicket and wicket, would, in the opinion of the umpire, have hit the wicket. The most extreme alternative considered by the County Cricket Council was to add to the existing Law the words, "or, should he wilfully cross the wicket to defend it with his person"; this in effect would have been a reversion to the 1774 rule, and although seriously discussed in 1888 the proposal was not accepted since it clearly placed too heavy a responsibility on the umpires, and, even

granting them the wisdom of Solomon, was in any case too drastic.

Instead, the Council recommended to the M.C.C. an alternative to secure that the striker would be out if, with any part of his person between wicket and wicket, he should stop a ball which the umpire considered would have hit the wicket. This form was clearly an easy one for the umpires who were not required to adjudicate on the intent of the player or the pitch of the ball.

The M.C.C. gave the most careful consideration to this proposal, but reached the conclusion that the padding canker was not so deep-seated as to justify a change in the Law. Instead they issued an historic pronouncement "that the practice of deliberately defending the wicket with the person instead of the bat is contrary to the spirit of the game, and inconsistent with strict fairness, and the M.C.C. will discountenance and prevent this practice with every means in their power." Players, County committees and umpires were at the same time all asked to co-operate in an effort to put an end to the menace.

Even the most ardent supporters of reform had to admit that this action produced an immediate improvement, but it was short-lived and within five years padding had become so general that the M.C.C. republished their instruction after having first ascertained that there was no general wish to see the Law itself altered. Of all the reformers, Robert Lyttelton was the most consistent during the entire period with which we are concerned; right up to the time of his death in 1939 he never ceased to press the 1888 proposal on the M.C.C. Committee, and this pressure, in which he was joined by Alfred Lyttelton and E. V. Bligh, prompted the M.C.C. once more in 1900 to test the opinion of the Overseas Bodies, the Counties, players and umpires. Opinions still differed, but bowing to the views of the umpires, the M.C.C. Committee proposed a change in the Law on the lines of the Cricket Council recommendation of 1888. History however repeated itself; just as in 1863 a proposal to alter the Law had failed on a formal point of order, so at a particularly well-attended Special General Meeting in 1902 the change, while being favoured by the greater number present, did not get the two-thirds majority vote necessary for it to become Law.

The M.C.C. Committee nevertheless arranged for the proposal to be given a trial in the Minor Counties' Championship of 1902,

but at the end of the season the captains reported adversely on it; the trials were suspended, and little more was heard of the question for some years.

The lull lasted until 1926 when Lord Harris inspired a general enquiry into ways and means of helping the struggling bowler, but at first the Advisory County Cricket Committee were not prepared to recommend any alteration in the "L.B.W." Law. A further enquiry in 1928 by a sub-committee strongly representative of the bowlers of the day indicated some relaxation of opinion, and at once R. H. Lyttelton seized the opportunity of pressing for a change in the Law. His proposal was a compromise on the lines of the 1888 recommendation to provide that a batsman could be out from a ball pitching *outside* the line of the off-stump if it struck any part of his person between wicket and wicket.

Again however this change in the Law was not acceptable, but instead the sub-committee recommended an experimental trial of the "snick" rule under which the striker could be given out even if the ball had first touched the edge of his bat. Since this was in conflict with the Law permitting the striker to guard his wicket with his person after having played the ball, the rule had to make special provision on this point. As ever, opinions on the value of the rule differed, though the umpires consistently maintained that it did offer considerable benefit to the bowler, and that it presented little difficulty in operation: the experiment was however abandoned after the 1933 season.

This once more encouraged the reformers to press for a radical alteration in the Law itself on the lines of the formula proposed by Lyttelton in 1928 with the result that it was tried out during the following two seasons both in England and Overseas, and having been approved was finally introduced as Law in 1937.

So the matter stands to-day, and it would be a rash person to suggest that the question will not again be reopened. Indeed we know that Don Bradman has recently pressed the Australian Board to give trials to a rule under which the striker may be out from a ball pitching outside the off-stump, and hitting part of the batsman's person outside of the line between wicket and wicket.

The main lesson to be learnt from the history of this period would seem to be the importance, and the difficulty, in attaining simplicity in the "L.B.W." Law—without this it is inevitable that

too heavy a demand is made on the accurate judgment of the umpires in administering what is certainly the most difficult of all the Laws.

OTHER MEASURES ADOPTED TO ASSIST THE BOWLER

Individually some of these other measures may appear insignificant, but collectively they show the degree of thought and care devoted during the period to the restoration of the balance of power between the bowler and the batsman.

The first change, made in 1889, permitted a bowler to change ends as often as he wished in any innings provided he did not bowl two overs in succession. This change was off-set by another increasing the over from four to five balls; a further increase to six balls was made in 1900. These changes were designed to save time during play, but a trial of the eight-ball over in 1939 with the same object did not meet with the approval of the players in England, although the longer over had been a success in Australia and South Africa for many years.

In 1902 on the recommendation of the County captains the length of the Bowling crease was increased by two feet to eight feet eight inches; this change had been proposed by the well-known umpire Thoms as early as 1888, but subsequent to its adoption many good judges have held that it was a mistake as from it sprang an increase in swing bowling and the corresponding partial eclipse of genuine spin bowlers. This view may have been over-emphasised, as certainly in recent years all too few bowlers of any type appear to make much use of the crease at all.

The next advance in 1907—and this most certainly did encourage seam bowling—was the grant of a new ball after 200 runs had been scored off the old one; in recent years this rule has been altered experimentally for first-class cricket to one under which a new ball can be claimed after a fixed number of overs.

In 1925 it came to light that but few of the balls used in first-class cricket conformed to the Law as regards their weight and size—particularly the latter. This led at once to the balls being properly gauged, and next to bitter complaints by the bowlers that the standard balls were too large. In fact the manufacturers had in the previous years unwittingly provided an admirable trial of a smaller ball, which in 1927 was legalised.

Experiments carried out in 1872 with a larger wicket had

proved a failure, and in 1884 the only modification made in the new code in respect of the wicket was to place a limit on the thickness of the bail, which had not previously been specified. The larger wicket was again considered in 1899, and a proposal for an increase in the size of the wicket actually came before the M.C.C. Annual Meeting in 1903, but failed to obtain the necessary majority for a change. Nothing further occurred until the wicket was increased in 1931 to twenty-eight inches by nine inches after extensive trials at home and overseas.

"DIRECT ATTACK"

It would be wrong to omit reference to the controversy which raged in 1933 and 1934 round that type of bowling which came to be called "bodyline," and which is still so fresh in the mind of all cricketers. I do not propose to give the story in full detail as all who wish to refresh their minds on the subject will find it described at length in *Wisden's Almanack* for 1934, 1935 and 1936.

A very considerable degree of misunderstanding persists over the definition of this sort of bowling which has been agreed by all to "be an offence against the spirit of the game." In the first place it is definitely confined to "fast" bowling in its ordinary sense, and no one has ever suggested that a fast bowler is not perfectly entitled to bowl an occasional bouncer, and if he wishes to do so to place a strong on-side field. These are points which many followers of the game quite fail to appreciate. Secondly, the bowler only becomes guilty of an offence if he conducts a direct attack upon the batsman which in the opinion of the umpire is obviously the "persistent and systematic bowling of fast short-pitched balls at the batsman standing clear of his wicket."

Before an umpire can decide that an offence against the spirit of the game is being committed, he must therefore be satisfied on four points—that the bowling is both fast and short-pitched, that it is directed against the striker standing clear of his wicket, and that it is persistent. If he feels that this definition applies in its full sense, the umpire then knows that an unfair attack is in progress with which he has the power to deal. The existence or otherwise of a packed on-side field is only material in as far as it may give some indication of the motive of the bowler.

During their tour in Australia in 1932–3 the M.C.C. Team

exploited bowling of this type to a degree which the Australian authorities felt was not in the best interest of the game. At the time no definite charge of "unfairness" was made, and without this there seemed to be no question that the tactics being used were within the written Laws of the game. It was however clear that both in the interest of the game and of future international relations, any tendency towards a general introduction of direct-attack methods must be curbed.

The 1933 season in England passed without incident, and in November of that year the Counties agreed that no alterations to the Laws were desirable and that the captains could be relied upon not to permit or countenance bowling of the type. In the following July the Imperial Cricket Conference affirmed its adherence to this conclusion.

Despite this, direct-attack methods were resorted to in a few matches in 1934, and after the season the M.C.C. insisted on receiving a complete assurance from the Counties that this type of bowling must cease, and agreement was reached on the instructions to be given to the umpires.

These instructions clearly stated that cases of "direct attack" had occurred in 1934, that since this type of bowling had been accepted as being "unfair" the umpires were empowered to deal with it, and that the latter would be strongly supported in any action they thought fit to take since the Counties had agreed "that the County Committees and the County Captains shall take all steps in their power to eliminate from the game the type of bowling as now defined, i.e. direct attack." The instructions went on to state in explicit terms what action the umpires should take, and this has now been incorporated as a Note to the Law dealing with "Unfair Play."

In considering the manner in which this problem was dealt with, it should be compared with the story of "throwing" already given earlier in this chapter. The latter trouble persisted for years because certain captains decided to depart from the spirit of the game until the umpires pulled them up. Instead of dealing with the captains, as was finally done so successfully, the M.C.C. for too long tried to get the umpires to shoulder an invidious responsibility. In the case of "direct attack," this lesson had been learnt, and the answer to an at least equally difficult problem was found at once.

In conclusion it is of course clear that "direct attack," like "throwing," can be attributed entirely to the feeling of frustration engendered in bowlers of the highest quality when fighting against modern batsmanship on modern pitches. Authority must be on the alert to watch for latent developments which may well be contrary to the best interest of the game.

LEGISLATION OF A GENERAL NATURE

So far I have only referred to legislation resulting from efforts to assist the bowlers, and during the period there were but few others unrelated to this main theme. The only alterations of note were those concerned with the "follow on" and "declaration" Laws. Both were primarily directed towards reducing the number of drawn matches, which resulted from the huge scores following on the improvement of pitches and batting technique.

It has always been something of a mystery that, while the "follow on" Law dates from 1835, "declarations" were not provided for until 1889—this is the more extraordinary since the inspiration for both can be traced to the desire to avoid the burlesque of batsmen knocking down their own wickets, or deliberately getting themselves out in other ways.

The "follow on" Law was the subject of much muddled thought during the latter part of the nineteenth century when it was still obligatory. The University matches of 1891, 1893 and 1896 all pointed to the absurdity of a rule which forced a side to field for two consecutive innings on the improved pitches of the day, and then possibly to have to bat last on a crumbling pitch. It required however considerable pressure from Australia, and the failure to win a Test match after Australia had automatically followed on in 1899 at Old Trafford, to bring about the change to an optional rule in the following year.

CONSTITUTIONAL AND OTHER DEVELOPMENTS

Owing to the increasing importance of highly competitive cricket it gradually became necessary for the M.C.C. to supplement the Laws of Cricket in various ways. The pronouncement on the "L.B.W." problem in 1888 was followed by others which have led to the introduction of interpretations of a case law nature, and to the issue of what to-day are termed "Instructions to Umpires."

We have seen that proposals to alter the Laws themselves required the formal approval of a Special General Meeting of the M.C.C., and in 1894 a new Rule to govern this procedure was introduced in the following terms: "The Laws of Cricket shall not at any time be changed, except by a vote of two-thirds of Members present and voting at a Special General Meeting, of which notice shall be given in *The Times* and two Sporting papers, not less than two months before the day of the Meeting. Any amendment to a proposed alteration shall be advertised not less than one month before the day of Meeting. This notice shall state in distinct terms, the change in the law to be proposed, and no change shall be declared carried unless twenty Members at least shall vote in favour of it."

This formula clearly aimed at avoiding hasty interference with the conduct of the game, and its effect was felt both in 1901, when a proposal to alter the "L.B.W." Law received a majority vote insufficient for its passage into law, and again in 1903 when a resolution to add one inch to the width of the wicket met with a similar fate.

When it is remembered that no Law, or an amendment to an existing one, is ever submitted for adoption without prior consultation with Governing Bodies Overseas, and that every shade of opinion in the United Kingdom is taken into account, there can be little danger of the spirit and character of the game changing. Before any major change is accepted, it is usual to try it out experimentally for one or two seasons, as is being done at the present time in connection with the provision of a new ball during the progress of an innings.

As early as 1888 a proposal submitted by the M.C.C. Committee to even the balance between bowler and batsman was referred back by the Annual Meeting on the ground that there had not been sufficient time for its examination, and in particular that the Counties and Overseas Bodies had not been consulted. This provides an early and interesting example of the care exercised over any point which might affect the general well-being of the game. It is interesting to recall that, when resubmitted in the following year, the proposal was completely accepted which suggests that the reference back was made solely on constitutional grounds, and in no way to obstruct the passage of a useful piece of legislation.

We have now surveyed the development of the Laws of Cricket from the earliest times up to the introduction of the 1947 Code, of which an account will be found in the next chapter.

In the last resort the M.C.C. has always depended, and must always depend, on the cricket world for loyalty to the letter and the spirit of the Laws, and it would seem that cricketers are content to believe that the interests of the game they love are best secured by leaving its legislation in the hands of a single authority endowed with the wisdom and experience of years, and animated with the single desire—to promote its welfare.

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Chapter Five

THE PREPARATION OF THE 1947 CODE

WHEN a Bill is presented to Parliament to become the law of the land after passing through its several readings in both Houses, the procedure is well established, and understood by the electorate. In the case of a new code to govern the game of Cricket, the M.C.C. in 1944 had no precedent later than 1884 to which they could refer, and their dependency spanned the globe. A Parliamentary Bill is drafted by lawyers in a form designed to produce the minimum of litigation in its later application; its language is therefore that of the lawyer, and more often than not much of it is obscure to the layman. In addition, however contentious the Bill, given a working majority in Parliament the Government can be sure of its passage into law without damaging amendment.

The Laws of Cricket cannot and must not, be couched in strict legal terms, since they are drafted by laymen for use by laymen—in many cases by men of humble education, or even with little knowledge of the English language. Furthermore, as many will agree, in such a revision it is never desirable to jettison picturesque phrases of the eighteenth-century tradition, unless they are misleading in their intent. Finally, whereas an Act of Parliament aims at being all-embracing, it has always been the glory of Cricket that its Laws do not set out to cover every small point in a complicated game, but leave much unwritten for sensible interpretation by players imbued with its spirit.

Acts of Parliament, despite the greatest care of their expert draftsmen, normally prove to have untidy ends, and it is not to be expected that a new code of the Laws of Cricket can avoid obscurities.

The formal acceptance of such a new code depends in the first place on its receiving a two-thirds majority at a Special General Meeting of the M.C.C., on which occasion the Committee have no assured party backing marshalled by the party whips. Its

further and more testing acceptance by the cricket world depends on the extent to which the code accurately interprets the differing requirements of the game in all parts of the world. United Nations and Leagues of Nations have seldom reached agreement on matters affecting individual sovereignties, and it is surely one of the wonders of the modern world that in games, which are by no means divorced from considerations of national prestige, the authority of such bodies as the M.C.C. and the Royal and Ancient Golf Club continue to serve the interests of their respective dependants without regard to the differences of national cultures, languages and sovereignties. This will only persist so long as such authorities continue as always to consult their associated organisations with a view to reaching decisions by agreement.

Just as Acts of Parliament are supplemented by case law decisions, so too the rules of any game require from time to time official interpretations, and in most cases the quicker these can be provided the better it will be for the prestige of the responsible authority and for the future of the game. In Cricket, whereas an alteration to the Laws requires the approval of a Special General Meeting of the M.C.C., the committee of the Club have never since its formation failed to enquire into any matter brought to their notice, and to issue, whenever necessary, an interpretation to act as case law for the future. These decisions have been promulgated in the form of public pronouncements, instructions to umpires, or as Notes added to the Laws.

We have seen that the adoption of the 1884 revision synchronised with a rapid expansion of international, county, league and club cricket. This fact, and the readiness of the M.C.C. to deal with every individual enquiry addressed to them, led to a considerable increase in the number of interpretations and definitions, and in 1902, the then Secretary, the late Sir Francis Lacey, published an edition of the Laws with full notes and interpretations, together with a special section containing instructions to the umpires, all of which had of course from time to time been approved by the M.C.C. Committee, often after consultation with, or on the suggestion of the County Cricket Clubs. This publication had a very wide sale both at home and overseas, and had reached its 16th edition by 1939; by then the Notes were beginning to dwarf, if not to obscure, the Laws proper—in some cases indeed they appeared to over-ride them.

The late Sir Stanley Jackson had long previously suggested the necessity for a complete overhaul of the code to Lacey, whose reply invariably was, "You make the attempt, and then if you see daylight, I'll join you in the task." Lacey, of course, appreciated the dangers and difficulties attendant on any tampering with an already accepted code of procedure; it could only succeed if all the wide-flung interests were drawn into consultation with the strictly limited objective of collating and tidying up the existing code, resisting entirely all temptation to make changes in the conduct of the game, for which inevitably conflicting suggestions would be received. This, we have already seen, was the basis of the 1884 revision, and in my opinion must always apply in similar circumstances if the task of revision is ever to be finished without the introduction of objectionable compromises, which are inappropriate for any game, and may well lead to loss of prestige in the position of the governing authority.

Before the end of the Second World War, the 1884 code had been in use for over sixty years, and clearly the psychological moment to obtain agreement on a successor would be before cricket once more resumed the even tenor of its way amidst the inevitable chaos of the peace to come; Sir Stanley Jackson then in 1944 obtained the agreement of the M.C.C. Committee to a thorough revision.

Apart from the desirability of collating the Laws and their Notes, the 1884 code, thorough as its revision had been, disclosed one or two glaring omissions, and the sequence of its Laws was by no means logical. The amendments during its long life had in all cases not been too happily worded, and in any case amendments however carefully framed must in the mass lead to obscurity. Furthermore the old code did not provide sufficient elasticity to meet the requirements of the various levels of competitive cricket, or of the differing climates in which the game had come to be played.

It is interesting to place on record that it was an enquiry from the Bradford Central Cricket League in 1943 on the case of a Run out off a "No ball," arising from an obscure amendment to the Law in question, which was directly responsible for the decision to revise the code.

The committee laid down terms of reference for the task—these stressed the importance of a logical rearrangement, the incorpora-

tion in the Laws of appropriate matter hitherto given in the form of Notes, the provision of definitions wherever necessary, and the elimination of obscurities; changes of intent on major points were to be avoided, and to prevent the Laws proper being over-loaded with points of detail, definitions and interpretations would continue to be provided in the form of Notes to the relevant Laws.

It was agreed that the Secretary, aided by Mr. H. S. Altham and Mr. E. R. Wilson as assessors, should work out a preliminary draft to be considered by a Laws sub-committee under Sir Stanley Jackson, consisting of Lt.-Col. R. T. Stanyforth, Mr. R. W. V. Robins, Mr. H. S. Altham, Sir Pelham Warner, Lt.-Col. H. A. Henson and myself. It was at once clear that the success or failure of the project depended on the result of this initial stage since the reception of any proposal would largely turn upon the clarity of its presentation.

The preparatory work included a very detailed examination of the old code and its interpretations, against the background of correspondence in the files at Lord's, in order to establish the points which had caused the greatest difficulty to umpires and players. It then involved not only the complete rewriting of the old code, but preparing the full arguments in favour of all the suggested alterations both of sequence and wording.

Under the war conditions existing at the time the preliminary work was in progress, meetings for discussion could only take place at infrequent intervals—this fact in itself emphasised the absolute necessity for stating in meticulous detail the reasons for every change to be proposed in the preliminary draft.

This draft was considered and amended in turn by the Laws sub-committee and the full M.C.C. Cricket sub-committee, and by July 1945 the main committee had accepted the final version as suitable to issue for criticism and suggestions to cricket authorities both at home and overseas.

This consultation stage was of course crucial since it alone would indicate the degree of acceptance of the first draft not only by Clubs in England, but by the important Boards of Control representing cricket opinion in Australia, South Africa, New Zealand, India and the West Indies. A carefully prepared memorandum explaining the limited purpose of the revision was issued with the draft early in September 1945. To allow for postal delays, which at that time applied both to sea and air mails, and for

the difficulty in arranging meetings of delegates in countries as large as Australia, seven months were allowed for consideration, and even this proved too short in the case of Australia. Full information about the project was given to the Press, and in all over eighty cricket organizations at home and overseas were invited to give their views on the proposals. It is interesting to record that apart from the Overseas Bodies already mentioned, copies of the draft were sent to Canada, Ceylon, Fiji, Kenya, Bermuda and Holland.

The results exceeded all expectation as in principle the revision was warmly welcomed everywhere. Naturally many valuable suggestions on points of detail were received, and of these only two gave rise to difficulty in the minds of the Laws sub-committee. Both points were of considerable importance, and both arose from previous interpretations rather than from the Laws proper; therefore although the suggestions did in fact alter the conduct of the game quite materially, they did not constitute a major alteration of the Laws.

The first of these concerned the playing out of the last over of a match—the previous custom had been to leave a decision on this to the batting side in the case when a wicket fell within two minutes of "Time." It was decided that this was a one-sided option, and it would be fairer to provide for the final over to be played out at the request of either captain.

The second suggestion pointed out the unsatisfactory nature of the custom that a wicket could be regarded as "down" if either bail was in the slightest degree disturbed, a custom which was interpreted in different ways by different umpires. In this case the sub-committee agreed that the rule must be made clearer, but were not inclined to recommend a change which might not be in the best interest of the bowler.

It was decided to consult Overseas Bodies and the Counties again on both these matters, and as a result the rule for playing out the final over of a match was accepted, and the Australian view that the criterion for the wicket to be "down" should depend on the actual fall of a bail was generally approved.

The period taken up by this consultation was as much as fourteen months, but there is no doubt that the cricket world warmly appreciated the care being taken to reach agreement on the more difficult matters which had arisen. It was not until December 1946

that the M.C.C. Committee approved of a final draft to be presented in accordance with the rules of the Club at a Special General Meeting to be held on May 7th, 1947.

It now remained for the body of members of the M.C.C. to give their approval of the new code, and the 7,000 members were notified in January that they could obtain advance copies of the proposal. At the same time copies were issued to all Overseas Bodies, and to the Press.

This led to a very few useful suggestions being received for improving the draft; in the case of four Laws the committee agreed to meet the views expressed by submitting amendments to the main proposal—in no case did these involve more than verbal alteration, or the incorporation in the Law itself of matter already included as a Note to the Law, or vice versa.

At the Special General Meeting on May 7th, the members were clearly impressed with the care taken over the revision which from first to last had been spread over nearly three years, and the new code was unanimously accepted at a particularly well-attended meeting.

At the same time it was agreed that in order to give time for printing and distribution both to overseas and to clubs at home, the revision would not operate before the commencement of the 1948 English season.

It can be claimed that the terms of reference laid down for the work were complied with and no serious alteration was made to the conduct of the game. The rearrangement of the Laws on a strictly logical basis resulted in a great gain of ease of reference, and helped towards a reduction in the number of the Laws. Sixty old Laws, including three for one-day matches, were condensed into forty-seven, and the letterpress of the Laws and Notes was reduced by about one-sixth in bulk.

The provision of one or two defining Laws and the inclusion of many established interpretations in the body of the Laws enabled several of the old Notes to be dropped; this, and a close scrutiny of the Laws and their Notes to eliminate obscurities, resulted in considerable clarification.

The only alterations in the conduct of the game occurred where actual experience had shown that the old Laws had caused difficulty for the umpires; these changes are set out in detail in Chapter 6.

In use during the 1948 season, when it stood up to the test of an Australian visit to England, the new code has proved acceptable to both players and umpires. The fact that it provides more elasticity in certain important respects than its predecessor should mean fewer alterations on points of detail in the future.

In this epitome of the birth of a code, it would be wrong not to refer to the enthusiastic guidance of Sir Stanley Jackson who, both as Chairman of the M.C.C. Cricket sub-committee and of the special Laws sub-committee, gave unstinted time and patience to the very considerable work involved in the task. We have already seen how anxious he had been for such a revision, and without his support and interest it is doubtful if it could ever have achieved the results so generally recognised. It was indeed tragic that he should have died a few weeks prior to the adoption of the code which he had done so much to inspire and produce.

Chapter Six

THE GROWTH OF THE LAWS OF CRICKET

A CHRONOLOGY OF THE DEVELOPMENT OF THE GAME DURING THE PERIOD 1744 TO 1947

Introductory

A general sketch of the growth of the Laws since 1744 has been given in Chapters 2 to 5, but, to the best of my knowledge, an accurate and complete chronology of the statutory changes has never previously been attempted. Such a list, covering as it does a period of over 200 years, must necessarily be lengthy, and if every detail was meticulously included it would become confused.

I have therefore excluded unessential modifications of wording whenever the intention of a Law remains unaltered. After careful consideration of various alternatives, I decided that the best sequence from the point of view of the reader would be to follow the sectional arrangement of the Laws used in the 1947 Code (*vide* Appendix II) for the entries against any single date. By giving each entry a Serial Number, it has been possible to link it both to the last previous one on the same subject, and to the next succeeding one—this method of referencing will enable the full story of any Law to be extracted without undue difficulty.

In certain cases fresh light has been thrown on the date or significance of a change, and this has been indicated by printing in **bold type.**

THE 1744 CODE

We have already seen that the Laws of 1755, which are reproduced in Appendix I, agree with those in the 1744 version except for some modernisation of wording. While the latter were "settled by the CRICKET-CLUB, and play'd at the ARTILLERY-GROUND, LONDON," the former were laid down by the representatives of several clubs, particularly that of the Star and Garter in Pall Mall.

As it is necessary to link subsequent changes in the Laws to the earliest form, the main features of the 1744 Code are set out below

arranged in the order of the well-defined sections of the 1947 version. It is interesting to note how little the broad framework of the game has changed during the past 200 years.

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
SECTION A—THE PLAYERS, UMPIRES AND SCORERS				
1744	1	The size of a team is not stated, though it is known that the Grand Matches of the period were played with eleven players on each side.	—	1884
	2	No "fresh men" were allowed to act as substitutes on any account.	—	23
	3	As to-day, the umpires could be changed during a match, but only by agreement.	—	24
	4	Scoring was by "notches" cut on a stick, **and "runs" were so termed until *c.* 1811, though the word "notch" did not finally disappear from the Laws until 1823.**	—	54
SECTION B—THE IMPLEMENTS OF THE GAME, AND THE GROUND				
	5	The Ball, weighing between 5 and 6 ounces, was to be marked by the umpires so that it could not be changed during a match.	— —	25 47
	6	There was no restriction on the width or length of the Bat.	—	22
	7	The Pitch was selected by the side which won the toss; this also determined the choice of innings. (*Vide* Serial Number 11.)	—	27
	8	The Wickets, 22 yards apart, consisted each of two stumps and measured 22 by 6 inches, with one bail 6 inches long.	—	34
	9	No limit of length was laid down for the Bowling Crease, and the Popping Crease was 3 feet 10 inches from the wicket.	— —	28 60

CHRONOLOGY

Date	Serial No. of Change	Particulars of Change	Reference to Serial Nos. Prior	Later
SECTION C—THE CARE AND MAINTENANCE OF THE PITCH				
	10	No special rules existed, and there is no mention of any provision for rolling, cutting or covering the pitch during a match.	—	40
SECTION D—THE CONDUCT OF THE GAME				
	11	The choice of innings as at present depended on the "Toss of a Piece of Money." The number of innings was not stated but in the Grand Matches it was usual for each side to have two innings.	—	27
	12	The intervals allowed after a batsman was dismissed, and between innings were the same as at present. The umpires called "Play" *three* times after which refusal to play was "at the Peril of giving the Game."	—	29

Note to Serial Numbers 8 and 9

Prior to 1700 the form of the wicket is a matter of some doubt, and it seems likely that it varied from district to district. Nyren, quoting from a MS. lent him by William Ward, has described one pattern which is of particular interest as suggesting the origin of the term "Popping." He records that, "Between the stumps a hole was cut in the ground, large enough to contain the ball and the butt-end of the bat. In running a notch, the striker was required to put his bat into this hole instead of the modern practice of touching over the popping crease. The wicket-keeper, in putting out the striker when running, was obliged, when the ball was thrown in. to place it in this hole before the adversary could reach it with his bat. Many severe injuries of the hands were the consequence of this regulation; the present mode of touching the popping crease was therefore substituted for it." In other words the batsman to be home had to pop his bat into the popping hole before the wicket-keeper popped the ball into it.

Haygarth and Pycroft lend support to the existence of this form of wicket, and two oil paintings in the M.C C. Collection actually show it in use. These paintings may not be strictly contemporary, but they are early enough to provide supporting evidence of the true origin of the term "Popping." Haygarth's suggestion that this form of wicket may have remained in use until the late eighteenth century does not, however, appear to have any substance.

Goldwin's description of cricket in 1706, supported as it is by the Richmond Articles of Agreement of 1727 (*vide* Chapter 1), is evidence of the disappearance of the Popping Hole at a considerably earlier date The completion of a run by "touching the Umpire's stick" appears to have been the immediate forerunner of the Popping Crease at least as a local variation in parts of Sussex and Surrey The general introduction of the crease could hardly have been long delayed as we can imagine in the case of a run out that an umpire in danger of being run down by the batsman would have found it difficult to concentrate his attention on the breaking of the wicket.

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
	13	No mention is made of how notches were made. **The umpires adjudicated on good or bad runs, and this presumably included the case of a short run.** If the fielding side obstructed a run, the umpires could order a notch to be scored as a penalty.	—	30, 41, 51
		There is no reference to Boundaries.	—	1884
		There is no reference to "Lost ball."	—	51
	14	The "Over" was a four-ball one at the end of which the umpire called "Over."	—	31, 108
		The bowler was allowed to change ends once only in any innings.	—	101
	15	While the term "Dead ball" is not used, the meaning is implicit in the Laws.	—	49
	16	A "No ball" was only called when the bowler's "hinder foot" was in front of the bowling crease. It entailed no penalty, and **it would seem that the ball was regarded as dead so that the striker could not score off it.**	—	54
	17	"Byes" and possibly "Leg Byes" are implied though not explicitly mentioned.	—	56
		"Wides" were not recognised.	—	56
	18	The bail had definitely to fall from the top of the stumps for the wicket to be down—if the bail was already off, then as now, a stump must be struck out of the ground with ball in hand.	—	85
	19	An injured batsman could retire, and *claim* to resume his innings later.	—	96
	20	Seven of the nine ways in which to-day a batsman can be "Out" have remained unaltered.	—	32

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
		"Silver Billy" Beldham is recorded to have stated that he remembered the introduction of the first "L.B.W." Law as a cure for the "shabby" methods adopted by the batsmen, but **the 1744 Laws in fact long previously allowed the umpires to adjudicate on "standing unfair to strike."**	—	32
		In the matter of Obstruction, the striker was only out if he left his running ground to prevent a catch; in their running ground either batsman could obstruct a catch, provided they did not use bat or hand for the purpose.	—	38
SECTION E—DUTIES OF THE UMPIRES				
	21	In general the present-day rules applied, but in addition the umpires were to judge of "all frivolous delays, of all Hurts, whether real or pretended, and are discretionally to allow what Time they think proper before the Game goes on again."	—	138
		As to-day, the umpires could only order a batsman out on appeal. Each umpire at his own wicket adjudicated on all appeals.	—	33
Sept. 25th 1771	22	**A committee of the Hambledon Club limited the width of the bat to 4¼ inches in the circumstances already described in Chapter 2.** This decision, to be later confirmed by the County representatives, is evidence of the Hambledon prestige at this time—the fact that they settled on a width which has remained unaltered since, does credit to their perception.	6	26

THE REVISION OF 1774

This revision was carried out by a committee representing Kent, Hampshire, Surrey, Sussex, Middlesex and London—**the first occasion on record of any meeting of County representatives. Since there is no evidence that the committee which carried out the revision in 1755 was a standing one, it is quite probable that some of the changes which appear for the first time had been adopted as common practice previously—we know that this was so in the case of Serial Number 22.**

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
Feb. 25th 1774	23	**Substitutes in the field are no longer definitely prohibited, and it appears probable that they were in fact allowed by consent.**	2	45
	24	**There is no reference to the umpires being changed by mutual consent.**	3	46
	25	The tolerance for the weight of the ball is reduced to be between 5½ and 5¾ ounces.	5	82
	26	The limit of 4¼ inches for the width of the bat is confirmed.	22	77
	27	The visiting team has choice of pitch and innings—the pitch to be within 30 yards of a point chosen by the home team. Should the game be played at a "Third Place," i.e. on a neutral ground, the Bowlers are to toss up for choice of pitch and innings.	7, 11	52, 53
	28	The Bowling Crease is defined as being 3 feet long on either side of the wicket.	9	65
	29	The interval between innings is increased from 10 to 15 minutes. The umpires are only required to call "Play" once instead of three times before deciding a match against a side refusing to play.	12	88
	30	**"Short runs" are specially referred to for the first time.** (While the Law	13	—

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
		has remained essentially unaltered, it is of interest to find that a proposal to deduct two runs was considered at the time of the 1835 revision "because such striker, not having run home in the first instance, cannot have started in the second from the proper goal.")		
	31	**The umpires are not directed to call "Over."**	14	79
	32	**The "Hit wicket" Law disappears temporarily.**	20	37
		The first specific "L.B.W." Law is introduced providing for the striker to be out if he "puts his *leg* before the wicket with a *design* to stop the ball, and actually prevents the ball from hitting his wicket by it." This Law clearly placed a very heavy premium on good umpiring, and it is interesting to note the use of the word "leg" instead of "person," which appeared later.	20	43
	33	**The jurisdiction of the umpires for decisions "each at his own wicket" is no longer defined.**	21	44
c. 1775	34	The three-stump wicket is introduced, with *one* bail 6 inches long. (*Vide* Chapter 2.)	8	35
Sept. 1st 1785	35	The first reference in an edition of the Laws to the three-stump wicket is found in the Wallis print of this date.	34	36
c. **1786**	36	**There is a reference to the use of two bails for each wicket in the Maidstone edition of the Laws.**	35	39
	37	**The same edition again contains the "Hit wicket" Law.**	32	42
c. **1787**	38	**The second Maidstone edition includes a new Law dealing with**	20	107

CHRONOLOGY

Date	Serial No. of Change	Particulars of Change	Reference to Serial Nos. Prior	Later
		"Obstruction" in identical wording to that later used in the first M.C.C. Code. This reads, "If under pretence of running a Notch, or otherwise, *either* of the Strikers prevent a Ball from being caught, the Striker of the ball is out." **It might be inferred from this, and from the evidence of Serial Numbers 36 and 37, that a committee carried out some slight revision of the 1774 Code just before the M.C.C. came into being.**		

THE FIRST M.C.C. CODE—1788

These Laws are given in Britcher's *Scores* published in 1796 as the Code "revised by the Cricket Club at St. Mary-le-bone, May 30th, 1788." **It is not certain that Britcher may not have incorporated changes approved during the intervening years.**

May 30th 1788	39	The number of stumps is not specified, and this point is not rectified officially until 1838. (*Vide* Serial Number 83.) **It would seem that the three-stump wicket had been so commonly accepted by this year that no special reference to it was thought necessary.** Serial Number 36 is not confirmed, and the *bail* is specified as being 6 inches long.	36	48
	40	For the first time a Law provides for rolling, watering, covering, mowing and beating of the pitch during a match *by mutual consent.*	10	64
	41	It is provided that no run shall be scored if the striker be caught, and that the run in which a batsman is run out shall not be reckoned.	13	—

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
	42	The reintroduction of the "Hit wicket" Law is confirmed in a new form of words.	37	61
	43	The application of the "L.B.W." Law is restricted to a ball which has "pitched in a straight line to the wicket."	32	67
	44	The jurisdiction of the umpires in respect of an appeal for a catch is again introduced.	33	81
1798	45	The provision of substitutes in the field is recognised without restriction as to where they may field.	23	62
	46	Permission to change umpires by mutual consent is again granted.	24	76
	47	A new ball may be demanded by either side at the start of each innings.	5	130
	48	The wicket is increased to measure 24 by 7 inches, with the *bail* 7 inches long. **(The benefits granted to the bowler by Serial Numbers 47 and 48 are particularly interesting as the first evidence of a set policy to maintain an even balance between the bowler and the batsman—*vide* Chapter 2.)**	39	50
	49	A new Law provides a penalty of 5 runs if the fieldsman stops a ball with his hat. **No doubt the adoption of the top hat as part of the usual attire of the players led to this introduction. The term "Dead ball" is used for the first time in this Law.**	—	127
			15	1884
After 1803 but before May 25th 1809	50	The *bails* are referred to in the plural for the first time in a reliable edition of the Laws.	48	59
	51	A "Lost ball" Law is introduced—the striker to score all the runs he may have made, with a minimum allowance of four.	13	66

CHRONOLOGY

Serial No. of Change	Particulars of Change	Reference to Serial Nos. Prior	Later
Before 1811 52	**The pitch is to be selected by the umpires within 30 yards of a centre selected by the opposing sides.**	27	63
53	**Tossing is again to decide the choice of innings.**	27	—
54	**It would seem from an examination of unofficial codes that as late as 1828 the old rule by which the visiting side had the choice of pitch and innings continued to be used in the case of Home and Away matches being arranged. The new rule however applied in all other cases, and we can imagine in all the Grand Matches.**		
55	**The striker is allowed to play at a "No ball," and to count any resulting runs—he can only be out by being run out. (~~This change is the first evidence of the attack to develop in the ensuing years against the introduction of round-arm bowling—*vide* Chapter 2.~~)**	4, 16	55, 120
56	**The term "run" instead of "notch" is seen here for the first time—it became general by 1823.**	4	—
	The ball is to be bowled under-hand and delivered with the hand below the elbow. ~~As in the case of Serial Number 54, we here have evidence of a serious endeavour to obstruct the advent of "throwing bowling."~~	54	58
	A Law for "Wides" appears for the first time—the penalty to be one run entered as a "Bye," though this term remains undefined. This entry however justifies the assumption made in Serial Number 17 that "Byes" had always been a recognised means of scoring.	17	71, 103

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
Before 1817	57	**A fresh bowler is allowed two trial balls, but having taken them, he must then complete the four-ball over.**	—	79
	58	**The "No ball" Law was again modified with the object of curbing round-arm bowling.** The resulting Law was so complicated that in fact it materially assisted the sponsors of the "march of intellect" in their campaign. (*Vide* Chapter 2.)	55	70
Before 1821		**The changes listed in Serial Numbers 59 to 61 were almost certainly made in 1819,** as G. B. Buckley has traced a Press notice of a match played in Hampshire on June 29th of that year, described as being the first "played out of London with the wicket two inches higher than usual."		
	59	**The Wicket is increased to measure 26 by 7 inches.**	50	68
	60	**The distance of the Popping crease from the wicket is increased to 4 feet as a result of the increase in the height of the wicket.**	9	—
	61	**The striker is out "Hit wicket" if any part of his dress breaks the wicket.**	42	—
Before May 1823	62	**Substitutes are not to bowl, keep wicket, field at point, middle wicket or long stop (to a fast bowler), except by agreement. A direction that the umpires must be punctilious in enforcing this Law was omitted in 1827, but was restored by 1830.**	45	75
	63	**The selection of the pitch is left entirely to the umpires, i.e. the opponents need no longer select a centre within 30 yards of which the wickets would be pitched by the umpires.**	52, 53	1947

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
	64	**After rain the pitch may be changed by mutual consent.**	40	73
	65	**The Bowling crease is increased to 6 feet 7 inches with Return creases at each end of it at right angles.**	28	69
	66	**The allowance for "Lost ball" is increased from four to six runs.**	51	—
	67	**The "L.B.W." Law is altered to require the ball to have been delivered in a straight line to the wicket, and to have struck any part of the batsman's person.** **This alteration was certainly designed to assist the bowler. As the 1788 rule required that the ball should pitch straight, the first clause must have encouraged the round-arm supporters, and its inclusion appears to have been contrary to the M.C.C.'s current policy (*vide* Chapter 2).**	43	87
After May 1823 but before 1825	68	**The Wicket is increased to measure 27 by 8 inches, with the stumps of sufficient thickness to prevent the ball from passing through, and with bails 8 inches long.** **This change is almost certainly that mentioned in *Bell's Life* of June 27th, 1823, as "newly adopted."** (*Vide* G. B. Buckley, *Fresh Light on Pre-Victorian Cricket.*)	59	83
After 1825 but before 1828	69	**The Bowling crease is increased to 6 feet 8 inches to conform with the width of the wicket.**	65	117
May 19th 1828	70	As a sequel to the experimental round-arm matches played in 1827 already discussed in Chapter 2, the "No ball" Law was adopted in a simplified form leaving it crystal clear that the bowler must keep his hand and arm below the elbow.	58	72

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
	71	The allowance for a "Wide" is to be entered as such and no longer as a "Bye."	56	80
July 27th 1829	72	A penalty for a "No ball" is introduced for the case in which no run is otherwise obtained.	70	74
Before 1831	73	**An old provision permitting the bowler to water his run up to the wicket is deleted.**	64	93

THE REVISION OF 1835

There is every evidence that this was the most thorough revision undertaken up to that time; it must have started in 1834 as the proposed alterations in the Laws were publicly advertised before the end of that year. As has been already explained in Chapter 2, the Laws were presented for adoption at the Anniversary Meeting of the M.C.C. held on May 14th, 1835, when there was only time to deal with Serial Number 74, and the remainder of the code was referred to a special Committee which sat on May 19th. A Special Meeting held on the following day confirmed the recommendations of the Committee.

May 14th 1835	74	The "No ball" is altered to legalise round-arm bowling in the following terms, "The ball must be bowled. If it be thrown or jerked, or if the hand be above the shoulder in the delivery, the umpire must call 'No ball'."	72	80
May 20th 1835	75	Substitutes, even with consent, may not bowl, keep wicket, field at point, cover point, or long stop—in the last-named position the embargo now applies to every type of bowling.	62	94
	76	A Law to prohibit umpires from betting appears later in the day than might be expected, since the selling of matches had become a scandal many years earlier. Either side is given power to dismiss an offending umpire.	46	1947
	77	The limit of 38 inches for the length of the bat is introduced.	26	—

CHRONOLOGY

Date	Serial No. of Change	Particulars of Change	Reference to Serial Nos. Prior	Later
	78	The first "follow on" Law appears obliging a side to bat again if 100 runs behind on the first innings.	—	95
	79	A fresh bowler is allowed two trial balls, but if he takes even one, he must then finish the over.	57	84
		The umpire is again instructed to call "Over" after the four balls have been bowled.	31	—
	80	The umpire is specially enjoined to call "No ball" immediately on delivery, and "Wide" as soon as the ball has passed the striker.	71	89
			74	90
		The ball is to be regarded as "dead" on the call of "Wide," so that no more than the penalty of one run can be reckoned.		
	81	For an appeal to be entertained it must be made before the next ball is bowled.	44	—
May 10th 1838	82	The size of the ball is specified for the first time; it must measure between 9 and 9¼ inches in circumference.	25	122
	83	**Although often referred to in earlier unofficial editions of the Laws, it is specifically stated for the first time officially that each wicket consists of three stumps, of *equal* and sufficient thickness to prevent the ball from passing through.**	68	1884
	84	**Trial balls are no longer allowed to a fresh bowler.**	79	—
	85	**If one bail remains in place, the removal of the remaining bail renders the wicket "down" for the purpose of a "Run out," without the necessity of striking a stump from the ground.**	18	106
May 9th 1839	86	Practice with the bat is prohibited during play.	—	—

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
	87	The "L.B.W." Law reverts to the 1788 version which required a ball to have been pitched straight irrespective of the line of its delivery.	67	99
May 14th 1840	88	The interval between innings reverts to 10 minutes.	29	—
June 17th 1844	89	The batting side is allowed to reckon all the runs resulting from a "Wide" —the ball is no longer "dead" on the call of "Wide." **This was a decision of the M.C.C. Committee which seems to have been brought into use at once, though it was not officially confirmed until the Anniversary Meeting of the following year.**	80	91
June 2nd 1845	90	The umpires are to call "No ball" if not *absolutely satisfied* that the hand is below the shoulder in delivery.	80	97
	91	A "Wide" is defined as a ball not "fairly within the reach of a batsman." At the same time it is made clear that it is not a "Wide" if the striker moves to bring himself within reach of the ball.	89	134
	92	**The umpires are required to change ends after each side has had one innings.**	81	104
May 3rd 1849	93	Subject to a request by either side being made to the umpires within one minute of the end of an innings, permission is given for the pitch to be swept and rolled between the innings.	73	98
May 15th 1854	94	The consent of the opposite side is required to the particular player required to act as fielding substitute, and to the place in which he may field. A runner may be allowed for an injured striker, who however is liable to	75	103

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
		be run out if either he or his runner is out of their ground while the ball is in play.		
	95	The limit of runs for a "follow on" is reduced to 60 runs in the case of a one-day match, and to 80 in the case of a game of longer duration.	78	111
	96	A batsman who retires may only resume his innings by consent of the fielding side.	19	—
May 5th 1858	97	The direction given in Serial Number 90 is reinforced to include not only the instant of delivery, **but also the bowler's action immediately beforehand.** **(For particulars of the instructions issued to the umpires on this subject, *vide* Chapter 3.)**	90	100
June 11th 1860	98	The rolling of the pitch between innings to be at the request of the side next to bat.	93	102
April 15th 1863	99	**It was decided to alter the "L.B.W." Law to render the striker liable should he stop the ball with any part of his person between wicket and wicket, irrespective of the pitch of the ball, or whether it would have hit the wicket or not.** This decision was not put into practice as the M.C.C. found that the resolution was out of order owing to notice not having been given in accordance with the rules. (*Vide* Chapter 3.)	87	1884
June 10th 1864	100	A proposal to allow over-arm bowling was not accepted at a General Meeting of the M.C.C. in 1863, but is now approved in the terse phrase, "The ball must be bowled."	97	1884

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
May 4th 1870	101	Provided he does not bowl more than two overs in succession, a bowler may change ends twice but no more often in an innings.	14	109
May 2nd 1883	102	The pitch may be rolled for 10 minutes before the start of play. **This change is interesting since it emanated from the County Secretaries, a reflection of the increasing prestige of County cricket. Although the change was decided on in 1883, it was not promulgated until the publication of the new code in the following year.**	98	126

THE 1884 CODE

The preparation of this Code has been fully described in Chapter 4, from which it will be clear that its introduction involved no major changes in the conduct of the game.

April 21st 1884		For the first time reference is found to the number of players on each side, to the number of innings, to the method by which runs are scored and the results of matches assessed, to the appointment of umpires and scorers, and throughout the revision free use is made of the term "Dead ball" about which previously there were no very explicit instructions.	1	—
			49	112
		The thickness of the bail is specified for the first time to remove doubts about the overall height of the wicket.	83	125
		"Boundaries" are officially mentioned for the first time, though they were in use many years earlier.	13	—
		A last-minute addition was made to the "No ball" Law to make it clear that the umpire must call if not ab-	100	113

CHRONOLOGY

Date	Serial No. of Change	Particulars of Change	Reference to Serial Nos. Prior	Later
		solutely satisfied of the fairness of a delivery. Three Laws dealing with one-day cricket were removed from the general code and shown separately. It is interesting to note that the opportunity was not taken to revive the 1863 proposal to amend the "L.B.W." Law. All the changes mentioned above in no way altered the intent of the earlier Laws, and the only important alterations are as follows:	99	128
	103	A striker becomes liable to be out for *any* infringement of the Laws by his runner — previously only his liability in respect of a run out had been mentioned.	94	129
	104	The umpires are to be appointed "one for each end"—a truly significant phrase.	92	—
	105	Although the term "Bye" is found much earlier in the Laws for Single-wicket, and clearly both Byes and Leg Byes were a recognised means of scoring, they are now specifically defined for the first time.	56	—
	106	The Law defining a wicket being "down" confirms that if one bail is off, the fall of the remaining bail suffices without the need to strike a stump from the ground.	85	135
	107	The "Obstruction" Law is extended to cover not only the obstruction of a catch but now any form of such tactics by either batsman; except in the former case either batsman is liable to be dismissed.	38	—

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
May 1st 1889	108	The Over is increased from four balls to five.	14	116
	109	A bowler is permitted to change ends as often as he pleases, but may not bowl two overs in succession in any innings.	101	—
	110	The batting side is allowed to declare its innings closed at any time on the last day of a match.	—	115
June 10th 1894	111	The limit of runs for a "follow on" is increased to 120 runs in a three-day match. The Law still however provides no option in its application.	95	114
May 3rd 1899	112	The ball becomes "dead" if it lodges in the batsman's clothing.	1884	1947
Oct. 30th 1899	113	*Either* umpire may call "No ball" if not satisfied with the absolute fairness of any delivery.	1884	133
May 2nd 1900	114	The enforcement of a "Follow on" becomes optional for the side in the lead. The limits are altered to: for a three-day match 150 runs, for a two-day match 100 runs, and for a one-day match 75 runs.	111	121
	115	A declaration is allowed in a three-day match after the start of the luncheon interval on the second day.	110	118
	116	The Over is increased from five balls to six.	108	131
May 7th 1902	117	The Bowling Crease is lengthened to 8 feet 8 inches.	69	—
May 2nd 1906	118	In a two-day match a declaration on the first day is allowed provided 100 minutes remain for play.	115	119
May 4th 1910	119	A declaration is allowed at any time on the second day of a three-day match.	118	121
May 1st 1912	120	The striker cannot be out stumped off a "No ball," but may be run out	54	136

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
		—this change was destined to cause much difficulty in interpretation.		
May 6th 1914 and May 7th 1919	121	If the start of play is delayed by weather, the "follow on" and "declaration" rules are to apply in accordance with the number of days remaining after the actual start of play.	114 119	123 124
May 4th 1927	122	The ball is to measure between 8 13/16 and 9 inches in circumference.	82	130
	123	The limit of runs for a "follow on" in a three- or more day match is altered to 150 runs.	121	—
	124	Serial Number 119 is extended to apply in a match of more than three days.	121	—
May 6th 1931	125	The height of the wicket is increased to be not less than 27 inches nor more than 28 inches—in the latter case the width to be 9 instead of 8 inches.	1884	—
	126	The time allowed for sweeping and rolling the pitch before the start of each day's play and between the innings is reduced to 7 minutes.	102	—
May 6th 1936	127	It is made clear that the penalty of 5 runs for irregular fielding is in addition to any runs already made.	49	—
May 5th 1937	128	The "L.B.W." Law is extended to include the case of a ball pitching on the off-side of the wicket, provided it hits some part of the striker between wicket and wicket.	1884	1947

THE 1947 CODE

Since the reasons leading up to the revision of the Laws in 1947 have been fully explained in Chapter 5, no special further introduction is now required. Apart from the definite alterations set out later the most important features are as follows:

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
May 7th 1947		A definition of the term "Pitch" is included, and the use of the term "Wicket" is confined to the stumps and the bails.	—	—
		The term "Special Regulation" is defined in order to provide for any special playing conditions agreed upon as necessary to meet the requirements of differing climates, competitive cricket and so on.	—	—
		A new Law is included to collect and expand all the many references to the ball becoming "dead" previously scattered throughout the 1884 code.	1884	132
		The "L.B.W." Law is more closely defined in respect of a ball hitting the striker either full-pitch or above the level of the bails.	128	—
		The umpires are no longer required to pitch the wickets, but are to satisfy themselves that they have been properly pitched.	63	—
	129	The batting captain has the right to say where a fielding substitute may *not* field; previously he was required to say where he should field. *N.B.* Subject to consent a substitute may keep wicket.	103	—
	130	The provision of a new ball at the start of an innings is no longer obligatory in every class of cricket.	47, 122	—
	131	A major change is made in respect of the final over of a match. Previously the batting side alone had the option of continuing play if a wicket fell within two minutes of "Time," but now the last over of any match must be finished if either captain so demands.	—	—

CHRONOLOGY

Date	Serial No. of Change	Particulars of Change	Reference to Serial Nos. Prior	Later
		Latitude is provided for the "Over" to be of either 6 or 8 balls in order to meet the requirements of cricket overseas.	116	—
	132	The new "Dead ball" Law for the first time states when the ball ceases to be "dead."	1884	
	133	The "No ball" Law no longer requires the bowler to have his back foot "grounded" at the instant of delivery, though it must still be behind the line of the Bowling crease. Previously umpires had found it impossible to adjudicate on this point, and as a matter of course had disregarded the old instruction.	113	—
	134	It is made clear that the striker cannot create a "Wide" by stepping back.	91	—
	135	Whereas before it had been ruled that the least disturbance of a bail sufficed for the wicket to be "down," it is now necessary for the bail to fall clear of the grooves on the stumps.	106	—
	136	The Laws regarding "Running out" and "Stumping" revert to the original eighteenth-century conception, in order to eliminate many difficulties of interpretation which previously existed. It is now ruled that when the wicket-keeper puts down the wicket, the striker is not to be given "Run out" unless in the opinion of the umpire he is attempting a run.	120	—
	137	The old Laws were obscure on the point of the wicket-keeper taking the ball in front of the wicket. The Law now states that he must remain behind the wicket until the striker	—	—

CHRONOLOGY

Date	*Serial No. of Change*	*Particulars of Change*	*Reference to Serial Nos. Prior*	*Later*
		plays the ball, or the ball passes the wicket, or the striker attempts a run.		
	138	Previously no mention was made to the incommoding of the striker by any fieldsman except the wicket-keeper. This is now corrected by bringing obstruction of this nature within the judgment of the umpires in respect of unfair play.	21	—

APPENDICES

Appendix I

Reproduction ($\frac{7}{8}$ scale) of the Laws as first published in booklet form in 1755.

THE

GAME

AT

CRICKET,

As ſettled by the Several

CRICKET-CLUBS,

Particularly that of the

STAR and GARTER
In PALL-MALL.

LONDON:
Printed for M. READ, and ſold by W. REEVE
in *Fleet-Street*.
MDCCLV.

THE

GAME

AT

CRICKET.

THE Pitching the firſt Wicket is to be determined by the Toſs of a Piece of Money.

When the firſt Wicket is pitch'd, and the Popping-Creaſe cut, which muſt be exactly Three Feet Ten

Inches from the Wicket, the other Wicket is to be pitch'd directly oppoſite, at Twenty-Two Yards Diſtance, and the other Popping-Creaſe cut Three Feet and Ten Inches before it.

The Bowling-Creaſes muſt be cut in a direct Line from each Stump.

The Stumps muſt be Twenty-Two Inches long, and the Bail Six Inches.

The Ball muſt weigh between Five and Six Ounces.

When the Wickets are both pitch'd, and all the Creaſes cut, the Party that wins the Toſs-up, may order which Side ſhall go inn firſt, at his Option.

LAWS

LAWS

FOR THE

BOWLERS.

Four BALLS and Over.

THE Bowler muſt deliver the Ball, with one Foot behind the Creaſe, even with the Wicket; and when he has bowl'd one Ball, or more, ſhall bowl to the Number of Four before he changes Wickets, and he ſhall change but once in the ſame Innings.

He may order the Player that is inn at his Wicket, to ſtand on which

Side of it he pleaſes, at a reaſonable Diſtance.

If he delivers the Ball, with his hinder Foot over the Bowling-Creaſe, the Umpire ſhall call no Ball, tho' it be ſtruck, or the Player be bowl'd out; which he ſhall do without being aſk'd, and no Perſon ſhall have any Right to queſtion him.

LAWS

FOR THE

STRIKERS,

OR

THOSE that are INN.

IF the Wicket is bowl'd down, it's out.

If he ſtrikes, or treads down, or falls himſelf upon his Wicket in ſtriking (but not in over-running) it's out. A Stroke, or Nip, over or under his Bat, or upon his Hands (but not Arms) if the Ball be held before it

it touches the Ground, though it be hugg'd to the Body, it's out.

If in ſtriking, both his Feet are over the Popping-Creaſe, and his Wicket put down, except his Bat is down within, it's out.

If he runs out of his Ground to hinder a Catch, it's out.

If a Ball is nipp'd up, and he ſtrikes it again wilfully, before it came to the Wicket, it's out.

If the Players have croſs'd each other, he that runs for the Wicket that is put down, is out: If they are not croſs'd, he that returns is out.

If in running a Notch, the Wicket is ſtruck down by a Throw, before his Foot, Hand, or Bat is over the Popping-Creaſe, or a Stump hit by the

the Ball, though the Bail was down, it's out.

But if the Bail is down before, he that catches the Ball muſt ſtrike a Stump out of the Ground, Ball in Hand, or elſe it's not out.

If the Striker touches, or takes up the Ball before it has lain quite ſtill, unleſs aſk'd by the Bowler, or Wicket-Keeper, it's out.

BAT,

BAT, FOOT, OR HAND, OVER THE CREASE.

WHEN the Ball has been in Hand by one of the Keepers, or Stoppers, and the Player has been at Home, he may go where he pleaſes till the next Ball is bowl'd.

If

If either of the Strikers is croſs'd, in his running Ground, deſignedly, the ſame muſt be determined by the Umpires.

N. B. The Umpires may order that Notch to be ſcored.

When the Ball is hit up, either of the Strikers may hinder the Catch in his running Ground; or if it is hit directly acroſs the Wickets, the other Player may place his Body any where within the Swing of the Bat, ſo as to hinder the Bowler from catching it; but he muſt neither ſtrike at it, nor touch it with his Hands.

If a Striker nips a Ball up juſt before him, he may fall before his Wicket,

Wicket, or pop down his Bat, before it comes to the Wicket, to ſave it.

The Bail hanging on one Stump, though the Ball hit the Wicket, it's not out.

LAWS

FOR THE

WICKET-KEEPERS.

THE Wicket-Keepers ſhall ſtand at a reaſonable Diſtance behind the Wicket, and ſhall not move till the Ball is out of the Bowler's Hand, and ſhall not, by any Noiſe, incommode the Striker; and

and if his Hands, Knees, Foot, or Head, be over, or before the Wicket, though the Ball hit it, it ſhall not be out.

LAWS

FOR THE

UMPIRES.

TO allow Two Minutes for each Man to come inn when one is out, and Ten Minutes between each Hand.

To mark the Ball that it may not be changed.

They are ſole Judges of all Outs and Inns; of all fair or unfair Play; of all frivolous Delays; of all Hurts, whether

whether real or pretended, and are diſcretionally to allow what Time they think proper before the Game goes on again.

In Caſe of a real Hurt to a Striker, they are to allow another to come inn, and the Perſon hurt to come inn again ; but are not to allow a freſh Man to play, on either Side, on any Account.

They are ſole Judges of all Hindrances ; croſſing the Players in running, and ſtanding unfair to ſtrike, and in Caſe of Hindrance may order a Notch to be ſcor'd.

They are not to order any Man out, unleſs appealed to by one of the Players.

Theſe Laws are to the Umpires jointly.

Each

Each Umpire is the ſole Judge of all Nips and Catches ; Inns and Outs ; good or bad Runs, at his own Wicket, and his Determination ſhall be abſolute ; and he ſhall not be changed for another Umpire, without the Conſent of both Sides.

When the four Balls are bowl'd, he is to call over.

Theſe Laws are ſeparately.

When both Umpires call Play three Times, 'tis at the Peril of giving the Game from them that refuſe to play.

Appendix II

THE LAWS OF CRICKET

(1947 Code—1st Edition Adopted May 7th, 1947.)

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(A)—THE PLAYERS, UMPIRES AND SCORERS

SIDES

1.—A match is played between two sides of eleven players each, unless otherwise agreed. Each side shall play under a Captain who before the toss for innings shall nominate his players who may not thereafter be changed without the consent of the opposing Captain.

NOTES ON LAW 1

1.—If a captain is not available at any time, a deputy must act for him to deal promptly with points arising from this and other Laws.

2.—A side should not field with more than eleven players.

SUBSTITUTES

2.—A Substitute shall be allowed to field or run between the wickets for any player who may during the match be incapacitated from illness or injury, but not for any other reason without the consent of the opposing Captain; no Substitute shall be allowed to bat or to bowl. Consent as to the person to act as substitute in the field shall be obtained from the opposing Captain, who may indicate positions in which the Substitute shall not field.

NOTES ON LAW 2

1.—A player may bat, bowl or field even though a substitute has acted for him previously.

2.—An injured batsman may be "Out" should his runner infringe Laws 36, 40 or 41. As *Striker* he remains himself subject to the Laws; should he be out of his ground for any purpose he may be "Out" under Laws 41 and 42 at the wicket-keeper's end, irrespective of the position of the other batsman or the substitute when the wicket is put down. When *not the Striker* the injured batsman is out of the game and stands where he does not interfere with the play.

THE APPOINTMENT OF UMPIRES

3.—Before the toss for innings two Umpires shall be appointed; one for each end to control the game as required by the Laws with absolute impartiality. No Umpire shall be changed during a match without the consent of both Captains.

NOTE ON LAW 3

1.—The umpires should report themselves to the executive of the ground 30 minutes before the start of each day's play.

THE SCORERS

4.—All runs scored shall be recorded by Scorers appointed for the purpose; the Scorers shall accept and acknowledge all instructions and signals given to them by the Umpires.

NOTE ON LAW 4

1.—The umpires should wait until

a signal has been answered by a scorer before allowing the game to proceed. Mutual consultation between the scorers and the umpires to clear up doubtful points is at all times permissible.

(B)—THE IMPLEMENTS OF THE GAME, AND THE GROUND

THE BALL

5.—The Ball shall weigh not less $5\frac{1}{2}$ ounces, nor more than $5\frac{3}{4}$ ounces. It shall measure not less than $8\frac{13}{16}$ inches, nor more than 9 inches in circumference. Subject to agreement to the contrary either Captain may demand a new ball at the start of each innings. In the event of a ball being lost or becoming unfit for play, the Umpires shall allow another ball to be taken into use. They shall inform the Batsmen whenever a ball is to be changed.

NOTES ON LAW 5

1.—All cricket balls used in First-class matches should be approved before the start of a match by the umpires and captains. The latter may demand a new ball at the start of each innings.

2.—After 200 runs have been made off a ball in First-class matches, the captain of the fielding side may demand a new one. In other grades of cricket this regulation will not apply unless so agreed before the toss for innings.

3.—Any ball substituted under this Law should have had similar wear or use as that of the one discarded.

THE BAT

6.—The Bat shall not exceed $4\frac{1}{4}$ inches in the widest part; it shall not be more than 38 inches in length.

THE PITCH

7.—The Pitch is deemed to be the area of ground between the bowling creases, 5 feet in width on either side of the line joining the centre of the wickets. Before the toss for innings, the executive of the ground shall be responsible for the selection and preparation of the Pitch; thereafter the Umpires shall control its use and maintenance. The Pitch shall not be changed during a match unless it becomes unfit for play, and then only with the consent of both Captains.

THE WICKETS

8.—The Wickets shall be pitched opposite and parallel to each other at a distance of 22 yards from stump to stump. Each Wicket shall be 9 inches in width and consist of three stumps with two bails upon the top. The stumps shall be of equal and of sufficient size to prevent the ball from passing through, with their top 28 inches above the ground. The bails shall be each $4\frac{3}{8}$ inches in length, and, when in position on the top of the stumps, shall not project more than $\frac{1}{2}$ inch above them.

NOTES ON LAW 8

1.—The use of stumps with metal fittings is a source of danger and should not be encouraged.

2.—Except for the bail grooves the tops of the stumps shall be dome-shaped.

3.—In a high wind the captains may agree, with the approval of the umpires, to dispense with the use of bails (*see* Law 31, Note 3).

THE BOWLING AND POPPING CREASES

9.—The Bowling crease shall be in line with the stumps; 8 feet 8 inches in length; the stumps in the centre; with a Return crease at each end at right angles behind the wicket. The Popping crease shall be marked 4 feet in front of and parallel with the Bowling crease. Both the Return and Popping creases shall be deemed unlimited in length.

NOTE ON LAW 9

1.—The distance of the Popping Crease from the wicket is measured from a line running through the centre of the stumps to the inside edge of the crease.

(C)—THE CARE AND MAINTENANCE OF THE PITCH

ROLLING, MOWING AND WATERING

10.—Unless permitted by special regulations, the Pitch shall not be rolled during a match except before the start of each innings and of each day's play, when, if the Captain of the batting side so elect, it may be swept and rolled for not more than 7 minutes. The Pitch shall not be mown during a match unless special regulations so provide. Under no circumstances shall the Pitch be watered during a match.

NOTES ON LAW 10

1.—"Special Regulations," within the framework of the Laws, referred to in this and subsequent Laws are those authorised by M.C.C. in respect of County cricket, or by Overseas Governing Bodies in respect of cricket in the countries concerned. Such Regulations do not apply to matches played by touring teams unless included in these Notes and Interpretations of the Official Laws, or unless agreed to by both parties before the visiting team arrives.

2.—The umpires are responsible that any rolling permitted by this Law and carried out at the request of the captain of the batting side, is in accordance with the regulations laid down and that it is completed so as to allow play to start at the stipulated time.

3.—The time allowed for rolling shall be taken out of the normal playing time if a captain declare an innings closed either, (*a*) before play starts on any day so late that the other captain is prevented from exercising his option in regard to rolling under this Law, or (*b*) during the luncheon interval later than 15 minutes after the start of such interval.

4.—In Australia, South Africa and New Zealand, if at any time a rain-affected pitch is damaged by play thereon, it shall be swept and rolled for a period of not more than ten consecutive minutes at any time between the close of play on the day on which it was damaged and the next resumption of play, provided that:

(i) The umpires shall instruct the groundman to sweep and roll the pitch only after they have agreed that damage caused to it as the result of play after rain has fallen warrants such rolling additional to that provided for in Law 10.

(ii) Such rolling shall in all cases be done under the personal supervision of both umpires and shall take place at such time and with such roller as the groundman shall consider best calculated to repair the damage to the pitch.

(iii) Not more than one such additional rolling shall be permitted as a result of rain on any particular day.

(iv) The rolling provided for in Law 10 shall not be permitted on any day on which the rolling herein provided for takes place within two hours of the time appointed for commencement of play on that day.

5.—The pitch may be mown under the supervision of the umpires before

play starts on the third day of a match, (or on the Monday of a match starting on the preceding Friday or Saturday), and thereafter on each alternate day.

COVERING THE PITCH

11.—The Pitch shall not be completely covered during a match unless special regulations so provide; covers used to protect the bowlers' run up shall not extend to a greater distance than 3½ feet in front of the Popping creases.

NOTE ON LAW 11

1.—It is usual under this Law to protect the bowlers' run up, before and during a match, both at night and, when necessary, during the day. The covers should be removed early each morning, if fine.

MAINTENANCE OF THE PITCH

12.—The Batsman may beat the Pitch with his bat, and Players may secure their footholds by the use of sawdust, provided Law 46 be not thereby contravened. In wet weather the Umpires shall see that the holes made by the Bowlers and Batsmen are cleaned out and dried whenever necessary to facilitate play.

(D)—THE CONDUCT OF THE GAME

INNINGS

13.—Each side has two innings, taken alternately, except in the case provided for in Law 14. The choice of innings shall be decided by tossing on the field of play.

NOTES ON LAW 13

1.—The captains should toss for innings not later than 15 minutes before the time agreed upon for play to start. The winner of the toss may not alter his decision to bat or field once it has been notified to the opposing captain.

2.—This Law also governs a One-day match in which play continues after the completion of the first innings of both sides. (*See also* Law 22.)

FOLLOWING INNINGS

14.—The side which bats first and leads by 150 runs in a match of three days or more, by 100 runs in a two-day match, or by 75 runs in a one-day match, shall have the option of requiring the other side to follow their innings.

NOTE ON LAW 14

1.—In Australia the lead necessary to enforce a follow-on in a match lasting three days or more is 200 runs.

DECLARATIONS

15.—The Captain of the Batting side may declare an innings closed in a match of three days or more, at any time on the second and succeeding days; in a two-day match, at any time but on the first day not later than 1 hour and 40 minutes before the hour agreed on for drawing stumps; in a one-day match, at any time.

16.—When the start of play is delayed by weather Laws 14 and 15 shall apply in accordance with the number of days' play remaining from the actual start of the match.

COMMENCEMENT AND CLOSE OF PLAY AND INTERVALS

17.—The Umpires shall allow such intervals as have been agreed upon for meals, 10 minutes between each innings and not more than 2 minutes for each fresh batsman to come in. At the start of each innings and of each day's play and at the end of any interval the Umpire at the Bowler's end shall call "Play," when the side refusing to play shall lose the match. After "Play" has been called no trial ball shall be allowed to any player, and when one of the Batsmen

is out the use of the bat shall not be allowed to any player until the next Batsman shall come in.

NOTES ON LAW 17

1.—The umpires shall not award a match under this Law unless (i) "Play" has been called in such a manner that both sides can clearly understand that play is to start, (ii) an appeal has been made, and (iii) they are satisfied that a side will not, or cannot, continue play.

2.—It is an essential duty of the captains to ensure that the "in-going" batsman passes the "out-coming" one before the latter leaves the field of play. This is all the more important in view of the responsibility resting on the umpires for deciding whether or not the delay of the individual amounts to a refusal of the batting side to continue play.

3.—The interval for luncheon should not exceed 45 minutes unless otherwise agreed (but *see* Law 10, Note 3). In the event of the last wicket falling within 2 minutes of the time arranged for luncheon or tea, the game shall be resumed at the usual hour, no allowance being made for the 10 minutes between the innings.

4.—Bowling practice *on the pitch* is forbidden at any time during the game.

18.—The Umpires shall call "Time," and at the same time remove the bails from both wickets, on the cessation of play before any arranged interval, at the end of each day's play, and at the conclusion of the match. An "Over" shall always be started if "Time" has not been reached, and shall be completed unless a batsman is "Out" or "Retires" within 2 minutes of the completion of any period of play, but the "Over" in progress at the close of play on the final day of a match shall be completed at the request of either Captain even if a wicket fall after "Time" has been reached.

SCORING

19.—The score shall be reckoned by runs. A run is scored:

1st—So often as the Batsmen after a hit, or at any time while the ball is in play, shall have crossed and made good their ground from end to end; but if either Batsman run a short run, the Umpire shall call and signal "One short" and that run shall not be scored. The Striker being caught, no run shall be scored; a Batsman being run out, that run which was being attempted shall not be scored.

2nd—For penalties under Laws 21, 27, 29, 44, and boundary allowances under Law 20.

NOTES ON LAW 19

1.—If while the ball is in play, the batsmen have crossed in running, neither returns to the wicket he has left except in the case of a boundary hit, or under Laws 30 Note 1 and 46 Note 4 (vii). This rule applies even should a short run have been called, or should no run be reckoned as in the case of a catch.

2.—At his own risk the striker may take guard and play the ball in front of the popping crease; should he attempt to run from that point, the umpire does not call "One short."

3.—If two or more runs are attempted, only one run is deducted on a call of "One short," even though both batsmen may have failed to complete the same run, and although the failure of a batsman to complete a run shortens the run immediately following.

4.—The umpire signals "One

short" by bending an arm upwards to touch the shoulder with the tips of the fingers.

BOUNDARIES

20.—Before the toss for innings the Umpires shall agree with both sides on the Boundaries for play, and on the allowances to be made for them. An Umpire shall call or signal "Boundary" whenever, in his opinion, a ball in play hits, crosses or is carried over the Boundary. The runs completed at the instant the ball reaches the Boundary shall count only should they exceed the allowance, but if the "Boundary" result from an overthrow or from the wilful act of a fieldsman, any runs already made and the allowance shall be added to the score.

NOTES ON LAW 20

1.—In deciding on the allowances to be made for boundaries the umpires will be guided by the prevailing custom of the ground.

2.—It is a "Boundary" if the ball touches any boundary line or if a fieldsman with ball in hand grounds any part of his person on or over that line. A fieldsman, however, standing within the playing area may lean against or touch a boundary fence in fielding a ball (*see also* Law 35 Note 5).

3.—An obstacle, or person, within the playing area is not regarded as a boundary unless so arranged by the umpires. The umpire is not a boundary, but sight screens within the playing area shall be so regarded.

4.—The customary allowance for a boundary is 4 runs, but it is usual to allow 6 runs for all hits pitching over and clear of the boundary line or fence (even though the ball has been previously touched by a fieldsman). It is not usual to allow 6 runs when a ball hits a sight screen full pitch, if the latter is on or inside the boundary.

5.—In the case of a boundary resulting from either an overthrow or the wilful act of a fieldsman, the run in progress counts provided that the batsmen have crossed at the instant of the throw or act.

6.—The umpire signals "Boundary" by waving an arm from side to side, or a boundary "6" by raising both arms above the head.

LOST BALL

21.—If a ball in play cannot be found or recovered any Fieldsman may call "Lost Ball," when 6 runs shall be added to the score; but if more than 6 have been run before "Lost Ball" be called, as many runs as have been run shall be scored.

THE RESULT

22.—A match is won by the side which shall have scored a total of runs in excess of that scored by the opposing side in its two completed innings; one-day matches, unless thus played out, shall be decided by the first innings. A match may also be determined by being given up as lost by one of the sides, or in the case governed by Law 17. A match not determined in any of these ways shall count as a "Draw."

NOTES ON LAW 22

1.—It is the responsibility of the captains to satisfy themselves on the correctness of the scores on the conclusion of play.

2.—Neither side can be compelled to continue after a match is finished; a one-day match shall not be regarded as finished on the result of the first innings if the umpires consider there is a prospect of carrying the game to a further issue in the time remaining.

3.—The result of a finished match is stated as a win by runs, except in the case of a win by the side batting

last, when it is by the number of wickets still then to fall. In a one-day match which is not played out on the second innings, this rule applies to the position at the time when a result on the first innings was reached.

4.—A "Draw" is regarded as a "Tie" when the scores are equal at the conclusion of play but only if the match has been played out. If the scores of the completed first innings of a one-day match are equal, it is a "Tie," but only if the match has not been played out to a further conclusion.

THE OVER

23.—The ball shall be bowled from each wicket alternately in Overs of either 8 or 6 balls according to the agreed conditions of play. When the agreed number have been bowled and it has become clear to the Umpire at the Bowler's wicket that both sides have ceased to regard the ball as in play, the Umpire shall call "Over" in a distinct manner before leaving the wicket. Neither a "No Ball" nor a "Wide Ball" shall be reckoned as one of the "Over."

NOTE ON LAW 23

1.—In default of any agreement to the contrary, in the United Kingdom the "over" shall be 6 balls.

24.—A Bowler shall finish an "Over" in progress unless he be incapacitated or be suspended for unfair play. He shall be allowed to change ends as often as desired, provided only that he shall not bowl two "Overs" consecutively in one innings. A Bowler may require the Batsman at the wicket from which he is bowling to stand on whichever side of it he may direct.

DEAD BALL

25.—The ball shall be held to be "Dead"—on being in the opinion of the Umpire finally settled in the hands of the Wicket-keeper or of the Bowler; or on reaching or pitching over the boundary; or, whether played or not, on lodging in the dress of either a Batsman or Umpire; or on the call of "Over" or "Time" by the Umpire; or on a Batsman being out from any cause; or on any penalty being awarded under Laws 21 or 44. The Umpire shall call "Dead Ball" should he decide to intervene under Law 46 in case of unfair play or in the event of a serious injury to a player; or should he require to suspend play prior to the Striker receiving a delivery. The ball shall cease to be "Dead" on the Bowler starting his run or bowling action.

NOTES ON LAW 25

1.—Whether the ball is "finally settled" is a question of fact for the umpire alone to decide.

2.—An umpire is justified in suspending play prior to the striker receiving a delivery in any of the following circumstances:

(i) If satisfied that, for an *adequate* reason, the striker is not ready to receive the ball, and makes no attempt to play it.

(ii) If the bowler drops the ball accidentally before delivery, or if the ball does not leave his hand for any reason.

(iii) If one or both bails fall from the striker's wicket before he receives the delivery.

In such cases the ball is regarded as "Dead" from the time it last came into play.

3.—A ball does not become "Dead" when it strikes an umpire (unless it lodges in his dress), when the wicket is broken or struck down (unless a batsman is out thereby), or when an unsuccessful appeal is made.

NO BALL

26.—For a delivery to be fair the ball must be bowled, not thrown or jerked; if either Umpire be not entirely satisfied of the absolute fairness of a delivery in this respect, he shall call and signal "No Ball" instantly upon delivery. The Umpire at the Bowler's wicket shall call and signal "No Ball" if he is not satisfied that at the instant of delivery the Bowler has at least some part of one foot behind the Bowling crease and within the Return crease, and not touching or grounded over either crease.

NOTES ON LAW 26

1.—Subject to the provisions of the Law being complied with, a bowler is not debarred from delivering the ball with both feet behind the bowling crease.

2.—The striker is entitled to know whether the bowler intends to bowl over or round the wicket, overarm or underarm, right or left handed. An umpire may regard any failure to notify a change in the mode of delivery as "unfair," if so, he should call "No Ball."

3.—It is a "No Ball" if the bowler before delivering a ball, throws it at the striker's wicket even in an attempt to run him out (*see* Law 46 Note 4 (vii)).

4.—If a bowler break the near wicket with any part of his person during the delivery, such act in itself does not constitute "No Ball."

5.—The umpire signals "No Ball" by extending one arm horizontally.

6.—An umpire should revoke the call "No Ball" if the ball does not leave the bowler's hand for any reason.

27.—The ball does not become "Dead" on the call of "No Ball." The Striker may hit a "No Ball" and whatever runs result shall be added to his score, but runs made otherwise from a "No Ball" shall be scored "No Balls," and if no runs be made one run shall be so scored. The Striker shall be out from a "No Ball" if he break Law 37, and either Batsman may be run out, or given out if he break Laws 36 or 40.

NOTES ON LAW 27

1.—The penalty for a "No Ball" is only scored if no runs result otherwise.

2.—Law 46 Note 4 (vii) covers attempts to run before the ball is delivered, but should the non-striker unfairly leave his ground too soon, the fielding side may run out the batsman at the bowler's end by any recognised method. If the bowler throws at the near wicket, the umpire does not call "No Ball," though any runs resulting are so scored. The throw does not count in the "Over."

WIDE BALL

28.—If the Bowler shall bowl the ball so high over or so wide of the wicket that in the opinion of the Umpire it passes out of reach of the Striker, and would not have been within his reach when taking guard in the normal position, the Umpire shall call and signal "Wide Ball" as soon as it shall have passed the Striker.

NOTES ON LAW 28

1.—If a ball which the umpire considers to have been delivered comes to rest in front of the striker "Wide" should not be called, and no runs should be added to the score unless they result from the striker hitting the ball which he has a right to do without interference by the fielding side.

2.—The umpire signals "Wide" by extending both arms horizontally.

3.—An umpire should revoke the

call if the striker hits a ball which has been called "Wide."

29.—The ball does not become "Dead" on the call of "Wide Ball." All runs that are run from a "Wide Ball" shall be scored "Wide Balls," or if no runs be made one run shall be so scored. The Striker may be out from a "Wide Ball" if he break Laws 38 or 42, and either Batsman may be run out, or given out if he break Laws 36 or 40.

BYE AND LEG BYE

30.—If the ball, not having been called "Wide" or "No Ball," pass the Striker without touching his bat or person, and any runs be obtained, the Umpire shall call or signal "Bye"; but if the ball touch any part of the Striker's dress or person except his hand, and any run be obtained, the Umpire shall call or signal "Leg Bye"; such runs to be scored "Byes" and "Leg Byes" respectively.

NOTES ON LAW 30

1.—If the striker wilfully deflects the ball with any part of his person, no runs are scored, and the batsmen may not change ends.

2.—The umpire signals "Bye" by raising an open hand above the head, and "Leg Bye" by raising a leg and touching it with the hand.

THE WICKET IS DOWN

31.—The wicket shall be held to be "Down" if either the ball or the Striker's bat or person completely removes either bail from the top of the stumps, or, if either or both of the bails be previously off, strikes a stump out of the ground. Any player may use his hand or arm to put the wicket down or, even should the bails be previously off, may pull up a stump, provided always that the ball is held in the hand or hands so used.

NOTES ON LAW 31

1.—A wicket is not "down" merely on account of the disturbance of a bail, but it is "down" if a bail in falling from the wicket lodges between two of the stumps.

2.—If one bail is off, it is sufficient for the purpose of this Law to dislodge the remaining one in any of the ways stated.

3.—If, owing to the strength of the wind, the captains have agreed to dispense with the use of bails (*see* Law 8, Note 3), the decision as to when a wicket is "down" is one for the umpires to decide on the facts before them. In such circumstances the wicket would be held to be "down" even though a stump has not been struck out of the ground.

4.—If the wicket is broken while the ball is in play, it is not the umpire's duty to remake the wicket until the ball has become "dead." A fieldsman, however, may remake the wicket in such circumstances.

5.—For the purpose of this and other Laws, the term "person" includes a player's dress and equipment as normally worn.

OUT OF HIS GROUND

32.—A Batsman shall be held to be "Out of his ground" unless some part of his bat in hand or of his person be grounded behind the line of the Popping Crease.

BATSMAN RETIRING

33.—A Batsman may retire at any time, but may not resume his innings without the consent of the opposing Captain, and then only on the fall of a wicket.

NOTE ON LAW 33

1.—When a batsman has retired owing to illness, injury, or some other unavoidable cause, his innings is counted as "Retired, Not Out,"

but otherwise as a completed innings to be recorded as "Retired, Out."

BOWLED

34.—The Striker is out "Bowled"—If the wicket be bowled down, even if the ball first touch his bat or person.

NOTE ON LAW 34

1.—The striker, after playing the ball, is out "Bowled" if he then kicks or hits it on to his wicket before the completion of his stroke.

CAUGHT

35.—The Striker is out "Caught"—If the ball, from a stroke of the bat or of the hand holding the bat, but not the wrist, be held by a Fieldsman before it touch the ground, although it be hugged to the body of the catcher, or be accidentally lodged in his dress. The Fieldsman must have both his feet entirely within the playing area at the instant the catch is completed.

NOTES ON LAW 35

1.—Provided the ball does not touch the ground, the hand holding it may do so in effecting a catch.

2.—The umpire is justified in disregarding the fact that the ball has touched the ground, or has been carried over the boundary provided that a catch has in fact been completed prior to such occurrence.

3.—The fact that a ball has touched the striker's person before or after touching his bat does not invalidate a catch.

4.—The striker may be "Caught" even if the fieldsman has not touched the ball with his hands, including the case of a ball lodging in the wicket-keeper's pads.

5.—A fieldsman standing within the playing area may lean against the boundary to catch a ball, and this may be done even if the ball has passed over the boundary.

6.—If the striker lawfully plays the ball a second time he may be out under this Law, but only if the ball has not touched the ground since being first struck.

7.—The striker may be caught off any obstruction within the playing area provided it has not previously been decided on as a boundary.

HANDLED THE BALL

36.—Either Batsman is out "Handled the ball"—If he touch it while in play with his hands, unless it be done at the request of the opposite side.

NOTES ON LAW 36

1.—A hand holding the bat is regarded as part of it for the purposes of Laws 36, 37 and 39.

2.—The correct entry in the score book when a batsman is given out under this Law is "Handled the Ball," and the bowler does not get credit for the wicket.

HIT THE BALL TWICE

37.—The Striker is out "Hit the ball twice"—If the ball be struck or be stopped by any part of his person, and he wilfully strike it again, except for the sole purpose of guarding his wicket, which he may do with his bat or any part of his person, other than his hands. No runs except those which result from an overthrow shall be scored from a ball lawfully struck twice.

NOTES ON LAW 37

1.—It is for the umpire to decide whether the ball has been so struck a second time legitimately or not. The umpire may regard the fact that a run is attempted as evidence of the batsmen's intention to take advantage of the second stroke, but it is not conclusive.

2.—This Law is infringed if the striker, after playing the ball and without any request from the oppo-

site side, uses his bat to return the ball to a fieldsman.

3.—The correct entry in the score book when the striker is given out under this Law is "Hit the ball twice," and the bowler does not get credit for the wicket.

HIT WICKET

38.—The Striker is out "Hit wicket"—If in playing at the ball he hit down his wicket with his bat or any part of his person.

NOTES ON LAW 38

1.—The striker is "Out" under this Law if:

(i) In making a second stroke to keep the ball out of his wicket he hits it down.

(ii) While playing at the ball, but not otherwise, his wicket is broken by his cap or hat falling, or by part of his bat.

2.—A batsman is not out for breaking the wicket with his bat or person while in the act of running.

L.B.W.

39.—The Striker is out "Leg before wicket"—If with any part of his person except his hand, which is in a straight line between wicket and wicket, even though the point of impact be above the level of the bails, he intercept a ball which has not first touched his bat or hand, and which, in the opinion of the Umpire, shall have, or would have, pitched on a straight line from the Bowler's wicket to the Striker's wicket, or shall have pitched on the offside of the Striker's wicket, provided always that the ball would have hit the wicket.

NOTE ON LAW 39

1.—A batsman is only "Out" under this Law if *all* the four following questions are answered in the affirmative.

(i) Would the ball have hit the wicket?

(ii) Did the ball pitch on a straight line between wicket and wicket (and this case includes a ball intercepted full pitch by the striker), or did it pitch on the offside of the striker's wicket?

(iii) Was it part of the striker's person other than the hand which first intercepted the ball?

(iv) Was that part of the striker's person in a straight line between wicket and wicket at moment of impact, irrespective of the height of the point of impact?

OBSTRUCTING THE FIELD

40.—Either Batsman is out "Obstructing the field"—If he wilfully obstruct the opposite side; should such wilful obstruction by either Batsman prevent a ball from being caught it is the Striker who is out.

NOTES ON LAW 40

1.—The umpire must decide whether the obstruction was "wilful" or not. The involuntary interception by a batsman while running of a throw in is not in itself an offence.

2.—The correct entry in the score book when a batsman is given out under this Law is "Obstructing the field," and the bowler does not get credit for the wicket.

RUN OUT

41.—Either Batsman is out "Run out"—If in running or at any time, while the ball is in play, he be out of his ground, and his wicket be put down by the opposite side. If the batsmen have crossed each other, he that runs for the wicket which is put down is out; if they have not crossed, he that has left the wicket which is

put down is out. But unless he attempt to run, the Striker shall not be given "Run out" in the circumstances stated in Law 42, even should "No Ball" have been called.

NOTE ON LAW 41

1.—If the ball is played on to the opposite wicket, neither batsman is liable to be "Run out" unless the ball has been touched by a fieldsman before the wicket is put down.

STUMPED

42.—The Striker is out "Stumped" —If in receiving a ball, not being a "No Ball," delivered by the Bowler, he be out of his ground otherwise than in attempting a run, and the wicket be put down by the Wicket-keeper without the intervention of another fieldsman. Only when the ball has touched the bat or person of the Striker may the Wicket-keeper take it in front of the wicket for this purpose.

NOTE ON LAW 42

1.—The striker may be "Stumped" if the wicket is broken by a ball rebounding from the wicket-keeper's person.

THE WICKET-KEEPER

43.—The Wicket-keeper shall remain wholly behind the wicket until a ball delivered by the Bowler touches the bat or person of the Striker, or passes the wicket, or until the Striker attempts a run. Should the Wicket-keeper contravene this Law, the Striker shall not be out except under Laws 36, 37, 40 and 41 and then only subject to Law 46.

NOTE ON LAW 43

1.—This Law is provided to secure to the striker his right to play the ball and to guard his wicket without interference from the wicket-keeper. The striker may not be penalized if in the legitimate defence of his wicket he interferes with the wicket-keeper.

THE FIELDSMAN

44.—The Fieldsman may stop the ball with any part of his person, but if he wilfully stop it otherwise five runs shall be added to the run or runs already made; if no run has been made five shall be scored. The penalty shall be added to the score of the Striker if the ball has been struck, but otherwise to the score of Byes, Leg Byes, No Balls or Wides as the case may be.

NOTES ON LAW 44

1.—A fieldsman must not use his cap, etc., for the purpose of fielding a ball.

2.—The five runs are a penalty and the batsmen do not change ends.

(E)—DUTIES OF THE UMPIRES

45.—Before the toss for innings, the Umpires shall acquaint themselves with any special regulations, and shall agree with both Captains on any other conditions affecting the conduct of the match; shall satisfy themselves that the wickets are properly pitched; and shall agree between themselves on the watch or clock to be followed during play.

NOTES ON LAW 45

1.—Apart from "Special Regulations" (*see* Law 10, Note 1), other conditions of play within the framework of the Laws are frequently necessary, e.g., Hours of play, Intervals, etc.

2.—The captains are entitled to know which clock or watch will be followed during play.

46.—Before and during a match the Umpires shall ensure that the conduct of the game and the implements used are strictly in accordance with the Laws; they are the sole judges of fair and unfair play, and the final judges of the fitness of the

ground, the weather and the light for play in the event of the decision being left to them; all disputes shall be determined by them, and if they disagree the actual state of things shall continue. The Umpires shall change ends after each side has had one innings.

NOTES ON LAW 46

1.—An umpire should stand where he can best see any act upon which his decision may be required. Subject to this over-riding consideration the umpire at the bowler's end should stand where he does not interfere with either the bowler's run up or the striker's view. If the other umpire wishes to stand on the off instead of the leg side of the pitch, he should obtain the permission of the captain of the fielding side and inform the batsman.

2.—The umpires must not allow the attitude of the players or spectators to influence their decisions under the Laws.

3.—A code of signals for umpires is laid down in the Notes to the relevant Laws; but an umpire must call as well as signal, if necessary, to inform the players and scorers.

4.—FAIR AND UNFAIR PLAY.

(i) The umpires are entitled to intervene without appeal in the case of unfair play, but should not otherwise interfere with the progress of the game, except as required to do so by the Laws.

(ii) In the event of a player failing to comply with the instructions of an umpire or criticising his decisions, the umpires should in the first place request the captains to take action, and if this proves ineffective, report the incident forthwith to the executives of the teams taking part in the match.

(iii) It is illegal for a player to lift a seam of the ball in order to obtain a better hold. In such a case the umpire will if necessary change the ball for one which has had similar wear, and will warn the captain that the practice is unfair. The use of resin, wax, etc., by bowlers is also unfair, but a bowler may dry the ball when wet on a towel or with sawdust.

(iv) An umpire is justified in intervening under this Law should any player of the fielding side incommode the striker by any noise or motion while he is receiving a ball.

(v) The umpires are justified in preventing players from causing damage to the pitch which may assist the bowlers.

(vi) The persistent and systematic bowling of fast short-pitched balls at the batsman standing clear of his wicket is "unfair" and if, in the opinion of the umpire at the bowler's end, unfair bowling of this type takes place he must adopt the following procedure:

(*a*) When he decides that such bowling is becoming persistent he forthwith "cautions" the bowler.

(*b*) If this "caution" is ineffective, he informs the captain of the fielding side and the other umpire of what has occurred.

(*c*) Should the above prove ineffective, the umpire at the bowler's end must:

(i) At the first repetition call "Dead Ball" when

the over is regarded as completed.

(ii) Request the captain of the fielding side to take the bowler off forthwith.

(iii) Report the occurrence to the captain of the batting side as soon as an interval of play takes place.

A bowler who has been "taken off" as above may not bowl again during the same innings.

(vii) Any attempt by the batsmen to *steal a run* during the bowler's run up is unfair. Unless the bowler throws the ball at either wicket (*see* Laws 26 Note 3 and 27 Note 2), the umpire should call "Dead Ball" as soon as the batsmen cross in any such attempt to run, after which they return to their original wickets.

5.—GROUND, WEATHER AND LIGHT.

(i) Unless agreement to the contrary is made before the start of a match, the captains (during actual play the batsmen at the wickets may deputise for their captain) may elect to decide in regard to the fitness of the ground, weather or light for play; otherwise or in the event of disagreement, the Umpires are required to decide.

(ii) Play should only be suspended when the conditions are so bad that it is unreasonable or dangerous for it to continue. The ground is unfit for play when water stands on the surface or when it is so wet or slippery as to deprive the batsmen or bowlers of a reasonable foothold, or the fieldsmen of the power of free movement. Play should *not* be suspended merely because the grass is wet and the ball slippery.

(iii) After any suspension of play, the captains, or, if the decision has been left to them, the Umpires, unaccompanied by any of the players, will without further instruction carry out an inspection immediately the conditions improve, and will continue to inspect at intervals. Immediately the responsible parties decide that play is possible, they must call upon the players to resume the game.

APPEALS

47.—The Umpires shall not order a Batsman out unless appealed to by the other side which shall be done prior to the delivery of the next ball, and before "Time" is called under Law 18. The Umpire at the Bowler's wicket shall answer appeals before the other Umpire in all cases except those arising out of Laws 38 or 42 and out of Law 41 for run out at the Striker's wicket. In any case in which an Umpire is unable to give a decision, he shall appeal to the other Umpire whose decision shall be final.

NOTES ON LAW 47

1.—An appeal, "How's that?" covers all ways of being out (within the jurisdiction of the umpire appealed to), unless a specific way of getting out is stated by the person asking. When either umpire has given a batsman "Not out" the other umpire may answer any appeal within his jurisdiction, provided it is made in time.

2.—The umpire signals "Out" by raising the index finger above the head. If the batsman is not out, the umpire calls "Not out."

3.—An umpire may alter his decision provided that such alteration is made promptly.

4.—Nothing in this Law prevents an umpire before giving a decision from consulting the other umpire on a point of fact which the latter may have been in a better position to observe. An umpire should not appeal to the other umpire in cases on which he could give a decision, merely because he is unwilling to give that decision. If after consultation he is still in any doubt the principle laid down in Law 46 applies and the decision will be in favour of the batsman.

5.—The umpires should intervene if satisfied that a batsman, not having been given out, has left his wicket under a misapprehension.

6.—Under Law 25 the ball is "Dead" on "Over" being called; this does not invalidate an appeal made prior to the first ball of the following "Over," provided the bails have not been removed by both umpires after "Time" has been called.

Appendix III

A CLASSIFIED LIST OF EDITIONS OF THE LAWS OF CRICKET PUBLISHED BETWEEN 1744 AND 1835

A. DATED AND RELIABLE EDITIONS

Year	*Description*
1752	The Laws were published in *The New Universal Magazine* of November 1752 under the title "The GAME at CRICKET, as settled by the CRICKET-CLUB, in 1744, and play'd at the ARTILLERY-GROUND, LONDON." (*Vide* Chapter I.) The publisher, M. Cooper at the Globe in Paternoster Row, included an engraving of Hayman's painting of Cricket in the Artillery Ground to illustrate the Laws. (J. W. Goldman Library.)
1755	The Laws are found printed in this year for the first time in booklet form. The copy in the M.C.C. Library is entitled, "The Game at Cricket, As settled by the Several Cricket-Clubs, Particularly that of the Star and Garter in Pall-Mall; printed in London for M. Read, and sold by W. Reeve in Fleet-Street, 1755." (Appendix I.) Buckley has established that the booklet was advertised for sale on May 15th, 1755. These Laws are essentially the 1752 version in a slightly modernised form, and it may be taken that long before their publication the "several" clubs were in fact well accustomed to playing to a common code which had not varied materially since 1744, and probably since an even earlier date. (*Vide* Chapter I.)
1774	On February 25th, 1774, a new code of the Laws was adopted: several important additions were made, and the revision included radical modifications to both the sequence and the wording of the 1755 version. This revision was carried out at the Star and Garter by a committee of "Noblemen and Gentlemen of Kent, Hampshire, Surry, Sussex, Middlesex and London." It was

Appendix III

A CLASSIFIED LIST OF EDITIONS OF THE LAWS OF CRICKET PUBLISHED BETWEEN 1744 AND 1835

B. UNDATED OR UNRELIABLE EDITIONS

Year	*Description*
c. 1744—possibly earlier.	The same code as that printed in *The New Universal Magazine* of November 1752, but in earlier language in which "Ye" is used for "The," as given in *Scores and Biographies*, Volume I, taken from an undated manuscript of which trace has now been lost. The Laws printed on the margin of the first state of Ware's handkerchiefs have the same characteristics. (*Vide* Chapter I.)
c. 1750—possibly earlier.	A code practically identical with that of the 1752 *New Universal Magazine* version is found on a redrawn edition of Ware's handkerchief in the M.C.C. Collection.
1755	Thomas has stated that Ashley-Cooper republished another edition of the 1755 code from an original issued by Robert Sayer at the Golden Buck, Fleet Street. Neither the original or the reprint can now be traced, and it is thought that Thomas was mistaken. (*Vide* Chapter I.)
1774	An undated edition of the Laws was printed by T. Clout, junior, of Sevenoaks, for sale in Kent and Sussex. This gives the names of those who served on the committee of revision as follows: "In the chair, Sir William Draper. Present: His Grace the Duke of Dorset, Right Honourable Earl Tankerville, Sir Horace Mann, Philip Dehany, John Brewer Davis, Harry Peckham, Francis Vincent, John

A. DATED AND RELIABLE EDITIONS

Year *Description*

published in booklet form under the title "The Laws of Cricket," and printed, "By order of the Committee" for J. Ridley, St. James's Street. (M.C.C. Library.)

This edition is of great interest, not only on account of the revision, but because it provides the earliest record of a meeting of County Cricket representatives. (*Vide* Chapter 2.)

1785 On September 1st, 1785, John Wallis, of 16 Ludgate Street, in association with I. Binns, of Leeds, published as a broadsheet, "The Laws of the Noble Game of Cricket, as Established at the Star and Garter, Pall-Mall, by a Committee of Noblemen and Gentlemen." (M.C.C. Collection.) If we except the handkerchiefs, of *c.* 1750 and *c.* 1785, this was the first occasion on which the Laws were published in broadsheet form.

This broadsheet is embellished with an attractive engraving of Hayman's "Cricket in the Marylebone Fields" painted *c.* 1740.

This print provides the first reference in any edition of the Laws to the three-stump wicket. It takes the form of an insertion at the end of the third Law. "*N.B.* It is lately settled to use three Stumps instead of two to each Wicket, the Bail the same length as above." The wording of this footnote reinforces the suggestion already made that the 1774 committee was not a standing one, and did not in fact revise the Laws year by year.

There is no evidence to suggest that Wallis was not a reliable publisher, and this broadsheet almost certainly had a very wide circulation. This edition therefore has been commonly accepted as authentic—an assumption which appears to be fully justified by the next entry.

B. UNDATED OR UNRELIABLE EDITIONS

Year	*Description*
	Cooke, Charles Coles, Richard James, Esquires, Rev. Charles Pawlet." The M.C.C. Library copy was presented by Arthur Haygarth in 1868, and is almost certainly the source of the Laws for 1774 given by him in *Scores and Biographies*, Volume I.
	Another edition, dated 1774, was printed for J. Williams, No. 39, next the Mitre-Tavern, Fleet-Street, under the title "The Articles of Cricket." (M.C.C. Library.) The Laws given are those of 1755, and do not include the restriction on the width of the bat introduced in September 1771; they cannot therefore be accepted as reliable.
c. 1785	An undated linen handkerchief depicts a game of cricket in progress on the White Conduit Ground with the Laws of Cricket set out in three panels round the edge (*vide* plate facing page 33). The Laws are described "as established at the Star and Garter, Pall Mall by a Committee of Noblemen and Gentlemen" and agree verbatim with the 1774 Code, supplemented with the Note in regard to the third stump exactly as it appears in the Wallis print of 1785. The pictures at the four corners are those of the Prince of Wales, the Earl of Dorset, Sir Horace Mann and Colonel Tarleton. The portrait of the Prince of Wales shows him as a young man in his twenties; since he was born in 1762, and the White Conduit Ground only became fashionable about 1780, it would seem that this rare handkerchief was probably published about the same time as the Wallis print, and that it gives further evidence of the authenticity of the latter. (M.C.C. Collection.)
1786	"New Articles of the Game of Cricket" were printed in booklet form for H. Turpin, No. 104 St. John's Street, and are dated 1786. (M.C.C. Library.) These are identical with the version given in the Ridley edition of 1774, and contain none of the alterations noted in the Wallis broadsheet, or in Blake's Maidstone edition. (*Vide infra.*) In particular there is no reference to the introduction of the third stump, although an engraving is inserted depicting the three-stump wicket in use on the White Conduit Ground.

A. DATED AND RELIABLE EDITIONS

Year	*Description*
1787	The July 1787 number of *The New Universal Magazine* contained a version of the 1774 code, which is identical with that given by the Wallis print of 1785, including the note about the three-stump wicket: this constitutes strong supporting evidence for the correctness of the latter code. The accompanying plate, however, is an engraving by Noble, after a drawing by A. Neil, of the White Conduit Ground. (E. R. Wilson Library.)
1788	The opening period of the M.C.C.'s authority between 1788 and 1803 is covered by the annual publication of *A Complete List of all the Grand Matches that have been played in the year, —with a correct state of each innings; and the Articles of Cricket inserted.* These were edited by Samuel Britcher, official M.C.C. Scorer, and up to 1799 had the additional hall-mark of being printed by T. Craft, "Printer to the Mary-le-bone Cricket Club." These books of Scores appeared at the end of each season, but the Laws were not included until 1796; both in this year and in 1797 they are referred to as those adopted on May 30th, 1788, though this does not rule out the possibility of some intervening changes having been incorporated. The revision of May 30th, 1788, must be regarded as a fresh code—the first to be produced under the aegis of the M.C.C.
1798 1799 1801 1802 1803	The Laws are also included, corrected to date, in the editions of Britcher for 1798, 1799, 1801, 1802 and 1803. (The editions mentioned are in the M.C.C. Library.) All these versions can be accepted as unquestionably reliable, and the period is therefore covered more adequately

B. UNDATED OR UNRELIABLE EDITIONS

Year	*Description*
	This evidence of lax editorship renders the booklet unreliable, but it is remarkable for the fact that the 1755 code is included immediately after the one for 1774. It is possible that the printing was specially ordered to enable a committee entrusted with a further revision to examine alongside each other the original versions of the two earlier codes. As has been pointed out in Chapter 6, Serial Number 38, there is evidence to suggest that such a revision was carried out just before the M.C.C. was founded in 1787.
c. 1786	J. Blake, of Maidstone, published an undated edition in booklet form under the title, "New Articles of the Game of Cricket, As settled and revised at the Star and Garter, Pall-Mall, February the 25th, 1774," by the same committee which was responsible for the dated Ridley edition. This edition appears to be later than 1785 as it contains evidence of changes subsequent to the publication of the Wallis print. For example, in two places there are references to two bails being required for each wicket, a change which one would expect to find about this time; the "Hit Wicket" Law appears for the first time, and a minor alteration is included in a rule for the Single Wicket game; in addition there are two changes of sequence. The M.C.C. copy of this edition is endorsed, "Moses Ades' Cricketing Book June 29 1788," suggesting that the date of publication was not earlier than about 1786.
c. 1787	In the M.C.C. Library there is a copy, recently reprinted from the original by photographic methods, of a later edition of Blake's booklet. This contains the modern

Addendum

c.1787 A copy of what appears to be a second issue of Blake's edition has the amendment to the "obstruction" rule pasted over. This appears to be the source of the facsimile reprint. There is no evidence of a second edition. A copy of this later issue was, in 1962, in the possession of Mr. L.G. Stratton, of 58 St. George's Road, Southwark, S.E.1.

A. DATED AND RELIABLE EDITIONS

Year	*Description*
	than any previous one, and indeed than the ensuing period up to 1835. Haygarth depended on Britcher for the Laws he gives for 1788, 1798, 1799, 1800 and 1801 in *Scores and Biographies*.
1804	T. Boxall published *Rules and Instructions for Playing at the Game of Cricket* in *c.* 1801 (1st edition) and 1804 (2nd edition); to these are subjoined "The Laws and Regulations of Cricketters, as Revised by the Cricket Club at Mary-le-bone." (M.C.C. Library.) In these booklets the Laws agree verbally with those of Britcher, and are reliable.
1809	On May 25th, 1809, "The Laws of the Noble Game of Cricket as revised by the Club at St. Mary-le-bone" were published as a broadsheet by John Wallis, 13 Warwick Square, London. (M.C.C. Collection.) These agree in sequence and phraseology with Britcher. Since Wallis had previously published the 1785 Laws in similar form, it is reasonable to have expected careful editorship from him, and there is no reason to differ from the accepted view that his version is authentic. Judging from the number of copies of the broadsheet known to exist to-day, it must have had a very wide circulation.
c. 1809	In 1811 Harris Bros., Horton Street, Liverpool, published the Laws of Cricket as revised by the St. Marylebone Club in 1809 for the use of the members of the important Liverpool Cricket Club. (J. W. Goldman Library.) These contain at least four alterations of outstanding importance, which are repeated in identical words, though in a slightly different sequence, in the 1816 Craft broadsheet. Furthermore they agree completely with the *c.* 1809 Bailey version. (*Vide* opposite.) These changes cannot have been merely intelligent anticipation, and this version therefore can be accepted as reliable.

B. UNDATED OR UNRELIABLE EDITIONS

Year	*Description*
1793	Haygarth, in *Scores and Biographies*, Volume I, provides the Laws for 1793 extracted from *The Sporting Magazine*. This version is suspect on account of the "L.B.W." Law being the pre-1788 one, and there is an omission in respect of the jurisdiction of the umpires.
1803	R. Pocock, of Gravesend, in this year published "Laws of the Manly Game of Cricket" which agree with Britcher except for one divergence in sequence, which was later followed by Baxter in his 1809 edition. (M.C.C. Library.)
1806	In this year Stanhope and Graham continued the Britcher series, which had ceased at the end of 1803, by publishing in one volume the scores for 1804 and 1805, including the Laws as revised in 1803. (M.C.C. Library.) These have two material differences from other codes of the same period in connection with the choice of innings and pitch, and with the Single Wicket game, for which five new and crudely worded rules are given. Since the Wallis print of 1809 does not endorse these modifications, this edition must be regarded with suspicion.
1808	The Laws given in *The New Pocket Hoyle* (Part II, 1808), are at least ten years out of date, and therefore quite unreliable. (M.C.C. Library.)
1809	The "Laws of the Noble Game of Cricket, corrected to the present Time, according to the Rules of the St. Mary-le-bone Club" were published in booklet form, dated 1809, by J. Baxter of the Sussex Press, Lewes. (M.C.C. Library.) Both in sequence and detail these differ from the more authentic Wallis print of the same year, and they must be regarded as unreliable. From internal evidence it is possible to infer that Baxter later used his 1809 version of the Laws as a basis for the one included in the first edition of Lambert's *Cricketer's Guide* which he published in 1816. (*Vide infra.*)
c. 1809	"Laws of the Noble Game of Cricket, as Revised by the Club at St. Mary-le-bone to this present day," published by J. Bailey, 116 Chancery Lane, London, are most unfortunately undated. (M.C.C. Library.)

A. DATED AND RELIABLE EDITIONS

Year *Description*

1816 T. Craft, Wells Street, Oxford Street, London, published as a broadsheet, "The Laws of Cricket, as revised by the Cricket Club, at St. Mary-le-bone, 1816." (British Museum Library.)

Since Craft was the official printer to the M.C.C. at the time of Britcher, there is no reason to doubt the authenticity of this version, and a study of the broadsheet strongly supports this view.

1820 Craft published a similar broadsheet with the Laws revised to 1820, and this also can be accepted as reliable. (M.C.C. Collection.) (*Vide* page 25.)

1823 A broadsheet entitled "The Laws of Cricket, Revised by the Marylebone Club in the Year 1823" was published by Carpenter and Son, 16 Aldgate High Street. (Sloane-Stanley Collection.)

The fact that the Laws appear serially numbered for the first time makes this edition interesting. On the copy examined the original owner has inserted in ink the alteration increasing the size of the wicket to 27 by 8 inches—the

B. UNDATED OR UNRELIABLE EDITIONS

Year	*Description*
	The same important changes that appear in the 1811 Liverpool edition are given in identical words. The two M.C.C. copies are from the A. L. Ford Library, and are dated 1806 on the modern leather binding. This may be a misprint for 1809 as the Laws are definitely later than those of the Wallis print which appeared early in that season. This edition therefore seems to be authentic, subject to an accurate date being ascribed to it.
c. 1815	A broadsheet with a crude print of Hayman's painting, "Cricket in the Marylebone Fields," was published by J. and E. Wallis, 42 Skinner-Street, Snow-hill (Printer, J. Pittman, Warwick Square). This undated sheet closely resembles the Wallis prints of 1785 and 1809 and appears to be authentic. It contains a new rule allowing two practice balls to a fresh bowler, a change which first appears in the official 1816 version, but the form of the "No ball" Law is that of *c.* 1811. (M.C.C. Collection.)
1816 to 1828	In 1816, J. Baxter of the Sussex Press, Lewes, published the first of a long series of Guides by William Lambert entitled, *Instructions and Rules for playing the Noble Game of Cricket*, to which are added "The Laws of the Game with additions and corrections." An examination of these Laws indicate that they may have been based on Baxter's bastard version of 1809, and it is clear from evidence found in the 11th edition, which appeared in 1828, that the publisher was very lax in incorporating changes as they occurred. Furthermore it is only possible to ascribe accurate publication dates to two or three of the many editions. Other writers have depended to some extent on the assumed accuracy of these Guides—for example, Haygarth in *Scores and Biographies*, Volume I—and it is therefore important to make it clear that the Laws given in the first eleven editions and in the special 20th edition called "England's Standard" are not to be depended on. The series were published at irregular intervals during the period 1816 to 1828, except for the 12th edition which appeared *c.* 1830. (*Vide infra.*) (J. W. Goldman and M.C.C. Libraries.)

A. DATED AND RELIABLE EDITIONS

Year *Description*

stumps to be of sufficient thickness to prevent the ball from passing through. It is known with almost complete certainty that this change was adopted in May 1823.

There is no reason to suspect the reliability of this edition.

1827 Haygarth extracted the Laws for 1827 for *Scores and Biographies*, Volume II, from *The Sporting Magazine*. These, like the 1823 version, are numbered and have every appearance of being correct.

1830 "The Laws of Cricket, revised by the Marylebone Club in the year 1830" were published as a broadsheet—entered at Stationers' Hall. (M.C.C. Library.)

The publisher's name is not given but a footnote suggests that it may have been "B. Dark, at his Manufactury, on Lord's Cricket Ground."

These Laws appear to be entirely reliable, and agree with a broadsheet bearing the same description published by Traveller, 25 Bell Street, Edgware Road. (British Museum Library.)

They also agree verbatim with the 1830 version extracted from *The Sporting Magazine* given in *Scores and Biographies*, Volume II.

(In 1831 the Editor of Bell's Life recommended the Laws published by Dark of Lord's (to his readers.) (M.S. Extracts, Buckley, G.B. – M.C.C. Library.)

B. UNDATED OR UNRELIABLE EDITIONS

Year	*Description*
1823	In this year Charles Clapshaw, of Farnham, published in booklet form "Rules of the Game of Cricket, as revised by the Cricket Club at St. Mary-le-bone, 1819," printed by I. Nichols. (M.C.C. Library.) This version differs both in arrangement and content from the Craft edition of 1820; this evidence of lax editorship renders it unreliable.
1825	Clapshaw published another edition of his booklet in 1825 with the Laws as revised to that year, printed by R. Cottle, of Basingstoke. (M.C.C. Library.) This edition incorporates the alteration in the size of the wicket made in 1823, but otherwise has the same character as the earlier one.
1830	The "Laws of the Manly and Noble Game of Cricket as revised by the Mary-le-bone Club in 1830" were printed in booklet form by Lewis and Co., 50 Bunhill Row, London. (M.C.C. Library.) On the back cover Clapshaw junior claimed to be "Cricket Bat and Stump Manufacturer to the Mary-le-bone Club," and the contents suggest that this version is nothing more than a reprint with a few alterations of the Farnham editions. Many of the changes known from official records to have been made in 1828 and 1829 are omitted, and the booklet is therefore unreliable.
c. 1830	Baxter published the 12th and final edition of Lambert's Guide about 1830 or a year or two later. Unlike all earlier editions, the Laws appear in authentic form, and it is unfortunate that an accurate date cannot be ascribed to their publication. (J. W. Goldman Library.)
1833	In this year John Nyren published his classic, *The Young Cricketer's Tutor*, and in it were included "The Laws of Cricket with the revision of them by the Mary-le-bone Club, in 1830." (M.C.C. Library.) An examination of these Laws shows that they appear authentic as regards the general content, but the arrangement is very different, and at least three unofficial rules are included.

A. DATED AND RELIABLE EDITIONS

Year	*Description*
1835	On May 20th, 1835, the M.C.C. adopted a completely revised code which contained considerable additions and changes—the Laws for the double-wicket game were increased from 43 to 47. A printed copy of these Laws is in the contemporary M.C.C. Minute Book, and all subsequent changes are also on record. For this reason it is unnecessary to test editions of the Laws after 1835 for reliability.

B. UNDATED OR UNRELIABLE EDITIONS

Year	*Description*
1835	"New Laws of the Game of Cricket, 1835" were published as a broadsheet by E. Wallis, 42 Skinner Street, London. (M.C.C. Collection.)

These are exceptional in not claiming to be official, but they are, in fact, probably the most misleading of all the numerous editions which qualify for the epithet "unreliable." Bearing in mind that the M.C.C. adopted a completely revised code in May 1835, the title would seem to suggest that the broadsheet would agree with this. On examination, however, it is evident that apart from one or two corrections, they have been lifted from the 20th edition of Lambert's Guide published some six years earlier.

The official Laws were numbered serially by 1823, and this edition is the first unofficial one in which numbering appears. Owing, however, to Lambert's sequence being followed, only the first five laws agree, and all the remainder carry wrong numbers which must have caused very considerable confusion.

In the M.C.C. Collection there is a second copy of this broadsheet which is undated although the Laws are the same—this may suggest an effort on the part of the publisher to settle with his own conscience.

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